SPEAKING SUCCESS

Mr.Keith

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Live Lesson Notes

Ambitions

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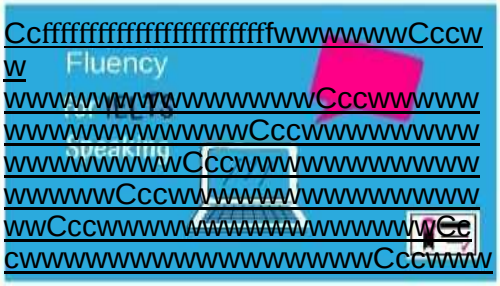

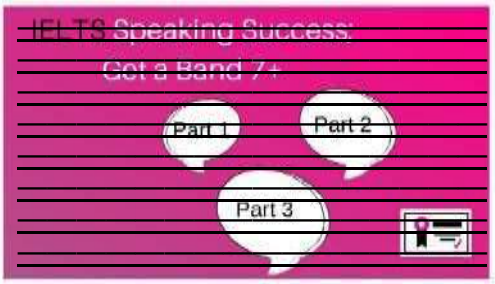

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful links
Warm up questions
Useful vocabulary
What ambitions do you have?
Idioms to talk about ambitions
Ambitions - good or bad?
Model answers

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Useful Links

How to answer the ‘**do you have any ambition**s?’ question.
https://content.wisestep.com/answer-ambition-life-interview-question

Video about Ambition is killing us

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of AMBITION, you will learn how to talk about your own ambitions and whether ambition is a good or bad thing!

Watch the complete video about this topic of ambition here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of business that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Are you ambitious?

What ambitions do you have?

Is it a good thing to be ambitious?

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Useful vocabulary

Ambition (n.) *uncountable*

I have so **much ambition**

Ambition (n.) *countable*

I have **many** different **ambitions**

I am **ambitious** (adj.)

What is ambition? = a desire to do well, to achieve a goal and to succeed

I have an aspiration to make a lot of money

Intention
Goal
Plan

I want to + verb

I want to be rich

I have an ambition to improve my English skills

I **long to** travel around the world *(really want it)*

I **strive to** be fluent in English *(try very hard)*

I dream **of** being rich
I dream **about** having a big house

I am ambitious to **pass** my exam with **flying colours** (=do very well)

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An ambition can be long term, for example,

He is ambitious at work, he wants to ***climb the corporate ladder*** *and become the CEO*

It can be short term, for example,

She is quite ambitious, she wants to invite 500 guests to her wedding

I want to sell 1,000,000 copies of my new book!
That's very ambitious, do you think you can do it?

Common Collocations

Personal ambition (run a marathon, have a big family, lose weight, visit Paris…)

Professional ambition (get a PHD, get a promotion, publish a book, speak at a conference…)

Lifelong ambition

It's a *lifelong ambition of mine* to _____

Having a **healthy** ambition can lead to success

I have a **burning** ambition to become a doctor

She is a person of **driving ambition**

You **lack ambition**

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What ambitions do you have?

(Typical job interview question)

If you get this kind of question in a job interview, you want to sound enthusiastic but not arrogant. So a short answer like this, is not so good.

I want to be successful!! ☹

You should be more **specific** (whether you are in a job interview or the IELTS speaking interview)

I want to *do my job well, and one day get promoted* ***because*** *I think I have a lot to contribute,* ***such as*** *my ideas for teaching students in different ways.* 😁

This is much better. Notice the idea of giving

1) Idea
2) Reason
3) Example

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Idioms to talk about ambitions

Dig in your heels
=*to be persistent*

I am going to publish my book, even though my friends say it's just a dream, **I am going to dig in my heels**

I will never **throw in the towel**
= *give up, stop*

You need to **stick at it**
= *to continue, persevere*

Carry on **at all costs**
= *come rain or shine (even though it is difficult)*

I **have got a bee in my bonnet** about writing a book.
=*something you really want to do*

Publishing a book is **beyond my wildest dreams**
=*something so great, I can hardly imagine it*

I was losing the game, but I managed **to claw my way back** and win
=*make a come back, to be successful after a failure*

I'll have to **go to great lengths** to achieve this goal
= *do everything possible*

I reached my goal but it was **blood, sweat and tears** all the way.
=*very hard work*

I had t**o fight tooth and nails** to reach my goal
=*fight and struggle hard*

I'm willing to **go the extra mile** to reach my goal
=*to do some extra work*

I will **keep my nose to the grindstone**
= *continue working hard*

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Ambition: Good or bad?

Good

It's beneficial to have a **competitive spirit** and to **strive for success**

It helps you **keep on track with** your goals

It's good as long as you don't hurt others or **stamp on** others

Bad

If it can be bad, if you see things as **a zero sum game** *(=a win - lose situation),*

and if your success is **at the expense of others** *(=other must lose, so you can win)*

So long as it is not **at the cost o**f others

If you have an **arrogant ambition** it can **get in your way**, and make you lose time

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Model Answers

Q: Do you have an ambition and what are your ambitions in life?

A:

I wouldn't say I am a **particularly ambitious person**, but yes,

I do have some ambitions, particularly, **professional ambitions**.

I **do dream about** writing a book and publishing a book and so right now I am actually **going to great lengths to** write the script and start editing this idea I have for a book, and, yes, that's an ambition that I have.

Q: Have the dreams you had as a child changed?

A:

Oh, absolutely, I mean you know, it's a bit funny, but as a child, I l**onged to be** a postman, because I thought postman had fantastic bicycles, but now, I think even as I was growing up as a young adult, **that dream changed significantly** and I think I **have become a little bit more ambitious** and I think certainly, **from a professional point of view,**

I **have an ambition to be successful** in the work that I do.

I long to be a good teacher and to use innovative and creative ways of teaching and although I don't wanna **stamp on** other people,

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I do want **to dig my heels in** and, you know, **do as much as it takes** to become successful in my area or my field as a teacher.

Q: Have you ever achieved your ambitions?

A:

That is a very good question.

I think I have had **several ambitions** in my life, and to be honest, **I haven't achieved all of them**. One of them that I have not achieved is to be a kind of a famous guitar player.

When I was in my 20s, I used to play guitar in a rock band and **I used to dream of** being a famous rock star, and playing the guitar in big concerts and whilst I was happy playing the guitar in the band, I never really **achieved that level or status** of being a world renowned musician, but I have achieved my goal of building, you know, a happy family.

That was a personal goal that I wanted to, always, **I wanted to achieve.** I do feel that I have reached that. It's **been blood, sweat, and tears** sometimes because, obviously families have disagreements but I think we are getting there, we have gotten there.

So, that's the ambition I feel I have reached

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Animals

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Some useful Links

Test your **vocabulary** about **animals** here
https://www.passporttoenglish.com/Advanced-English/Lesson14/Vocabulary.html

Zoos good or bad? - watch the debate!
https://www.kqed.org/education/532723/are-zoos-good-or-bad-for-animals

Ideas for some **interesting animals**
https://allthatsinteresting.com/interesting-animals

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General Vocabulary

*When talking about animals you **like**, the most common mistake is to use the singular, but if you are talking about this animal in general, you should use the **plural**.*

I like giraffe X

I like giraffes / dogs / elephants

I adore cats
I am into _____
I am a big fan of _____

I am a___person

I am a cat person

Pets

I **have a pet hate,** people speaking whilst eating
=something I hate a lot

I was the **teacher's pet**
= the teacher's favourite

Zoos

There are many different **species**

(n.) Capture (v.) - catch (v.)

Animals are kept in **captivity** (n.)

Cage (n.) -

It's sad to see **caged** (adj.) animals

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We can save **endangered** (adj.) animals
Tigers are an endangered animal

The tiger is an endangered animal

To become / be extinct (adj.)
= *to disappear, so no longer exist*

They are **on the brink of** extinction (n.)
= *about to become extinct*

They are **on the verge of** extinction
= *about to become extinct*

In a **conservation / natural / safari park** animals are allowed to **roam** (=to walk without direction) freely

We can protect animals from **poaching** (=illegal hunting)

Wild animals

herbivores (n.) = animals that eat plants
Cows, rabbits, horses…

carnivores (n.) are meat-eating animals
lions, tigers, snakes

mammals (n.) are warm-blooded, and the young feed on milk…
Humans, whales, dogs dolphins, bears

marsupials (n.) - the young live in a pouch (native to Australia)
Kangaroo, Koala, wombats, platypus, possums, wallabies

Animals that eat other animals are called **predators**

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Why do people have pets?

With this kind of question 'WHY DO PEOPLE____?"

*I recommend you focus on **1 group** of people, and then talk about them.*
This makes it easier to answer because it is very specific, otherwise you may just give a very general, 'surface-level' answer.

Also as you become more specific, you will find you use more specific vocabulary which can boost your vocabulary score.

For example,

If we are talking about old people, I think….

If we are talking about disabled people, they…

When it comes to young people, they….

More useful phrases

For **security**

For company

For companionship

They keep you company

In today's isolated life they want a companion

Pets symbolise a sense of welfare / well-being

To **curb** loneliness (=reduce, keep in check)

Help us meet other people

Pets give us a great chance to **socialise with others**

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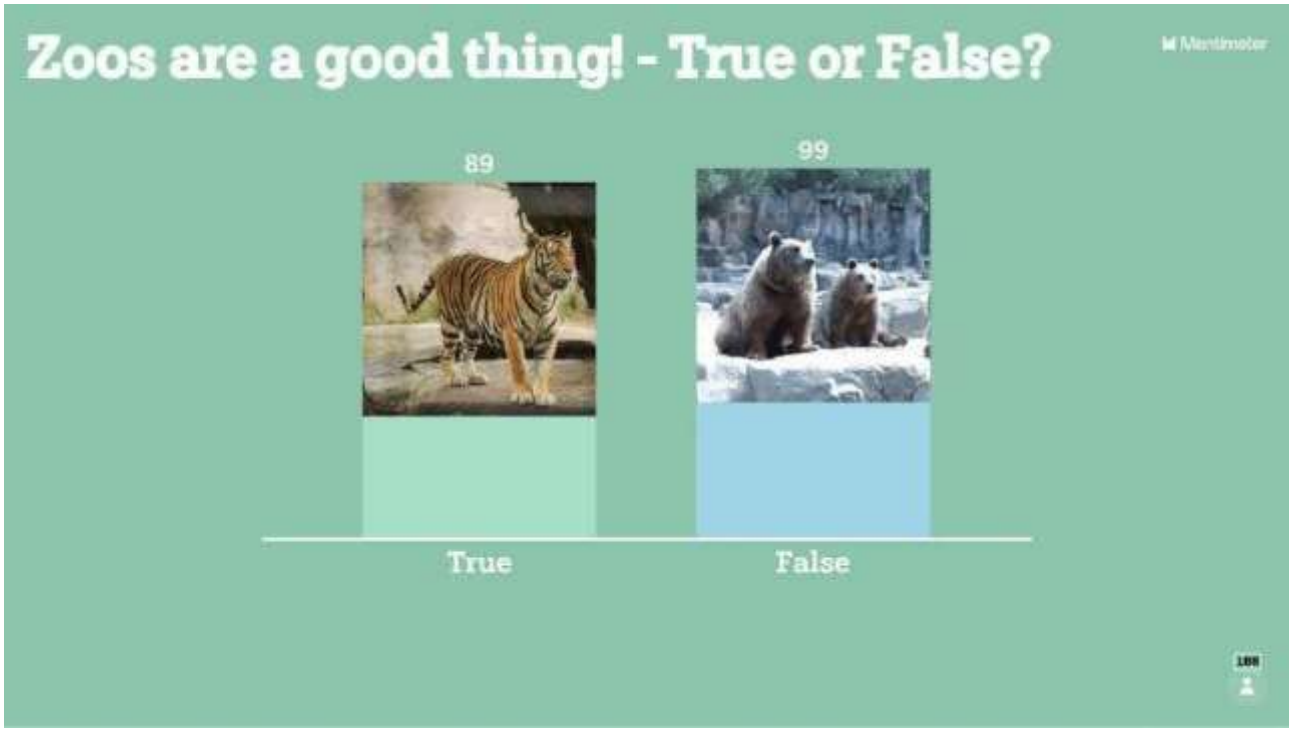
Zoos: Good or bad?



As you can see from the poll in our lesson, this is a hotly debated issue. If you are not sure about your opinion, you could say…

I am on the fence on this one
=undecided

I am in two minds about this
=undecided

Zoos are <u>not</u> a good thing because…

Cages and living conditions are too **cramped** - wild animals need liberty and freedom

Animals **lose their instincts** (for example how to hunt) and often become depressed

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They might be good for people but if we think of animals, zoos limit their activities and natural way of spending their life.

By keeping animals **cooped up** (in a small cage), there are more chances of extinction as they don't get the conditions they need to **mate** and **reproduce**

By keeping animals in captivity, **ecosystems** can **be badly effected.**

Some zoos abuse animals, for example, training elephants for entertainment.

Zoos **pose a risk**, if animals can escape, they can harm people.

Zoos <u>are</u> a good thing because…

They can help educate children

Zoos can be good **for educational purposes** to let children know about a wide range of animals.

That said, we should protect the **natural habitats** where the endangered species live.

I think, if workers treat animals kindly, zoos are good.

well, It really depends how well zoos are managed, and how much protection can be provided to the animals.

Its good to keep some of animals in zoos, as **otherwise** their **predators** will eat them and **their numbers will decrease**.

I think zoos are good to provided favourable conditions to endangered species and so help save them.

Zoos can help us understand the **biodiversity on our planet**

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Wild animals

MODEL ANSWERS to questions from students

Q1: Tell me about a time when you saw a wild animal?

A1:

Well, it's an interesting question because I live in the city, so I don't get a lot of access to wild animals**, as you can imagine.**

But I do remember once, when we were out **trekking** in the mountains, we went through a forest, it's not far from where I live, actually.

Whilst we were going through the forest, suddenly **out of the blue** *(=unexpectedly)* we saw this fox and I didn't know there were foxes in that forest, but there you go**, lo and behold,** *(=used to present a new and surprising situation)* there it was.

It was a lot bigger than I imagined. As I mentioned I live in a city so I don't see many wild animals, but this fox was almost **the size of a** wolf

and **what was interesting was,** it was really scared of us. It was more scared of us than we were of it.

So, it kind of **peeped up** *(=took a quick look)* from behind the bush, it looked at us and then **scurried away** *(=ran away quickly),* to run away and escape.

Obviously, it was afraid of humans. So, I **felt surprised to see** how big it was and how scared it was, but it was a really interesting experience that time I saw a fox in the forest near where I live.

*Notice, my speech is **not** in perfect sentences. If you write your answers out in perfect sentences, it will **not** sound natural, it will sound like you are a book!*

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Q2. Do you think zoos are a good way to conserve wild animals?

A2:

Well, it's an interesting question and I think I have two minds about this.

I know that, **by and large**, scientific research **points in the direction -** to suggest its not a good way to **conserve wild animals**,

because wild animals are **kept in captivity**, often in small **cramped** places, they **lose their instinct** *(=natural ability to do things),*

whether that be, how to hunt, how to look after their young or how to socialise,

and so they become depressed and they change their behaviour and so really they are not surviving as a species.

If we were to let them out into the wild, **they would** die within a week .

So, I think we really have to question whether we are really conserving the wild animals, the species, **for the long term.**

That said, there are certain animals may be endangered animals **on the brink of extinction** that need more protection, otherwise they will **die out**

and so for those animals it may be **plausible** to put them **in captivity**, preferably a natural park, where they can **roam freely** and **be closer to nature**

and so that yes, in that case, that may be a better way to conserve the species.

*Notice, my speech is not in perfect sentences. If you write your answers out in perfect sentences, it will **not** sound natural, it will sound like you are a book!*

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Q3. What wild animal do you like and why?

A3:

I am a big fan of elephants. I think, elephants are **curious and amazing** creatures.

I have seen elephants on the television, not in real life, where they are **trained to do** amazing things, from almost **acrobatics** to painting with their **trunk**.

I **just** think, they are lovely creatures and they seem very sociable, and very friendly, although of course in the wild I am sure they are much more aggressive,

but they are typically an animal that humans like **to tame (**=*to domesticate)* and I think they wonderful.

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Books

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These are the kinds of questions you may get asked in IELTS SPEAKING.

Part 1

Do you often read?
Did you read a lot when you were a child?
What kind of books do you like?

Part 2

Describe a book you have read recently

Part 3

Do you think people read more nowadays than in the past?

In what ways has the way we read changed in recent years?

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Some useful VOCABULARY tools

https://relatedwords.org

Great for finding words related to any topic you are studying. Great for expanding your vocabulary on a certain topic.

https://fraze.it

You put in a word and it gives you real life examples so you can see how to use that word

https://skell.sketchengine.co.uk/run.cgi/skell

You put in a word and it gives you all the words that collocate with it, including nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs and so on. Priceless tool, once you get to used to using it.

VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS

Literature (n.) = written works (books)

Literacy (n.) = the ability to read and write

Literate (adj.) = able to read and write

Fictional or non-fictional BOOKS

Fictional novels- think of the different genres -
Crime novels
Romance
Thriller - suspense
Comedy
Action
Sci-fi

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Books that have been made into a film

Non-Fictional

Biographies
Autobiographies
Hobbies
Historical (adj.)
Personal development = self help
Books related to your field of work
Recipe book
Travel guide

KEY WORDS

Plot = storyline

Setting = background (where - when)

Characters

Protagonist (main character / hero)

To **skim through** books in the bookstore

To **flip through** a book

To **leaf through** a book

All of these above mean to glance at quickly, not to read in depth.

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A voracious reader - an avid reader = reads a lot

A heavy read (n) = that book is difficult to read

It's a good read

This book is easy reading

This book makes easy reading

I could't put it down

It had me spellbound

It was a gripping novel

I read it from cover to cover

It's a captivating/great read

It had an intriguing plot

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Idiomatic expressions

To **turn over a new leaf** = to start anew / start something fresh

I want to get **in** my boss's **good book**s = I want to do something to win his/her favour

She **threw the book at** me = she told me off very strongly / scolded me for doing something wrong

Take a leaf out of Mary's **book** = learn from Mary (suggesting she is better than you)

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Business

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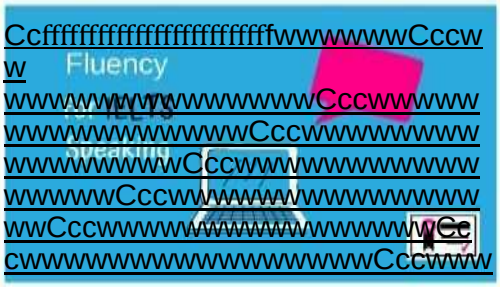

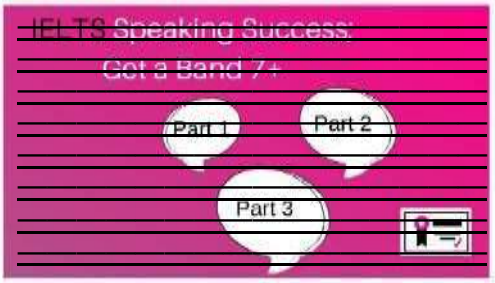

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful links
Warm up questions
Essential business vocabulary
How can small companies grow?
Idioms about business
Business idioms in the news
How to create a new business

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Useful Links

https://www.thebalancesmb.com/top-ways-of-growing-your-business-2948140

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of BUSINESS, you will learn how to talk about the world of business including, starting and growing a new business

Watch the complete video about this topic of business here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of business that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Would you like to start a business?

Would you prefer to work for a large company or a small one?

How has business changed in recent times?

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Essential business vocabulary

Business (**countable** noun)
= *a company*

We have **a lot of new businesses** in this city
I want to start **my own business**.

Business (**uncountable** noun)
Trade, or buying and selling

Business is good at the moment

Now let's look at the words used to describe different groups of people / business, starting from the smallest and becoming bigger.

1. An entrepreneur
(someone who starts a new business)

A freelancer = a consultant
(someone who is self-employed but does work for other people or companies)

2. A business = a company = an enterprise = a firm

A venture = a new business (emphasising **the risk**)

A start up
= *a new business, often used to talk about technology firms*

There are a lot of **tech start-ups** in Silicon Valley

3. An industry

Primary (mining, fishing, farming)
Secondary (car manufacturing)
Tertiary (services; teaching, nursing…)

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Heavy (B2B; oil, shipbuilding)
Light (consumer-oriented; B to C manufacturing of clothes, furniture, electronic gadgets)

4. A sector (contains several industries; Agriculture, Education, Retail, Financial services…)

*****

A **market** (where a number of companies trade)

To **enter** a market
To **break** into new markets
To **discover** and **conquer** new markets

To **corner** a market
= to **dominate** a market

Unemployment (n.) the number of people without a job

The rate of unemployment has risen recently

He is **unemployed**

He is **on the dole** (Inf. UK)
= He is unemployed

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How can small companies grow?

They can invest
They can seek investment

Find an **angel investor**
=a rich person who will invest in a new company (usually become part owner)

Get **venture capital**
=get investment for a new business

Make a lot of sales
Open more branches (for on the ground businesses / local business)
Go global

By investing / engaging in the community

Get **repeat buyers**
= *sell to existing customers*

Focus on a specific **niche**
=a specific market segment

Take on new staff
=employ new workers

Diversify
= sell new (lines of) products

Don't put all your eggs into one basket

Keep costs low

Get a **subsidy** = a grant, money from the government to help you

Improve the bottom line (your profit)
=revenue (income) minus expenditure (costs)

Do good **market research**

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Business idioms

To take a hammering
(= to suffer economically)

The F&B (food and beverage) industry **has taken a real hammering** recently.
In the recent recession, many businesses have **taken a hammering**

To keep your head above water
(=to survive)

With the lockdowns, many small businesses can't **keep their head above water**

To be hard hit (by…)
(=to suffer, be badly affected by…)

Businesses have **been hard hit** in recent times

Cut-throat competition
(=very strong competition)

There is a lot of **cut-throat competition** in the mobile phone market

Many companies will need to go **back to the drawing board** / to **start from scratch**
= to begin again (from the beginning)

This product is a **cash cow**
= it makes a lot of profit

Samsung have the **lion's share** of the market
(the biggest part)

With Covid many companies have been hard hit, but they have **to bite the bullet**
(Resist, wait, put up with it)

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Business idioms in the News

Watch the video

How many idioms can you spot?

Covid **has hit businesses hard** all over Europe

Restaurants and hotels **have taken a hammering**

Trying to get by
= *to survive*

Many SMEs are struggling to **keep their head above water**

Many SME's are going to **hit the wall**

Go belly up = go bankrupt (lose all your money)

So many of them, **are in the same boat**
= *same situation*

The government will give them subsidies or loans, **with no strings attached**
= *with no conditions*

It's a **no-brainer**
= *it's obvious, no need to think about it*

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How to create a new business

In this part of the lesson we answered the following questions to start a new business. Below are some relevant comments and language for each question.

Choose a sector (which and why?)

- *Financial*
- ***Education***
- *Retail*

Creating a business **in the education sector** will help us reach the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

Choose a business (which andwhy?)

- *Set up a school*
- ***Create a learning app***
- *Publish a magazine*

With COVID **more and more people** are **doing business online**

I would create a learning app because **education is digitalised** nowadays

Choose a product or service

- *Learn English*
- *Learn code*
- ***Learn how to start a business***

I think this is **an essential skill** for young people nowadays.

English is **in high demand** across the globe nowadays

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Choose a market

- ***Worldwide***
- *India*
- *China*

Given **the global nature** of online businesses, **it makes more sense** to aim for a worldwide market.

Choose a Target Customer

- *Old people (retirees)*
- *Married couples*
- ***Teenagers***

Teenagers, because they are most **in need** of this skill-set

Many teenagers **are unemployed** and an online business will give them a better chance to survive

Choose a pricing strategy

- *High-end price / Premium pricing*
- *Bundle pricing*
- ***Economy pricing*** */ Rock bottom prices /* ***no-frills prices***

Economy pricing is better because teenagers are not **financially independent**

People will be **enticed to buy** more with reasonable bundle pricing

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I would start with rock-bottom prices to enter the market and **build a customer base**, then **up the price** to a premium one once demand has risen.

I'd opt for bundle pricing strategy because people love discounts and always want to **get a bargain**

Homework:

Create a **logo** and **share** it in the Facebook Group

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Live Lesson Notes

Changes

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What you will learn:

Warm up questions
Essential vocabulary
Do you like change?
Idioms about Change
IELTS Speaking Part 3 Tips
Model Answers

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Some useful Links

Lyrics from the **David Bowie classic - Changes**
https://genius.com/David-bowie-changes-lyrics

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of CHANGE, you will learn how to talk about changes in life, the workplace and society

Watch the complete video about this topic of change here.

Warm up

These are the kind of questions on this topic of phones that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Tell me about recent changes in your life?
How have you changed since you were a child?
Do you like changes?

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Essential Vocabulary

It is essential to build your vocabulary and also to start ***activating*** *it.*

That means you should try ***making some phrases*** *with the vocabulary below.*

Remember to always learn the ***collocations*** *of new words.*

Try to fill in the gaps in these sentences.

1. This new government is going to_____some big changes

2. Covid has_____ _____quite a few changes in our lives

3. Please don't change your_____!

4. I am going to take the bus to work,_____a change

Possible Answers:

1. make / implement / consider / apply / conduct

2. brought about / lead to

3. opinion / mind / plan / ideas

4. for

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Common Collocations

Make a change

Introduce some new changes

This has **brought about/caused** a few changes

Change your **mind**

Change your **opinion**

Change your **tune** (=mind or attitude)

Change your **job**

Change a **plan**

I am going to take the bus to work, **for a change**

It's a change **for the worse / for the better**

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Do you like change?

Absolutely, if it's **for the better**

Change is constant, there is nothing we can do about it

It is **a constant** in our lives

Yes, I usually **embrace change.**

Yes, we can learn and grow **through change.**

I do, provided it is a **positive change.**

Idioms

The wind of change is coming *(=things are going to change)*

I have had **a change of heart** *(=to change my mind)*

A person cannot **change their stripes** *(=can't change their ways)*

A change is as good as a rest

To turn over a new leaf (=*start something new)*

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Idioms from the 'Stan the Man' Video

A change is as good as a rest

It's **a change for the better / worse**

I'**ve had a change of heart,** I've decided not to marry you!

I've decided **to turn over a new leaf**, I will stop eating cakes and start eating more fruit

I've been stuck in this job for years. I need **to blow away the cobwebs,** so I am going to quit and look for a new job, and **make a fresh start.**

This new manager has lots of new ideas. She is like **a breath of fresh air**

We need **to breathe new life into** this company, let's recruit some younger managers.

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Part 3 Tips

On the topic of change, you will probably have to talk about change in the past and future. These are some of the common topics you may have to talk about, and the causes of change you may want to mention.

Topics of change

Schools
Workplace
Family
Film / food / music industry

Causes of Change

Technology
Covid 19
Nature
Age

Common Question Types

How has_____changed in recent years?

You can break your answers into three simple parts.

1. The past
2. The change
3. Now

Well, in the past, _____

But recently **there has been** a huge change

Now, we **can see** _____

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How has <u>education</u> changed in recent years?

Well, in the past, we **used to have** face-to-face classes

But recently **there has been** a huge change

Now, we **can see** more students are studying online.

I think this is due to technology….

How will_____change in the future?

You can break your answers into three simple parts.

1. Now
2. The change
3. The future

Well right **now**, _____

But I think **this is more than likely to change**

In the future, we **will / might / may / are going to _____**

How will <u>education</u> change in the future?

Well right **now**, many pupils have to study online, as well as going to school

But I think **this is more than likely to change**

In the future, they will stop going to school altogether, and just study from home on mobile devices.

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Model Answers

Why are old people resistant to change?

A1.

Well, I am not sure that‘s **strictly true.**

I think, **by and large,** a lot of old people don’t like change, and that’s sometimes because they **are stuck in their ways.**

They have been doing the same thing for so many years that they **just** like the routine.

It gives some **a sense of security**, maybe **a sense of safety.**

For example, if they go shopping to the same shop, on the same street, at the same time every day, **there’s a sense of routine security and safety**, may be even public safety, which is important for older people.

But, that said, I don’t think all old people are resistant to change.

For example, my father has **embraced change.**

He has embraced technology. He now uses a tablet **to get online**, to surf the internet, and to have video conferences with me and other members of the family.

So, that’s my answer!

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What kind of change did you make in the past that affects your current situation?

A2.

When it comes to talking about changes I've made in the past, I think, there are lots of **changes I've made to my life.**

One of the most impactful changes that I have made, is going back to study, to do a master's degree in my 40s', which is quite old.

I mean, we've got **mature students,** but, I think, I was 44 or something when I was doing my master's degree.

It was **part-time** because I was working at that time.

But I decided to do a master's degree in digital education, in order to learn more about how people learn online and I think, this has **enormously impacted** my current situation

because with, well, I have chosen to start teaching more online and to design online courses to support students around the world

and I think for me, **having done** that masters was **a critical stage,**

in having the confidence and **the know-how to** set up learning environments, online courses and then to give classes online.

So, for me yeah, that's one of, er, the kind of change that I made, an educational change, **upping my skills**, I guess, that has affected my current situation.

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Childhood

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Riddle
I can talk, but have no mouth, I communicate but have no body, you can hear me but not see me.

Answer: Echo

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Some useful Links

Check vocabulary for popular **toys** here
https://www.parents.com/fun/toys/kid-toys/all-time-favorite-childhood-toys/

Ideas about how **childhood** was **different** 20 years ago
https://www.insider.com/how-being-kid-is-different-now-than-it- was-20-years-ago#in-many-cases-children-are-spending-less-time-outdoors-and-more-time-playing-alone-4

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Vocabulary

child (singular) - **children** (plural)

<u>ADJECTIVES</u> *collocations to use with CHILD*

well-behaved, obedient, gifted, talented, patient (*good things)*

difficult, naughty, wayward, stubborn, mischievous, hyperactive
(negative things)

Childhood (n.) -

Adjective collocations to use with CHILDHOOD

happy, cheerful, carefree, blissful *(good)*
lonely, deprived, gloomy, sorrowful *(bad)*

Childish (adj.)
= *immature*

Noun collocations to use with CHILDISH

behaviour, attitude

An only **child**
= *having no brothers or sisters*

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MORE EXPRESSIONS:

A. *The following all have the same meaning*

I **grew_up** in Manchester

I **was brought up** in _____

I **was raised** in _____

I **was born and bred** in _____

If talking about the country, we can also ***say****…*

My **motherland** is _____

B. I grew up in my birth place
in a nuclear family.
abroad.
in a bustling city.
in a stunning country-side.
in a well-educated family.
in a lush green valley.

C. *Phrases to talk about remembering*

I **remember** _my childhood well_
I **remember when I was a child**, I used to….
I **recall** _____
I **have a clear/ vivid memory** of_____
I have **fond memories** of my childhood, especially _____
I **vividly** remember _____

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Childhood activities

What did you do as a child?

We usually played **made-up games** / **pretend games**

We often played **hide and seek**

If my memory serves me right, I used to play in the streets **back then!**

As far as I can remember, we played football **most days**.

We often played chess

I '**played house**' with my friends

We used *to while away the hours* playing games

To while away the hours
= to pass the time idly / in a slow and relaxed way.

Past habits

I **used to** go to the park with my friends

We **would often** sit there for hours, chatting away.

It **wasn't uncommon for us** to play football in the park and then hang out until tea time.

I often **played outdoor activities** with my friends

We **got up to all sorts of things**, like chasing mice, playing in the mud and things like that.

To get up to
= to be involved in (often surprising things)

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Examples of childhood games and toys:

catcher catcher / Tig / Tag
blindfold game
see-saw
toy cars
mini-kitchen set
stacking toys
geometrical shapes
lego
action figures
jigsaws(puzzles)
mini-microscope
soC-toys
crayons
Play doh
board games
ludo
building blocks

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What toy did you like best?

When I was **bored** I played a **board** game
(both words pronounced the same)

I wouldn't let go of my favourite doll

I was obsessed with my train set

I loved my chess set

I was tethered to my iPad
=connected

I would go everywhere with my bike

My bike **was everything to me**

My sister loved her **Barbie doll** and my brother loved his **action figure**

I **was addicted to** my playstation / video games / my Rubik's cube

I was big fan of **playing cards**

What I loved more than anything else was to play with my crayons and draw pictures

I **could spend hours doing** jigsaws

My favourite toy was a remote-controlled racing car

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How was life different when you were a child?

Kids are **not** safer nowadays due to…

…the increased **crime rate**

…more **kidnapping**

…an increase in **cyberbullying**

…excessive **traffic** leading to more kids getting **knocked over**

…high pressure which leads to **mental health problems**

Children are **less willing / reluctant** / to have dinner with their families

Children are **not so enthusiastic** about having dinner with their families

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There is less communication within families because everyone is **tethered** to their mobile phone, leading to **fewer family meals**

Parents **have less time for** their children, and so children **have less time for** their parents!

Kids have fewer meals with their parents because there are fewer **set routines** nowadays, so it is hard to have **a fixed time** for dinner when the whole family can **sit down together.**

More women are in the **workforce,** so it is not uncommon for both parents of a **nuclear family** to be working, leaving many children alone and feeling more lonely than before.

Kids spend **so much time** on their computers and may not be aware **how little time** they are spending with their friends.

Children are more aware of nutrition but **are not necessarily** eating more healthily

Children **can get lots of information** abut health, but they are still **attracted by** fast food because it is marketed so well to children

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Cities

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Riddle
Which is the most dangerous town (city) in the world?
Answer: Electricity

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Introducing a city

You may want to talk about…

Location /Size

History

Industry

Interesting places

Weather

Location / Size

Manchester's locate**d in** the north of **England**

Manchester's located **to** the north of **London**

It can be found **in** the south or India

It can be found **on** the south **coast** of India

The zoo is in the **vicinity** of the city centre
=**nearby**, close by, in the neighbourhood of….

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Industry

Primary industries such as,
- Agriculture
- Mining
- Farming
- Fishing
- Oil and Gas

Manufacturing

The service industry
- Tourism
- Hospitality
- Recreation
- Food and beverage

The finance industry
IT
The entertainment industry

It **relies** mainly **on**____*tourism/ the service industry*__

It's **famous for**___*tourism/ the service industry*____

Its main source of revenue **comes from**__*tourism/ the service industry*_

The economy **depends** mainly **on**____*tourism/ the service industry*____

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Interesting places

Temples / museums / art galleries / beaches / mountains …..

Places **worth visiting** include _____

Tourists tend **to flock to** _____
(=go in crowds to…)

The places that **attract** most **visitors** are _____

Visitors are **drawn by** the amazing views

In IELTS speaking you probably don't want to list ***"the 10 best things to do"*** *in your city.*
It's better to just choose one, or maybe two and give more details about those.

If you could **only** do one thing in _London____, I would **recommend goING** to the Tate Gallery

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The city where I live - Santander, Spain

Collocations from the video

Dreary weather = Dull weather

Mild climate = not hot or cold

Overcast (adj).= cloudy

As for the weather, it's often overcast in my city.

The city **looks over** the **bay**

Holiday-makers = people on holiday

To **nibble at** = to eat in small bites (usually snacks)

Go for a stroll = go for a short walk

Big attraction = popular attraction

Heavy rain

It often throws it down = it often rains heavily

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How cities have changed in recent years

Many new buildings have **come** up

…have **sprung** up

….**cropped** up

All the above mean "to appear"

There are lots more skyscrapers now,
…compared to before
…compared to the the past

Cities have become 'smarter'

There has been an **influx of citizens** into cities

Increased urbanisation

Better quality housing

Higher **living standards**

Higher **cost of living**

More recreational facilities and amenities

More and more shanty cities have appeared
(**slums** = a poor and dirty area around a city)

Urban sprawl = the spread of the city

High street shops are disappearing

This is even more noticeable **following** the Corona virus / **in the wake of** the Corona virus

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Advantages of living in a city

Access to culture

High level of convenience

Reliable public transport

Variety of shopping outlets

Entertainment facilities

Better job opportunities

Higher quality eduction

Better standard of living

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Disadvantages of living in a city

Traffic congestion

Pollution

Air pollution / noise pollution / traffic pollution / water pollution

Overcrowding

Dense population

Growth of slums

High rate of unemployment

High cost of living

Wealth inequality

Growing gap/disparity between the rich and poor

High levels of stress

You get stuck in the rat race
(=working 9 to 5 everyday and stuck in a boring routine)

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Climate Change

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Some useful Links

Simple lesson introducing climate change
https://www.esolcourses.com/content/topics/environment/climate-change/climate-change-listening-activities.html

More **in-depth talk** about climate change
https://www.ted.com/talks/katharine_hayhoe_the_most_important_thing_you_can_do_to_fight_climate_change_talk_about_it

A **children's guide** to Climate Change
https://www.science-sparks.com/what-is-climate-change/

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Introduction

IELTS is **not** a test of knowledge.

You don't need to know everything about ***climate change,*** *but you should know* ***enough****, so you can discuss this topic, share some ideas and give some examples.*

This topic is most likely going to appear in IELTS Speaking Part 3.

It is often a good idea to read or watch material ***made for children*** *on topics like this.*

It will give you the key ideas, directly and in simple English.

It can be a good place to start.

For example,

https://www.science-sparks.com/what-is-climate-change/

You then may want to look at more official information such as this one,

https://www.nrdc.org/stories/global-climate-change-what-you-need-know

When it comes answering questions, you can use the following expressions to show off your language.

I am by no means an expert, but…

I don't know a great deal about this but…

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Vocabulary

Collocations for **Climate**

Inhospitable (=not kind) / severe / mild (=not hot/not cold) / hot / tropical

Collocations for **Weather**

Extreme / changeable / good / beautiful / atrocious / awful / dismal / fair

We can also describe the weather as….

Nippy / chilly (quite cold)
Bone dry (very dry)

*Weather - is more about **short term** changes*

*Climate - is more about **longer term** changes*

Weather tells you what to wear each day.
Climate tells you what types of clothes to have in your wardrobe!

Global Warming - an increase in the global average temperature on earth

Climate Change - the change in general weather conditions on the earth over a long period of time.
For example, we see more extremes weather nowadays, such as storms, tornadoes and floods than in the past.

Gas emissions - the production of gases like carbon dioxide (CO_2), and methane (CH_4).

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The Greenhouse effect - greenhouse gases trap heat from the sun in the atmosphere. The heat cannot escape and so the planet gets hotter.

Fossil fuels - non-renewable fuels, e.g. coal, carbon, oil, gas

Deforestation = the cutting down of trees on a large scale

Habitats = where animals and plants live

An ecosystem - a community of living things connected to their environment

A Carbon footprint

The amount of greenhouse gases produced from any person or organisation's activity.

I can reduce my carbon footprint by using less electricity at home.

Renewable energies - water (hydro), wind, sun (solar)

Try to solve / **tackle** / **address** climate change / global warming

We need to tackle climate change **head on** (=directly)

Mitigate climate change (=reduce, alleviate, minimise)

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Causes of Climate Change

The main **human cause** is probably **the burning of fossil fuels**, like coal, oil and gas, for electricity, heat and transportation.

When we use cars, planes and other forms of transport we burn fossil fuels and **emit greenhouse gases into the atmosphere**

The **exhaust fumes** from cars produce CO2

When we use electricity at home, we are most likely burning fossil fuels and so **producing greenhouse gases** which cause global warming.

Deforestation is a major cause of climate change. Trees **take in** CO2 and produce oxygen, so when we cut down trees this **stored CO2 is released.**
Also, as there are fewer trees, this balance of CO2 and oxygen is lost.

Tree roots hold the soil together and **keep the soil fertile.** Without trees the land is **less farmable**, and also the soil moves leading to both **landslides** and possible **drought**.

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Farming, including **raising livestock** (e.g. cows, sheep, and goats) produces harmful greenhouse gases because cows **emit methane gas** when they fart (when they **defecate**).

When farmers use this as **fertiliser**, it is also **emitting** more greenhouse **gases into** the atmosphere.

Apparently, the fashion industry that **pushes** us to buy new clothes every season, **produces vast amounts of** greenhouse gases.

These come from the **processes** needed to produce the **fabrics**, especially man-made ones, and also the **transportation** needed for the **complex supply chains**.

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Did you know a shirt made of **man-made polyester** has **twice the carbon footprint of a cotton shirt?**

Such **consumerism** also leads to huge amounts of waste and **non-biodegradable fabrics** that damage the environment.

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Is Climate Change a problem? Why?

In the past, the climate **occurred in regular cycles** and it used to rain during a particular season but now, it rains heavily any time and this is leading to **floods**.

The **Ozone layer** is being depleted due to daily increasing CO2 emissions.

Such gaps in the Ozone layer mean **the sun's harmful rays** are doing more damage to the planet.

The polar ice sheet is melting (**thawing out**) and the sea levels are rising

We are **disrupting the balance** in the ecosystem

It leads to the melting of the polar ice sheets

It leads to destruction of wildlife and their **habitats**

Some **species** are becoming **extinct**

It might lead to **sea-level rise** which in turn causes damage to coastal regions

The earth is getting hot and hotter and so there are more droughts which **has a devastating impact** on farming and the **livelihood** of local communities

At the same time, we are experiencing increasingly adverse and extreme weather conditions. **Floods** and **flooding** are more and more common place.

When we have floods, **contagious diseases** can **spread like wild fire**

Farmers face problems due to **soil erosion** and so use a**rtificial fertilisers** which can cause **water and air pollution**.

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MODEL ANSWERS

Q1. What do you think about climate change?

A1. Well, for sure, climate change is a **hugely controversial** subject nowadays

and I think, it's a problematic thing, its a **problematic issue**, clearly because the growing rise in the temperature, the global warming we are experiencing, is having a **huge impact** on our lives, and on nature and the the world around us.

For example, climate change…
the increase of the temperature that is happening **due to the** emission of methane from cows or **carbon emissions** from traffic, is leading to this increased temperature **which in turn leads to** the sea level rise which is getting worse and worse, and that's **destroying habitats** for animals like the polar bear and penguin.

But not only that, it's having a really **detrimental impact** on coastal cities and lower level land.

It **can lead to** tsunamis, flooding in lots of areas around the world and that's gonna have a really really bad impact.

So, personally, I think climate change is a serious problem {and} that we need to **take radical action**, right now.

I go along with Greta Thunberg saying we need to **wake up to the reality** around us.

I don't really go along with the **skeptics** who don't believe it's a serious problem. I think it a problem and we need to take action.

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Q2. Why is the climate change important?

A2. Well. It's a very good question and I'd like to answer the question in two parts. First of all, I think it's important politically and I think it's important environmentally.

Firstly, politically, this is **an important agenda** on any prime minister or any president's **to-do-list;** looking at the impact of climate change around the world.

So, yes it's **hugely important** for countries and politicians, but more importantly, **moving on to the second point**, it's hugely important for our environment because we are destroying the environment around us.

We are **destroying habitats** through **the rise in the sea level**.

We are destroying habitats through **deforestation**, cutting down trees across the world **which in turn leads to** droughts, the growth of **arid land** which could no longer be used for farming

and droughts have a really, obviously, **negative impact** on populations, especially in tropical areas.

So, it's a hugely important issue **for all of humanity.**

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Q3. What can we do to stop climate change?

A3. Well, I think there is a number of things that we can do. First of all as countries we can **introduce policies** that will **prevent** for example, **deforestation**.

Policies that will encourage countries to **take positive actions towards** climate change,

but there is also things that **we as individuals** can do.

For starters, we can save energy at home, we **can be turning off** lights when we don't need them so we are using less electricity.

We can take public transport, so **reducing our carbon footprint,** so there are **fewer greenhouse gas emissions**.

We can also **vote with our feet** when it comes to **consumerism,**

and we can choose to buy **fewer clothes,** so that we are not pushed by the **fashion industry** to be consuming all of these **fabrics** that then are just **left as waste**

and are having a negative impact on the **balance of the ecosystem** as well.

So, I think both of these **areas we need to address** in order **to tackle climate change head on.**

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What are the solutions to Climate Change?

We can change the way we travel, **opting for public transport** and **avoiding travel** by plane whenever possible.

We can eat less meat, and so **reduce the demand** for **livestock** and **cattle**.

We can **shop locally**, so food **supply chains** do not need excessive travel by train, boat or plane.

By and large, we should **consume less**, whether it be for electrical appliances or clothes. We shouldn't be a victim of **fast fashion.**

We can also consume less electricity at home, by using **energy saving bulbs** and be more careful to turn off lights and save energy.

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Clothes

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General Vocabulary

Common mistakes!

The clothe I love is X
The cloth I like most is…. X

Clothes *(is always plural)*
Cloth refers to the material and is also used for materials used for cleaning

One **item of clothing** I love is 😄

One **piece of clothing** I love is 😄

I like to dress jeans X

I like to **wear jeans** 😄

I wear jeans, it is so comfy X

I wear jeans / trousers, **they are** so comfy 😄

My jeans / trousers (g.b.) /pants (u.s.) **are** comfy

Essential verbs

1. To **wear** clothes - (sounds like "WHERE"!)

To wear is irregular

I usually **wear** jeans and a T-shirt

Last week, I **wore** a suit - WAR!

I **have** never **worn** a tie before!

I tend to wear…

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2. To **dress** *(usually no object)*

I like **to dress** smartly / casually / neatly

I will **dress up** when going to a party
=dress smartly

To **get dressed**

I **got dressed** quickly

I **got** the children **dressed**

Phrasal Verbs

I haven't **worn** these new shoes **in** yet!
=to wear something new until comfortable

I have **worn** this jacket **out**, I need a new one
=used so much it can no longer be used

I am **worn out**
= I am tired!

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What kinds of clothes do you like to wear?

I like to wear short skirt X

I like to wear short skirt**s** 😄

I like to wear **a** short skirt 😄

I like to wear **smart** pants
(= clean and tidy)

You should use either the plural or use 'a'.

I **typically wear** jeans and a t-shirt / a hoodie / a sweatshirt / silk clothes

I like to look **dashing**
= *handsome/beautiful*

How to describe your favourite clothes - useful adjectives!

simple
casual
presentable
= *quite smart*

scruffy
= *messy, untidy*

willy-nilly
=*without care, a bit untidy*

stylish yet comfy
elegant

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chic
dressy

a conservative style
classic clothes
vintage clothes

semi-formal dresses / clothes

Dressed up to the nines
= *really smart/elegant*

Dressed to kill (for a woman)
= *really smart/elegant*

I am going to dress to impress!

bright / dark colours

baggy
= *very loose (too big)*

tight / clingy
= *(too small)*

fashionable
Clothes that are **in fashion**

I like to wear clothes in black <u>colour</u> X

When talking about colours in English, we rarely use the word 'colour'. Just use the actual colour!

I like to wear clothes **in black** 😄

I like to wear **black clothes** 😄

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The clothes I wear!

Watch the **video** and decide if the following are True or False - **T/F**

1. After work, I like to slip into a t-shirt
2. I love accessories
3. In the summer I wear a Panama hat
4. At work now, I have a dress code to follow
5. In my old job, I would wear slacks or chinos
6. I always wear tailor-made shirts
7. If I am going out to a restaurant, I usually go for the smart casual look

Useful Vocabulary from the video

After work, I like to **slip into** a t-shirt
=*change into…*

I prefer to wear polo shirts and shorts in the summer

I am not really one for **accessories**
=*jewellery, belts, bags, gloves, hats….*

I don't really wear chains and stuff

I do wear a cap in the autumn to **keep my head warm**

In the summer I wear a **Panama hat** because it **keeps the sun out of my eyes**

At work, we have **a dress code** to **follow**

We have to **wear business casual**

In my old job, I **would typically wear** a jacket

I would have to wear a shirt and tie with a jacket

I would wear slacks or chinos
=*smart trousers*

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I usually **put on** a jersey, a jumper, or a pullover (all the same)

I usually wear **off the peg** shirts, not **tailor-made** ones

I like **short-sleeved** shirts rather than **long-sleeved** ones

Snug as a rug
=fits perfectly

Fits like a glove
=fits perfectly

There wasn't a **strict** dress code

Many women **wore** business casual

The women would typically wear a **knee-length skirt** or slacks, a **blouse** and maybe flat shoes, rather than high heel shoes

If we are going out, I would probably **go for the** smart casual look

I may wear jeans, it depends on the mood, on the vibe

The video answers: 1.T 2.F 3.T 4.F 5. T 6. F 7. T

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Model Answers

Tip

In speech we often **repeat things, but with a slight difference.**

SPOKEN	WRITTEN
…and **it drives me around the bend**, and not only that, **not only does it drive me round the bend**, it really scares me.	…and **it drives me around the bend**, and not only that, it really scares me too.

If you write your answers out in perfect sentences, it will not sound natural, it will sound like you are a book!

Don't *write your answer out first,*

Speak *your answer first, then record it, then write it out.*

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Q1. Are clothes important to you?

A1.
It's a good question. I mean **on a basic level,** yes, of course clothes are important.
I need practical clothes, for example, if I am going out walking and it's raining, I need to wear **the appropriate kind of clothes.**

Maybe a rain coat, taking an umbrella, something that will **protect me from the rain.**

So, **from a practical point of view**, I think clothes are really important.

From a fashion point of view, I don't think they are that important.

I know some people say that clothes represent your identity and its a way of expressing your personality,

but to be honest, for me, **I take a much more pragmatic** *(=realistic)* **approach.**

I think clothes are just a way to cover ourselves and keep ourselves warm or keep ourselves cool.

I don't really see them as f**ashion accessories** or a way of expressing who I am, but that's just **my personal take** *(=personal opinion)* on clothes.

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Q2. Do you think clothes reflect a country's identity?

A2.

I'd say, you know, in this **modern age of globalisation**, I don't think it really does reflect a country's identity.

I think so many people now wear similar clothes, be it jeans or T-shirts, it's just everybody's wearing the same **garb**, *(=clothes)*

and even where people are changing the fashion, like **ripped jeans**, that **catches on** quickly and then again, young people across the world are wearing the same clothes.

So, no I don't think so it does.

That said, there is **one element** that is important and that's traditional clothes,

and many countries still use traditional clothes, especially for special events.

For example, **at a wedding** or **at a funeral** or some kind of family celebration, for example maybe in countries like India, they would wear a Saree *(=kind of Indian dress)* for certain events.

And in other countries there are the more kind of traditional clothes, but I think in a lot of countries **that tradition is dying out** and those clothes are disappearing

and you very rarely see them nowadays, **whether it's a good or a bad thing**. So overall, I don't think clothes reflect a country's identity.

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Q3. How do you think fashion trends have changed over time (from the 90's to today?)

A3.

I think fashion trends have changed **enormously** in the past 30, 40, 50 years, not just from the 90's, but even before that.

You know, I remember when I was young, back in the day, **flared jeans,** *(=bell-bottom jeans)* **flares**, were very popular, and shirts with really **long collars**, these huge, flying collars, they were fashionable,

as was long hair as well, especially for men,

but I think whilst jeans are still popular, flared jeans went in and out of fashion, and came back again, but now different kinds of jeans are fashionable, right?

Ripped jeans are **much more fashionable**, and shirts with slim-fit, small collars are also popular now, whereas in the past, they weren't that popular.

The **old-fashioned** kind of mini-skirts w**ent out of fashion** and then again **came in fashion**.

So, **it strikes me** *(=it seems to me / I think)* actually, that **fashion goes around its cycles** and it's not long before it **comes back into fashion.**

So, fashion has changed, but I'd say not **in a linear way,** but in a circular way, if I can say that.

Final notes:

You don't have to do a conclusion at the end of part 2 or 3 questions. If you can, that's great, but it is not necessary.

Your dress will have little influence on the examiner, you can wear casual clothes, but I recommend you are tidy, and presentable.

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Live Lesson Notes

Coeducation

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What you will learn:

Useful links
Essential vocabulary
Advantages of Mixed schools / Single-sex schools
Disadvantages of Mixed schools / Single-sex schools
Idioms
Model Answers

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Some useful Links

Watch this video where kids give their opinions about single-sex and coeducational schools

Single-sex or coeducational schools? Which is better?
https://theconversation.com/single-sex-vs-coeducational-schools-how-parents-can-decide-the-best-option-for-their-child-55758#

Arguments for and against coeducation
https://www.ourkids.net/school/together-or-apart

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of COEDUCATION, you will learn how to talk about the impacts of gender on education and education systems

Watch the complete video about this topic of coeducation

Warm up

These are the kind of questions on this topic of co-education that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

What are the pros of children being educated in a mix gender environment?

Why do some people prefer their children be educated in single sex school?

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Essential Vocabulary

*It is essential to build your vocabulary and also to start **activating** it.*

*That means you should try **making some phrases** with the vocabulary below.*

*Remember to always learn the **collocations** of new words.*

Coeducation (n.)
= *education system where boys and girls are taught together*

Coeducational (adj.) schools

A coed (adj.) school

A coed (n.) = a female at a coed college/university

Mixed (gender) schools

Single-sex schools (e.g. only boys school)

Separate schools (e.g. only girls school)

All boys school or all girls school

Pros = benefits = upsides = **advantages** = good points

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What are the pros of children being educated in a mix gender environment?

Equal opportunities (single-sex schools tend to be private and so more elitist and maybe only **available to** the rich)

They can learn essential **socialising skills**

Learn how to **interact with** each other

It reflects real life

It **prepares** them **for** real life

It gives them **a readiness for** real society

They can learn **collaboration** or **competition with** the other sex

What are the pros of children being educated in a single-sex school?

Sometimes single-sex schools get better academic results

But there is little evidence to **back this up** *(=to support it)*

Girls can be more expressive and **speak <u>up on</u>** topics they may not discuss if boys are around

Girls can be more **participative**, especially **<u>in</u>** science classes.

Students can be more **<u>focussed on</u>** their studies

Teenage students can concentrate better - especially **in times of** puberty

There may be fewer **discipline problems**

Boys are not **bound by** *(=limited by)* stereotypes - they can **excel in** *(=very good at)* music and art if they want

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What are the cons of children being educated in a coeducational school?

Classrooms can be full of distractions

Teachers my have low **expectations of** girls' performance due to **cognitive bias** *(=subconscious and subjective idea that influences your decisions)*

Girls may find their views are not respected or listened to

What are the cons of children being educated in a single-sex school?

Kids don't understand the other sex - or **have misunderstandings <u>about</u>** them.

They have less exposure to the **opposite sex,** and so may **lack confidence.**

These schools encourage the stereotypes that girls and boys are different and need to be treated differently -

Promotes **gender stereotyping - gender bias**

A **stereotype** = a generalisation e.g. all boys like blue (not pink)

Classes can be boring and **tedious**

The **bigger picture** may be that quality education doesn't depend on gender…it is more about the quality of the teachers, and teaching

and the **home setting** counts a lot too

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Idioms

I need to **put my thinking cap on** (= to think about something)

I've been **racking my brains** about this problem (=thinking hard)

That teacher was great, he didn't **spoon-feed** us, he made us think!

I am going to **hit the books** (=study)

I managed **to sail through** this test, it was so easy. (=to *pass* smoothly)

To sit a test = to take a test (as a student)

To pass = to succeed

I **passed** my test **with flying colours**

Model Answers

Q1: What is the future of co-education?

As I said earlier, I have been **mulling this over** *(=thinking a lot about it)* quite a lot recently, I think, coeducation is going to be **the dominant form of education** in the future.

I think without a doubt, most parents prefer their children to go through a co-educational school system.

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There are **clear benefits**, I think it's **a reflection of real life.** Students can learn to interact and socialise in real life, **essential interpersonal skills** that they need with the opposite gender,

and I think also the quality of teaching doesn't really **depend on the gender**; it depends on the teacher, that's one of the primary factors.

So, although, yeah, I think the coeducation will be the future, but that's said, it is clear that there are **a growing number of** private schools, in the private sector in many many countries,

because parents are unhappy with the state education system and a number of these private schools do choose **the single-sex model** and so I think they will continue to exist, but not as many as in coeducation.

Q2: What is the best education, single sex or co- ed? Give your opinion

Well, I think coeducation has a lot of benefits, clearly!

Students learn to interact with other students **of different gender**, so they build up their socialising skills, they **build up their confidence** and it's a reflection of the real working world they are going to live in, in the future .

That said, there is some research that says single-sex schools get better academic results but the research is not solid and some people argue, there is **not enough research to back that up.**

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I think there are some benefits to the single-sex schools. It allows the girls, for example, to **participate in** all different subjects **without any biased against them**.

It allows girls, or boys, to **talk freely** about subjects that otherwise, they may not talk about **in front of the other sex.**

So, it can build up their confidence and help them really **focus on their academic results** because there are **no distractions** there. So, it's a very good question.

All in all, I think that both of them are good systems, but in a way I think this question **misses the point.**

I think that what makes education better is not the gender, what makes an education system or school better is the quality of the teaching, and how values and skills, and confidence are built within the coeducation schools.

That is my opinion.

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Live Lesson Notes

Decision Making

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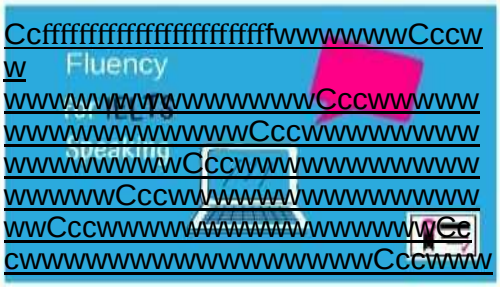

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful links
Warm up questions
Useful vocabulary
What decisions do people make every day?
Idioms to talk about decision making
Who is better at making decisions, children or adults?
Model Answers

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Useful Links

The paradox of choice
https://www.ted.com/talks/barry_schwartz_the_paradox_of_choice?language=en

3 ways to be a **better decision maker**
https://medium.com/mind-cafe/3-science-backed-ways-to-become-a-better-decision-maker-e61b95aaf2a7

How to be a **better decision maker**!
https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/how-to-be-a-better-decision-maker

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of Decision-making, you will learn how to talk about decisions, difficult decisions and how we make them.

Watch the complete video about this topic of the Decision-making here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of Decision-making that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Are you a decisive person?

What decisions do you find difficult to make?

What decisions do you make everyday?

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Useful vocabulary

Here is some useful language to talk about the IELTS Speaking topic of Decision Making.

To **decide** (v.)

e.g. I have decided to learn Japanese

A **decision** (n.)

Make a decision
Take a decision
Come to a decision
Arrive at a decision

I have made a decision to get married

Have you made a decision about/on your wedding venue yet?

I have come to a decision - I will have the wedding in the Hilton Hotel

Decisive (adj.)

Indecisive (adj.)

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Collocations:

- A **snap** decision (=quick)
- A **unanimous** decision (=everybody agrees)
- A **tough** decision (=difficult)
- A big / important decision
- A good / bad / bold wise decision
- A **rushed** / **hasty** decision

With 'decision' we can also use these adjectives

Vital / shrewd / straight forward / collective / conscious / controversial / strategic / bilateral / unilateral

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What decisions do people make every day?

People have to decide what to wear / eat / cook / think ….

We may have to consider which book to read / which film to watch / which chore to do first…

We face difficult/**tough choices**

We need to **weigh up the options** *(=evaluate the choices)*

We need to **weigh up the pros and cons**

You should **consider all the options**

There is so much **uncertainty**

We are **spoilt for choice** nowadays (=too many choices)

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Idioms to talk about decision making

I have **made up my mind =** *I have decided*

I am in two minds about this one = *I can't decide*

I am **at a crossroads =** *I have a difficult choice to make*

I am **in a** real **dilemma =** *I have a difficult choice and I don't know what to do*

I can't decide **for the life of me** = *it is very difficult to decide*

I have **had a change of heart =** *I have changed my mind*

We haven't decided yet, it's still **up in the air** = *It's undecided*

I am **sat on the fence**, I can't decide **=** *I haven't made a decision yet*

This is my final decision, **take it or leave it**! = *You have to accept it!*

Look before you leap = *think before you decide*

I will **cross that bridge when I get there** = *I will think about that consequence later, if it happens.*

Take the plunge = *to finally make a decision after thinking about it.*

I think he is going to **flip flop** again = *change his mind (suggests he frequently does it)*

You should **stick to your guns** = *stick to the decision you made, don't change!*

I am **between a rock and a hard place** = *I am in a difficult situation (where it is difficult to decide)*

I didn't need **to think twice**, I just chose this one. *(=think carefully)*

It's **Hobson's choice** = *there is no choice at all.*

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My wife says we can go anywhere on holiday, so long as she decides. That is **Hobson's choice!**

Don't put all your eggs in one basket = *diversify, don't risk everything on one thing.*

You should have several different investment plans, **don't put all your eggs in one basket**

Fish or cut bait = *stop wasting time and make a decision*

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Who is better at making decisions, children or adults? Why?

Here are some useful phrases to answer this question.

Children because they don't **fret** (=worry) about making mistakes

It **depends on** the situation and circumstances

Critical decisions are always taken by adults

Adults, because they are wiser and can **draw on a lifetime of experience**

Adults are more **pragmatic** when it comes to making decisions

Children never hesitate to decide because they never think about the **aftermath** *(=consequences)* of their decisions

Now consider the following phrases that we can also use.

Children are very **intuitive** *(=decide with feelings)*

They **follow their gut feeling** *(=decide with feelings)*

Children decide quickly, they don't **deliberate** *(=hesitate)*

Adults are more analytical

They weigh everything up *(= evaluate everything)*

They look at things **from all angles** *(=in many different ways)*

Adults overcomplicate/overthink things

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*These are useful phrases, but notice they are all **generalising**. For example, you are saying, 'all children are intuitive' but is this actually true?*

Is it always true for all children?

Probably not!

We can avoid over-generalising by adding a word or two to make this less direct and maybe also more polite.

Such as

- "can be"
- "tend to"
- "be more likely to"
- "might"

*This is a kind of **hedging**.*

Using hedging, makes your answers sound more natural, and less memorised!

Look at these examples where we make the above sentences less direct and more natural.

Children **can be** very intuitive
They **tend to** follow their gut feeling
Children **are more likely to** decide quickly, they don't deliberate

Adults **tend to** be are more analytical,
they **often** weigh everything up *(=assess everything),*
and **are more likely to** look at things from all angles
Adults might overcomplicate/overthink things

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Model Answers

Describe a decision you have made recently?

Well, a **decision that I made** recently is to do with a **purchase** that I made.

So, the **background to this is** basically, I have a website and in running the website, it uses different software to run smoothly, and I have been **toying with the idea of** *(=thinking about)* buying some special software to make the website quicker, to make it load more quickly.

And I **was in two minds about it,** because the software, I wasn't sure it was trustworthy and I wasn't sure if it was **good value for money**.

So as I often do, I am not really a very **intuitive decision maker**, right? I don't really **follow my gut**. I much prefer to do a bit of research, to kind of **weigh up the pros and the cons** of different things, I even write down sometimes, the good and the bad points. And then **having weighed everything up**, I will make a **final decision**; and sure enough, that's what I did here.

I did quite a bit research on the company and on the software. I looked at the reviews of other customers and then in the end I decided to go for it.

I took, in the end, I actually **took a snap decision**, although there was a

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lot of research behind it. And I chose to buy software and to run it and I am very happy with the purchase I made. It seems to work quite well and runs smoothly. So, yes that was a recent decision that I made.

Why do some people procrastinate?

I think it's just a case, **its just a matter of** some people being a bit lazy. Possibly. Some people are lazy and so they just find it easier **to put off decision making** rather than **making snap decisions**.

And I think sometimes **the root cause of that is** that they are afraid of the result. They are afraid of making mistakes.

If I choose 'A' what happens if it is **the wrong choice** and so they would much rather not decide and so they will just **sit around and procrastinate, deliberate,** and do anything to avoid making a decision.

For example, I know a lot of people who when it comes to online purchases they do that. Maybe they've had a bad experience when they bought something that wasn't good or **turned out to be** bad quality and so in future, they are **reluctant to make a choice**, because they are afraid they will **make the wrong choice**, they will **regret making that choice.**

So it's much easier to procrastinate in those kind of situations.

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Live Lesson Notes

Family 2

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These are the kind of QUESTIONS you might be asked in the test.

Part 3

Is family important in your country?
How are families today different from the past?
What role do grandparents play in families nowadays?

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Who should be responsible for care of the elderly?

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Is family important in your country?

*Note: 'Family' can be **both singular and plural,** depending on the emphasis you want to show.*

*As a **collective** noun, we tend to say '**family is** important', but if we want to emphasis the **individuals** in the family, we say '**family are** important.*

Read more about this here
https://blog.harwardcommunications.com/2017/02/07/the-family-is-or-the-family-are/

Yes, they are our flesh and blood

Family is a priority

Family is **really** crucial

Family plays a pivotal role in our lives

Our family instills certain values in us

Family bonds are important

Family help you get **through *thick*_and *thin*** (difficult

times) They can help you get **through the ups_and downs**

Your family will stand by you

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How are families today different from the past?

For this type of question you can use a 3 step approach - and show off 3 different tenses. It also helps you organise your ideas fluently

1. In the past, families **were** bigger

2. But things **have changed a** lot

3. Now, families **tend** to be smaller

1. Previously families **used to** live under the same roof
2. However, families **have gone through changes**
3. Now, they **tend** to live apart

1. In past times, families **were** close knit units
2. But things **have changed** somewhat
3. Nowadays families **are** not as close as they used to be

In terms of respect, they are different

In terms of the age of marriage they are different

In terms of family values there have been some changes

As far as incomes **are concerned,** more and more women have become **breadwinners**

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Young people are less **respectful** of older people

Demographics have changed

We typically have smaller **family units** these days

In days gone by, families used to bond more.

I'd say families are less **conservative** compared to the past

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What role do grandparents play in families nowadays?

Child carers
Babysitting
Mentors
Advisors
A bridge to tradition

They pass on traditions to the next generation

They have a role in helping their grandchildren have fun.

They share their wisdom

They can educate and pass on family values to their grandchildren

It is their duty to break the rules.

Sometimes they bring up their grandchildren

Some prefer to have a hands-off role

Some are very hands-on

They tend to spoil grandchildren

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Who should be responsible for care of the elderly?

Family
Grandchildren
Friends
Community
The government

It’s sometimes difficult for the children, as they may have work commitments too

Elderly thrive better when cared for by people who love them

The responsibility should lie with…

It’s really up to…

To my mind, it’s the job of….

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Family

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[IELTS Speaking Success - Get a Band 7+]

These are the kinds of QUESTIONS you might be asked in the test.

Part 1

Do you spend much time with your family?
Do you prefer spending time with your family or your friends?

Part 2

Describe a leisure activity that you do with your family

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Part 3

Is family important in your country?
How are families today different from the past?
What role do grandparents play in families nowadays?
Who should be responsible for care of the elderly?

Some useful Links

Interesting post about why family time is important
https://www.aha-now.com/why-family-time-is-important/

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VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS

Introducing your family

There are 3 of us

I have 2 siblings, an elder brother and elder sister

I am an only child

My close family (my partner and children)

My direct or immediate family (parents, grandparents, siblings, children)

My extended family (my direct family plus uncles, aunties, and cousins, as well as in-laws).

I met my wife / husband / partner / spouse…

I **was working** in Spain **at the time,**
I **had been working there** for several years
We **met** in my calligraphy class

Nice way to use three tenses in a short anecdote

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Ages and Stages of Life

Stage and Age (approx)	Useful expressions and phrases		
Baby 0 -18 mnths	She eats, cries and sleeps	She takes after her mother (looks like)	
Toddler 2-4 yrs Infant 2 - 5 yrs	She is so stroppy / bolshy. (demanding and annoying). He is a bundle of joy (great fun to be with)	He absorbs everything like a sponge. He picks things up quickly (learns quickly).	She's at the terrible twos stage
Child 4-12 yrs	He throws tantrums (get angry). Have an outburst. They pester their parents (annoy parents by asking for things)	She's a barrel of fun	He's the apple of my eye (I love him)
Teenager 13 - 18 yrs	She's in that rebellious stage	They are going through puberty, and hormonal changes.	
Young adult 18 - 30 yrs	They come of age (become an adult). He is irresponsible	She's all over the place (can't find her direction in life)	She's all grown up. They have grown wings - they are leaving the nest.
Middle aged 40-60 yrs	He's going through a mid-life crisis	She's getting on. (she's getting older) He's over the hill. (too old)	
Old aged / Elderly 70+	He's doing well for his age	She'll live to a ripe old age. He's a silver surfer (an elderly person who like to use the Internet)	

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Do you spend much time with your family?

Yes, I do.

Note: It's really natural English to answer this question with 'Yes, I do' / 'No, I don't'. Rather than just 'yes' or 'no'.

I like to **spend quality time** with them

During this lockdown period, I am **with them24/7**

No, I don't

Note: You don't want to just say 'no'. Start to develop your answers. For example…

I **am miles away** from them actually, due to the lockdown.

I work in a different city, so **I don't get to see t**hem much

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Do you prefer spending time with your family or your friends?

It depends, if I am going to a bar, **then** I'd like to hang out with friends, **but if I am** going to see a movie, **I'd rather** go with family

I don't spend as much as time with my family **as I should**, because I live abroad, but I would like to see them more frequently

I like both equally, I tend to spend an equal amount of time with both friends and family

Probably more with my family, I think **blood is thicker than water**

IDIOMS

Like father, like son

It runs in the family
Blonde hair runs in the family. Artistic talent runs in the family.

I followed in my Dad's footsteps
I took over my Dad's business and followed in his footsteps.

Blood is thicker than water (= Family is more important than friends)

She's the breadwinner (= She earns the money)
My mother is the breadwinner in our family

She brings home the bacon (= She earns the money)

The black sheep of the family (the naughty / bad one in the family)

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Live Lesson Notes

Festivals

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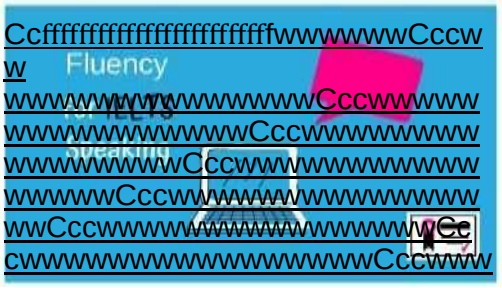

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Warm up questions
Useful vocabulary
What is your favourite festival?
How do you celebrate?
Idioms to talk about festivals
Model Answers
Useful links

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Useful Links

My Present to you - **Free Online Course**
Crack IELTS Speaking Part 1
https://keithspeakingacademy.com/crack-ielts-speaking-part-1/

Find out about interesting **festivals across the world**
https://www.audleytravel.com/blog/2011/september/top-festivals-around-the-world

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of Festivals, you will learn how to talk about your favourite festival and how you celebrate it.

Watch the complete video about this topic of Festivals here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of Festivals that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

What is your favourite festival?

How do you celebrate this festival?

Should festivals adapt with the times?

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Useful vocabulary

Here is some useful language to talk about the IELTS Speaking topic of Festivals

Festival (n.) = celebration of a special event (often religious)

Festival (n.) = a series of events, (music, film, drama)

The festival **is held in** Germany **in** August
This festival **takes place ___**
It **commemorates** the birth of Christ
It celebrates the

Festive (adj.)

A festive occasion
To be **in** a festive **mood**
The festive season
Festive decorations

Festivities (n.) (Plural) = celebrations

I hope you enjoy the festivities
The festivities go on for days

Feast (n.) = a big meal

I love Christmas dinner, it is an absolute feast

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What is your favourite festival?

Festivals Around The World that you told me you celebrate:

- **Eid Al-Fitr** / **Eid Al-Adha** (many countries)
- **Diwali** in India
- **Tết** Vietnam
- **Pôhela Boishakh** Bangladesh
- **Semana Santa**, (many Spanish-speaking countries)
- **Dia de los Muertos**, Mexico
- **Sinulog** Philippines
- **Carnival** (Brasil)
- **Chinese New Year**
- **Holi**, Rajasthan, India
- **Songkran Festival**, Thailand
- **Christmas** (many countries)
- **Festival of Lanterns,** Japan

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How do you celebrate?

Here are some useful phrases you can use to answer this question

We **celebrate** by eat**ing** _____

It's **a tradition (n.) to** eat _____

It's **traditional** (adj.) to eat _____

*When describing **food**, you can use these adjectives.*

- lavish
- amazing
- tasty
- delicious

We like to eat **local delicacies** *(=special food from that area)*

*Synonyms of '**eat**'*

We like to_____local delicacies

- Pig out on
- Devour
- Enjoy
- Sample

*Festivals usually involve people **coming together** to celebrate. Here are some phrases we can use for this.*

- We have a family gathering
- The family gets together
- We have a get-together with family and friends

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*In order to describe the **reason** for a festival, you could say,*

- **It's a chance to** remember _____
- It's a chance to show gratitude *(=to be thankful)*
- It's a chance to share happiness and joy
- **It's an opportunity to** visit relatives / the extended family
- **It's a nice occasion for us to** exchange gifts

There are / is …

- (Street) Parades
- Processions
- Floats in the street (trucks that carry things)
- Dancing in the street (N.B. not street dancers!)

Some festivals involve throwing things, from water or colourful powders, to tomatoes or even money.
*Notice how we use the verb '**throw**.*

We **throw** snowballs **at** each other *(the intention is to hit someone)*

We **throw** balls **to** each other *(the intention is for the other person to catch it)*

To describe the atmosphere, we can talk about…

- There's a real **party atmosphere**
- There's **a feeling of fun**
- There's **an ambience of** peace and love

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Festivals - Are they a waste of time?

YES

Many festivals have become **over-commercialised / highly commercialised**

We have forgot **the origin of the festival**

We neglect *(=pay no attention to)* the real meaning behind the celebration

NO

That said, it's a **great chance to** relax and **catch up with** extended family and friends

It gives us a break from the mundane routine

Festivals play a vital role in **passing down / on** our traditions to our children

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Idioms to talk about Festivals

The following all mean to have a good time

I usually **have a ball** at this festival, throwing water at everyone!

I **have a whale of a time** at Christmas

I **had the time of my life** at the last Holi festival

Here are some more useful idioms you could use when discussing this topic.

This festival is **as old as the hills** = *very old*

The family dinner is really something to **feast your eyes on**! = *makes you happy to look at it.*

Uncle Tom is always **the life and soul of the party** at New Year's **=** *the most active person at a party*

I spend so much money on presents and organising the parties, but I need to be careful not **to break the bank** = *spend too much*

The festivities **went like a dream** = *go smoothly*

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Model Answers

What don’t you like about celebrating a particular festival?

I am gonna talk about Christmas because on the one hand, I love **celebrating Christmas but it is a festival that** has certain aspects that **I am not particularly fond of.**

I guess it’s to do with the **over-commercialisation** of Christmas.

That we’ve moved from **celebrating** the birth of Christ to **the obsession with the gift-giving**.

Now, I understand that gift-giving is **a way to commemorate** the three wise men who gave gifts and presents to baby Jesus, but it seems like **we’ve swung too far** and now we focus too much on giving gifts

and what’s more, it’s really hard to find an imaginative and special gift for your family and friends because me, **for me personally,** it’s really hard to choose gifts for those people

and **we often end up** buying the same kind of gifts, socks, woolly jumpers, scarves and hats, because of course we celebrate in winter.

So often the same gifts, and it doesn’t seem to be **as meaningful as it used to be when I was a child**

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Describe the most impressive festival in your country

Well, **it's hard to say** exactly which is the most impressive festival because of course, there are, like many countries, **a myriad of different festivals that we celebrate** in the UK.

If I were to choose one, I think, **I would opt for** bonfire night.

So, bonfire night **is celebrated on** the fifth of November. It's a **nationwide celebration** and **it dates back to** several hundred years ago when somebody tried to blow up the houses of parliament and destroy the democratic processes in our country.

So **we celebrate the fact that** they failed to do that and, so what we do is, **the way we celebrate is,** people like to set bonfires or little fires in their garden in the evening and **the family gather around** the fire to keep warm.

There's lots of **local delicacies**, you know, **lavish feasts** and cuisines that we enjoy.

I remember when I was a child, we had black beans soup, we had roast potatoes, jacket potatoes, toffee apples…so **sweet and savoury delicacies** which were really delicious.

I guess on top of that, we also make effigies. So **there would be some**

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processions around the streets where we would carry our effigies of the person who tried to blow up the houses of parliament.

His name was Guy, Guy Fawkes, and we can carry the effigy around and then we throw it on top of the bonfire which is, **when you think about it,** it's quite horrific with burning this person, but **it's a symbol I guess**, to remember the victory against what that person tried to do.

I think, I think it's the most impressive festival because the lights, and the colour and the fire and the fireworks, which we also have just **give a whole an ambience of excitement** and you know, **you're on the edge of your seat** like the whole evening and the colours are just fantastic.

So for me, that's probably the most impressive festival in my country.

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How have festivals changed recently?

That's a very interesting question, and I haven't thought about it, to be honest. Let me think.

I think, on the one hand, festivals haven't changed that much because **they represent tradition** and we like to, you know, **pass down these cultural values** to our children

and so we like to **preserve the tradition** and keep festivals very much as they were a hundred years ago.

But on the other hand, there are, I think many **festivals have changed with the times**, and have adapted **in a positive wa**y, and sometimes **in a negative way**, to the modern times.

For me, a positive way is that **they have been updated** and **made relevant to young people.**

So maybe for example, at the Christmas mass at church we have lots of singing and guitars, and rock music which makes it relevant to a lot of young people but the message is still there.

I suppose, in a negative way, **as I mentioned earlier** in the test, the **over-commercialisation of festivals** like Christmas and Easter where people are just spending so much money, it's become a business.

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We fork out lots of money *(=spend a lot of money)* on things that we don't really need to celebrate but it's good for the economy, it's good for businesses, so long as we don't forget the **real spirit of the festival.**

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Fluency Secrets

1. Shut up!
2. Weak forms
3. Use ‘Chunks’
4. Repetition
5. Flexibility
6. Level -1
7. Give ‘Signposts’

Learning is not information

Learning is <u>skill development!</u>

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Information is the tip of the iceberg

It's the map, the backpack, the equipment and clothing….

…you then need to start climbing

If you read a book by Ronaldo on football, would you play football as well as him?

Why do people take 1 year to get promoted? Why don't they get promoted after reading a management book?

You need to practice so you can develop the skill.

Also finding and having **passion**, **interest**, **enjoyment** or just **fun** is important to improve your English.

The ideas below will give you some ideas about how to practice and improve your fluency.

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1. Shut up!!

AVOID Hesitation

USE Pauses

So before you begin an answer, take a second or two to think and get your first idea or phrase in your head.

Then start speaking.

You can pause, that is fine.

Even native speakers pause.

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2. Weak forms

How do we pronounce these words?

For
To
Do
Are
You

Usually we do not stress these words and so we use the ‘weak’ form; as follows

For	**/fə /**
To	**/tə /**
Do	**/də /**
Are	**/ə /**
You	**/jə /**

Examples:

For me personally, I like…

I want **to** visit Paris

Do we have any cake?

There **are** lots of …

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As **you** know, …

3. Chunks

A **chunk** is a **piece** of something.

For example, a chunk of bread is just a piece of bread.

A chunk of language is a **sound**, usually two or three words said together as one piece.

So instead of saying "I am into_____" as 3 words, we chunk these three words into one sound 'aminto', and we say 2 sounds

'**aminto_____**'

So 'I am into painting' is said '**aminto painting**'

Chunking common phrases like this can help our fluency enormously.

More examples

amfondof

Instead of thinking of 4 words, we think of one sound.

I am fond of_____ / amfondof _____

amfondof cooking / art / basketball….

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We can also chunk common, everyday phrases like these.

It is a great idea = itsagreatidea

I would love to = idloveto

When making notes, it may help you to write the chunk as one word.

You can even imagine it as a name (because names are usually one sound)

…my name is Mr. Idloveto 😁

Phrasal verbs

Phrasal verbs are great for chunking.

Try saying these as ONE sound.

get_upearly
wakeupealry
stickatit

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Grammar

We can also chunk most basic grammar structures or tenses

It is a = itsa = itsƏ

There are some good restaurants - thereƏ some…

In the past, **we used to**…

Now, **there's been a** big / dramatic / huge change.

Today….**we tend to**…

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4. Repetition

Fluency is all about practice. Repetition is a great place to start your practice. Later you can also practice conversation with a speaking partner.

First, you can practice repeating the phrases we saw above

aminto painting / cooking / football

amfondof singing / walking / travelling

Continue doing this with lots of other simple chunks, for example.

I want to _____
I like to _____
I tend to _____
I used to _____

There are lots of _____

You can continue practicing with the following audio clips in this article about confidence.

https://ieltsspeakingsuccess.com/ielts-speaking/speak-english-confidently-ielts-speaking-test/

Go to the first part titled 'Start Easy'

Listen to the first sentence of the audio.
Repeat, saying chunks rather than individual words.
Change one of the words, and keep practicing.

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5. Flexibility

After doing lots of repetition, you then need to also practice using the chunks to say things **that are true.**

This engages the brain and moves from automatic pilot to '**thinking person**'.

As you practice this, you also build flexibility and you will be able to talk about you and your life flexibly, not just repeating memorised phrases.

For example,

Repetition

<u>I tend to get up</u> at 7am / 8am / 9am

The truth

I tend to get up at 7:30, actually.

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6. Level -1.

Level minus 1 is a level just below your actual level.

If you try to practice speaking using language above your level, you will not develop your fluency.

You will just get frustrated.

You need to do some practice where you practice speaking at a level just below your level.

Try saying using language that is just below your level.

So, imagine a Band 5 saying this…

My hometown is a huge metropolis
where there is a myriad of fine-dining restaurants and luxury shops.
Tourists tend to go to the world-famous museums that are spread across the city

This kind of language is really above a band 5 level, so this student would NOT improve their fluency if they are always trying to speak like this, using this language.

They will end up frustrated.

In order to build fluency, they should do more practice at a lower level, for example,

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My hometown is a big city
where there are lots of restaurants and shops.
Tourists tend to go to the museums

And use weak forms and chunking.

My hometown's a_big city
*where **there ə lots of** restaurants_ən shops.*
*Tourists **tend tə go tə** the museums*

Notice the chunks.

Of course, this band 5 student should continue to try and learn more complex vocabulary and grammar, but a large part of their speaking practice should be at a lower level, in order to build fluency and confidence.

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7. Signposts

A key part of **fluency** in IELTS Speaking is **Coherence** - *this is how you connect your ideas, your sentences and phrases.*

We can and should use spoken **connectors** to do this.

Some spoken connectors just tell the listener (the examiner) what we are going to say, I call these '**signposts'.**

They add logic and coherence to our answer and so boost your fluency score.

You can make good use of signposts, especially on part 2 and 3.

Here are some examples, notice how you can chunk them and say them as **one sound**, not as individual words.

Talking about young people….I think…

As far as young people go, I think…

Firstly, I'd say…

By and large, I think….

I'm going to tell you about…

All in all, ….

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Live Lesson Notes

Food

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Riddle
A lemon went to the doctor because it was sick, what did the doctor prescribe?
Answer: Lemon-aid

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Some Recommended Books

5 Ingredients
Jamie Oliver (Penguin)

The China Study
T. Colin Campbell (BenBella Books)

Salt Fat Acid Heat
Samin Nosrat (Canongate Books)

In Defense of Food
Michael Pollan (Penguin)

Some useful Links

Harvard School of Public Health
https://www.hsph.harvard.edu/nutritionsource/healthy-eating-plate/

My Blog on Healthy Eating
https://seriouslyfunfood.com

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Essential Vocabulary

This dish is delicious,…..

tasty,

luscious,

mouthwatering,

tempting,

appetising,

scrummy

succulent (for meat)

It’s spot on

It’s perfect

Yummy? - Don’t use this in IELTS, it is a word normally used by children!

Nutritious (adj.)

Nutrition (n.) (uncountable)

Nutrient (n.) (countable)

Obese (adj.) = medically over-weight

Obesity (n.)

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What are the main macronutrients?

Carbs (Carbohydrates)

Good (unrefined / unprocessed) - whole grains, veggies/veg, fruits

Bad (refined / processed) - white rice / bread / pasta

Carbs also include….

Sugars - Glucose (essential for energy)
Fibre - beans, legumes, pulses

Protein - fish, legumes, meat, nuts

Fat - oils (saturated and unsaturated)

Micronutrients:

Vitamins

Minerals

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Do you eat healthy food? Why?

Yes, but not always, I like to **have a cheat day** once a week, where I can **pig out** on anything I like.

To pig out (*informal*) = to eat a lot of something

To eat the rainbow
= eat food of all different colours

Eat your **five a day** (5 portions of fruit and veg).

This was a government campaign in the U.K. to r**aise awareness** of the importance of **healthy eating**

To **go on a diet**

Have you ever been **on a diet?**

I have been on **a low-carb diet** for a few months.

I **follow** the Keto **diet** / the mediterranean diet

I strive (=try) to **eat everything in moderation**

I think I eat **a balanced diet**

I am a **vegetarian**

I have been a **vegan** for years now.

A **fruitarian** (only eats fruit)

A **flexitarian** (mostly vegetarian, but may eat some meat)

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What food do you like?

I love / adore__fish and chips___

I am rather **partial to** ____

I am **fond of** ____

I tend to eat _____

Pronounced "I tend to_(w) eat_____"

I tend **to avoid** _____

Pronounced "I tend to_ (w) avoid_____"

I veer_**away from** _____

I like Chinese **cuisine**

I love Indian **dishes**

I like Italian **food**

My favourite dish is _____

My child is a **fussy eater** or a **picky eater**
This means the only eat the food they like and won't try new foods

I am a **binge eater**

I am guilty of **binge-eating**

This means I eat lots of food in one go, and often I cannot stop. In extreme cases, this is a medical condition.

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Do you cook?

I am fond of cooking

I love to cook, my **signature dish** is _____

I **dabble in** cooking every now and again

I like **to rustle up** a pizza
(=to make quickly)

I like to **rustle** something **up** in the kitchen

I like to **whip** something **up** in the kitchen

I usually **follow recipes**

I prefer to **play it by ear** = improvise (no plan)

Or I like to **wing it** = improvise (no plan)

I often make it up as I go along

I love to improvise when it comes to cooking

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Live Lesson Notes

Generation Gap

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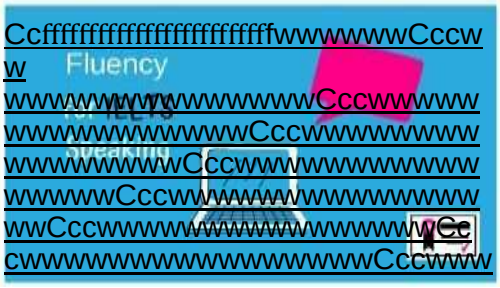

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful links
Warm up questions
Useful vocabulary
What causes the generation gap?
How can the generation gap be bridged?
Idioms to talk about young and old people
Model Answers

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Useful Links

Information about the **different generations**
https://medium.com/datadriveninvestor/who-are-boomers-gen-x-gen-y-and-gen-z-d1784f02d25d

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of the Generation Gap, you will learn how to talk about how children and old people behave, the relationship between them

Watch the complete video about this topic of the Generation Gap here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of Generation Ga that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Should children obey their parents?

Do grandparents look after children?

How should naughty children be punished?

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Related topics

Behaviour
A child who behaved badly

Games
A game/toy when you were a child

Mobile phones / apps
Should children have / use them?

A person who is open
Are children or adults more open?

Friends
Stay in touch with childhood friends?

Family
Should children obey their parents?
Do grandparents look after children?
How are the young generation different from their parents/ grandparents?

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Useful vocabulary

The **younger generation**

Toddlers (2-3),
T**een**agers (13-17),
Adolescents,
Young adults
Millennials (born between 1980-2000)

The **older generation**

A **generation gap**

= The differences in opinions (actions and beliefs) between one generation and another

Bridge the generation gap

Adjectives to describe "good" children

- well-behaved
- well-mannered
- well-brought up

Other positive characteristics

Full of energy/ impulsive/ creative/ gregarious/ sharp/ curious/ mysterious/ scholarly/ smart/ hardworking/ possessive/

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Adjectives to describe "naughty" children

- badly-behaved
- disobedient
- mischievous
- wayward
- defiant

Other Negative Characteristics

- black sheep
- noisy
- argumentative
- selfish
- picky

Other expressions about naughty children

I was **the black sheep of the family**
= *I was the naughty one in our family*

Be **a nuisance**
=*be a pain, naughty*

They **make a nuisance** of themselves

I used to **get up to no good**
=*do naughty things, or things I shouldn't do*

Play tricks on someone

To **tease** somebody
= *to make fun of them, and try to make them angry*

I **got into trouble**

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What causes the generation gap?

The gap is **due to _____**
The gap is **down to _____**
The gap arises **because of_____**

New **technologies**
The **development of technology**
Prevailing social media

By and large = In many cases = Generally speaking….

- Children prefer texting and communicating via social media

- Their parents may prefer making a phone call or **one-on-one interaction** and **face-to-face conversations**

Globalisation
Rapid changes in society
Changing cultures
Changes in out lifestyles

- Younger generations may travel more and gather (=*get)* different views

- We also have the Influence of different cultures, for example,

some young Brits **are into** Sushi
some young Chinese **are into** Starbucks coffee

Adolescence / Identity

Conflict arises because_____

- Teenagers are struggling to **carve out** (=find) their identity

- They are **going through a transition** stage
- They often **rebel against** their parents' values

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A lack of interaction
Differences of opinions

- Parents busy themselves with work and ignore their kids
- Kids are absorbed by their phones and don't pay heed to their parents

How can the generation gap be bridged?

Pass **down** (to give) values to the next generation

Accept the world has changed, for example,

- Men are no longer the **sole** (=only) bread winners

- Girls can become scientists

Find common ground (things to do together, to discuss together)

Communicate and teach each other

Build stronger **family bonds**

Spend time **with** each other

Have **mutual respect** and more interaction **with** each other

Actively listen to each other

Put your self into each other's shoes

Share ideas

Share hobbies

Give space to others and freedom to be who they are

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Idioms to talk about young and old people

Watch the video of Stan the Man and see if you can spot these idiomatic expressions

Back in my day *(=when I was young)*

At school, we used to **play tricks on** some of the teachers *(=do naughty things)*

There was **hell to pay**
(= someone was angry and you were in big trouble)

If my father found out, I'd **be in deep trouble** *(=a lot of trouble)*

If I got **in** my father's **bad books** *(=if I got into trouble with him)*

He would **come down on me like a ton of bricks** *(=punish me harshly)*

If my mother found out, I'd really **be in the dog house** *(= in big trouble)*

These **snowflakes;** they get everything they want *(=millennials)*

Nowadays - kids **are spoilt rotten** *(=spoilt too much)*

Tell them to behave and **it falls on deaf ears** *(=they ignore it = they pay no heed to it)*

They don't **pay the blindest bit of notice** *(=they totally ignore it)*

We need to **pass down** our values *(=give to our children)*

Anyway, that's **my take on** the Generation Gap *(=my opinion about …)*

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Model Answers

How is your generation different from your parent's generation?

A.

First of all, my parents **grew up** during the war, the Second World War, so **they grew up in** very, very **frugal times**, where they had to be careful with money, food, clothes, **nothing went to waste.**

They would be very careful how they spent their money, and so this, these values of being cautious, careful, and **thrifty**, are values that maybe they tried to **pass down to my generation**, but my generation were less thrifty and I think we were, I was growing up in a time in the early 1970s and 1980s where **there was more affluence** in my country and we were spending more money and we had a more **rebellious attitude** to everything.

So, I think, **generally speaking**, my generation is more rebellious and less cautious than my parents' generation.

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Describe a time when you saw a child behaving badly in public

A.

This was actually last summer, when I saw a young boy, he **must have been about** 10 years old, playing with his friends but he was **bullying** his friends. It was in the summer time, did I say that, it was in the summer! It was last year,

(Note from Keith: when you make things up, don't change things!!)

and so we were, actually, I was out with my wife, we were **sat outside** at a bar having a drink and the children were playing around in that area, and the parents were **close by**, and I noticed this young boy who was **ordering** the other boys **around**.

He was pushing them a bit and **shouting at** them and clearly **intimidating** them, **against their will**, to do some things.

And I think I had **to draw the line**, when I saw him hitting one of the other boys and **I just lent over to the parents** and said, because I realised they were from the same family, I said, 'have you noticed what they are doing and how they are playing'? The father immediately stood up and was very angry, not with me but with his son, and he went over and **told his son off,** and **that was the end of that**.

But I felt that I had to say something, but it's very difficult situation because you don't want to **interfere with other people's business** and

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how they run their families, but I sensed that they weren’t aware of what

was happening and so yeah I decided to say something.

That was a time when I saw a child **behaving mischievously** in a public place.

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Study with me

Globalisation

Part 3

These are the kind of questions you might asked on this topic.

How has globalisation affected your city?

What do you think about the effect of globalisation on business?

What are the advantages and disadvantages of globalisation?

Some useful Links

What is globalisation?
https://youtu.be/JJ0nFD19eT8

Find out more about Explain Like I am 5 years old (ELI5)
https://www.reddit.com/r/explainlikeimfive/

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Glocalisation in action with the "American Idol" style shows; one in Afghanistan, and one in the United Arab Emirates.
https://www.ted.com/talks/cynthia_schneider_the_surprising_spread_of_idol_tv?referrer=playlist-pop_culture_obsessions

VOCABULARY AND COLLOCATIONS

Developed countries OR Developed economies

Developing economies OR Developing countries

OR **Emerging economies**

Emerging economies are often defined as having a relatively low Human Development Index (HDI)

Developed countries are often defined as having a higher Gross Domestic Product per capita (GDP)

BRICS - **a term coined** to refer to 5 major developing economies; Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa.

This term is used less frequently nowadays, as it seems China and India are the only two to have made **huge economic growth**.

Economy (n.) - Economical (adj.)

Notice the change in stress

Globalisation is **old as the hills**

Collocations with 'global'

Global trade
Global economy
Global village
Global warming
Global governance
Global cooperation
Global stage

A **high standard of living**
A **high cost of living**

Prosperity (wealth)

Immigration = movement of people into a foreign country
Emigration = movement of people out of their own country

Convergence = standardisation

Cultural convergence

A loss of **cultural identity**

Glocalisation = the combination of Global and Local.

Typically this is a global product or service that is then localised to local needs, taste or culture.

International Coordination

Their **hands are tied** (=they have limited power)

We often refer a wide group of key governments around the world as the **‘International Community’**

The following organisations are often included in the ‘International Community’

WHO
UN
WTO
UNICEF
IMF
World Bank

How has globalisation affected your city?

There has been an **influx** of tourists

We are **governed by** European Law

We can eat **international cuisine**

There are thriving **minority communities** in my city *(Chinese, Vietnamese, Peruvian…)*

It has **modified our lifestyle,** we can but products from **across the world**

It has led to **increased job opportunities**

Or maybe…

It has led to **increased unemployment**

We tend to buy **imported products,** so local businesses have suffered.

What do you think about the effect of globalisation on business?

You can talk about a variety of businesses or industries here, including,

music industry / business
food industry / business
film industry / business

Many jobs have been **outsourced (gone abroad)**, so unemployment has risen

There has been a rise in the number of **multinational companies.**

Advances in technology have made it easier for companies to **operate internationally**. For example, it is easy to have video-conferences with colleagues in other countries.

Access to information across the Internet has made it easier for **brands** to **market their products** across he globe.

What are the advantages of globalisation?

Convenience of eating foods - listening to music - getting news - buying products **from around the world**

Ability to **learn** more about each other and so promote peace. For example we can connect via online platforms and talk with each other

We can travel and explore new countries **at the drop of a hat** (=instantly, immediately)

Businesses can **take advantage** of international markets, and economies can grow, leading to a **rise** in the **standard of living** for many people

What are the advantages and disadvantages of globalisation?

Negative impact on **local** food industry - culture -employment

Ecological impact (e.g. carbon emissions from planes)

Local traditions may disappear

We lose our **individuality**

The **divide** between rich and poor gets bigger

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Live Lesson Notes

Happiness

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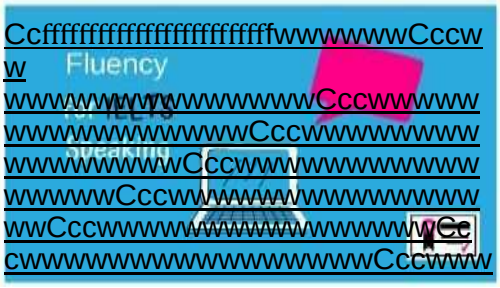

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful vocabulary
Collocations
What is happiness?
Idioms
What makes you happy?
Are younger people happier than older people?
Model Answers

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Useful Links

Measuring happiness
https://www.thehappycfo.it/433744673

The happiest man on earth

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of Happiness, you will learn collocations and idioms to talk confidently about happiness and what it means to you.

Watch the complete video about this topic of the Happiness here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of Happiness that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

What is happiness?

What makes you happy?

Are younger people happier than older people?

Are the things that make us happy now, different from years ago?

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Useful vocabulary

Here is some useful language to talk about the IELTS Speaking topic of Happiness. Notice the 'grammar' of these words, how they are used, and what prepositions can be used.

I am happy that you came to visit

She was such a happy baby, always smiling!

I am happy to be here

Happy with the answer

Happy for you (somebody)

Happy about that

Find a **synonym** of HAPPY in thissentence

I **am_____that you came to visit**

Here 'happy' describes a feeling of happiness. So we can use the following words as synonyms.

Glad
Elated = *very happy*
Thrilled = *extremely happy*
Delighted
Pleased
Content

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Find a **synonym** of HAPPY in this sentence

She was such a_____baby, always smiling!

Here 'happy' is an adjective to describe a person or thing with the qualities of happiness. So we can use these words.

Cheerful
Jolly
Joyful
Jovial
Happy-go-lucky
Pleasant

Collocations:

A happy marriage / memory / childhood / occasion

Happy with the answer
Happy for you
Happy about that

A happy coincidence

To find true happiness
Be blissfully happy

A happy meal (at MacDonald's)

Happy hour (in a bar when drinks are cheaper for a limited time)

Happy Christmas!

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What is happiness?

We could approach this answer in 2 ways. Firstly giving a definition of happiness, like from a dictionary. Secondly, by giving a more personal interpretation of what it means to us.

1. If we are talking about a definition, happiness…

…**is an emotional, physical,** and **mental** state of well-being

…**is** a feeling of **deep satisfaction** in life

…**is something we achieve by** having a purpose and a sense of meaning in life

2. Personally, for me, happiness is…

…Be**ing** healthy
…Be**ing** grateful
…Hav**ing** good friends
…Hav**ing** a day off work
…Achievi**ng** our goals

…**When** I pass my exams
…**When** I am cooking
…**When** I get a lovely present
…**When** my kids are happy
…**when** we are satisfied with our lives
…**when** you have peace of mind

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Happiness is difficult to define

It's **hard to put your finger on it** *(= hard to identify or to express/say)*

Everyone **sees it**

differently It depends on

each person

It's also interesting to consider (and talk about) whether happiness is something we feel automatically, something we choose, or something we have to work on and train.

Is it a state?

Is it a choice?

Is it a skill?

In this video a French buddhist talks about the need to train happiness.

Idioms about happiness

Watch the video with Stan the Man and spot the idioms!

To be **tickled pink** = very happy

I would be tickled pink, if I won the lottery

To be **over the moon**

She was over the moon when she passed her test.

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To be **on top of the world**

I am on top of the world when I am teaching

To **be pure bliss** = it's heaven!

Strolling in the park, smelling the flowers is pure bliss!

To **be on a high** = to be very happy / elated

To **have a whale of a time** = to have a great time

I had a whale of a time at your party yesterday

To **be in your element** = *to do something you really enjoy/like*

*I like dancing, I am really **in my element** on the dance floor*

What makes you tick? = What makes you happy?

To be as happy as the day is long = *to be very happy*

To walk on air = to be very happy

*I am **walking on air** when I listen to Pavarotti sing.*

It was music to my ears = it made me very happy

*When I heard I got a Band 8, **it was music to my ears!***

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Are younger people happier than older people? Why?

It **depends on the situation** they are **facing**

It depends on the **mindset** of each person

It **varies from person to person**

Maybe youngsters have more pressure from social media, exam pressure, even cyber-bullying, and so this **brings them down** *(=makes them sad).*

I believe youngsters **have less on their minds**, and so tend to be happier.

Yeah, health-wise definitely, youngsters are happier.

It's possible that older people are more **happy-go-lucky**, they don't care what others think of them, so they **are more inclined to be** content.

I think old people are happier than youngsters, as they aren't worried about their career, education, and job.

No, not at all, **quite the opposite**. I think old people are **more content** because the younger ones are **overly occupied with** work challenges and deadlines.

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Model Answers

Q1. What do you like to do when you are happy?

A.

Well for me personally, when I am happy, I like to go into the kitchen and start cooking. If I am in a good mood, I love **to dabble in the kitchen** (=try cooking things) and do, you know, cook some new recipes.

I mean, for me it's **pure bliss** when you are cooking and **the dish turns out really nice,** the same as the picture in the cook book and then of course I really enjoy eating the meal with the family and for me you know, I am really **over the moon,** if the family **appreciate the food,** and just getting together and having a bit of **quality family time** around food that I have cooked.

For me, that's a great way of, you know, of enjoying myself and being **contented**.

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Q2. Describe a happy moment you have had?

A.

I'd like to tell you about a time when I went to see a concert with my family. **It was going back maybe a year ago**. I think it was the summer time 'cos I remember it was quite warm. The weather was quite hot. And **I had bought** some tickets to take my family to a classical music concert.

We were very excited about going there and then **on the day** we went to this **auditorium** to watch this concert and when we went into the auditorium, it was so impressive. I mean the colours, the lights, the decoration, **the whole décor of the place** was, you know, absolutely fantastic. It looked beautiful and then we sat down.

But then when the music began, it was like we **were walking on air.** I mean it was the most beautiful classical music I have heard in a long time. I turned to look at my wife and she **was on cloud nine** and I think when I looked at my daughter, well she seemed to be really enjoying herself, right? She seemed to **having the time of her life**, listening to the music, all these different melodies and there was some singing as well, almost **angelic music**.

So we really enjoyed it, and after the concert, we **went for a stroll**

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along the promenade and we were talking about what we liked about the music. The different sounds and the different visual effects that were there in the auditorium. Really, you know, we **enjoyed it immensely.** It was a really, really happy moment. We were very content and delighted with the whole event that we went to.

Q3. How can we define happiness?

A.

Well, it's a really very interesting question and I **was mulling this over** *(=thinking about)* the other day because I was watching a video of a monk who was talking about the definition of happiness.

On the one hand, there are a kind of **book definitions** that say happiness is all about your **physical and emotional wellbeing** and that's true.

But personally, for me, happiness is the small moments in life. It's the little things that happen to us, **day in and day out** *(=everyday).* You know, happiness is when I am strolling through the park and I can smell the flowers and hearing the bird song. Happiness is when suddenly I see a fish jumping out of the water along the promenade where I walk every day. A beautiful sunset, these little things for me, are happiness.

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It’s a really, really interesting question because **going back to** the monk, he was suggesting that happiness is something we can learn and a skill we can develop, and you can **hone the skill** *(=develop the skill)*, to make it better and better.

I’m **in two minds about that** at the moment. I think, it’s probably true but for me, happiness is something we see in the little things every day.

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Live Lesson Notes

Hobbies

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These are the kind of questions you might get on this topic

Part 1

Do you have a hobby?
What equipment do you need for it?
Why do you think people have hobbies?
What hobbies are popular in your country?

Part 2

Describe a leisure activity that you do with your family

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Some useful Links

Great list of hobbies with definitions and pictures
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_hobbies

Link to get a complete **Mock IELTS** Test. Use the CODE: **keith10** to get a 10% discount.
https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

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VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS

WHAT IS A HOBBY?

Hobby - interest - pastime - leisure activity

Do you have a hobby?

Yes, I do.

Note: It's really natural English to answer this question with 'Yes, I do' / 'No, I don't'. Rather than just 'yes' or 'no'.

I like **doing yoga**
I am obsessed with **doing yoga**
I'm passionate about **doing yoga**
I am fascinated by **doing yoga**

I like to **dabble** in the kitchen

I like to **dabble** in cooking

I enjoy watching films, if that counts.

I enjoy watching films, if you can consider that a hobby

I draw/play chess/take photos… just for fun

Brisk walking is my thing

I'm a bit of a cricketer/painter/stamp collector…

I'm an **amateur** chef/phoTOgrapher/painter…

I'm an **aficionado** of films (a lover of…)

I love to crochet

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I love to listen to music (emphasises habit)

I love listening to music (emphasises action / enjoyment)

Note: We can use both to talk about hobbies. The first might be slightly better if the hobby is also a habit (i.e. you do it regularly)
The same applies to 'like'.

No, I don't have a hobby.

Note: You don't want to just say 'no'. Start to develop your answers. For example…

No, but I am looking into jogging …

(look into = investigate/research/find out about)

Note: you can use complex grammar really easily just by using the following Present Perfect Continuous tense

No, but **I've been** looking into …yoga

No, but I am think**ing** about tak**ing** up jog**ging**

(to take up = to start (a hobby))

No, but I am think**ing** about start**ing** jog**ging**

Note: Again, you can use complex grammar really easily just by using the following Present Perfect Continuous tense

No, but **I've been thinking** about taking up…yoga

No, but I'd like to try…yoga

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No, but I'd like to try my hand at…

(to try my hand at…= to have a go = to try (something new))

Some of your most popular hobbies!

Reading
Travelling
Cooking
Gardening
Watching films
Running
Fishing
Writing poetry
Doing origami

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What equipment do you need for it?

Equipment is uncountable. (Similar to these NOUNS - advice, news, information)

You don't need **much** equipment to go jogging

You only need **one** main **piece** of equipment, and that's a camera

For photography, **a** camera **is a prerequisite**

For photography, **a** camera **is essential**

I just need **a** camera and **I am good to go**

I just need **a** camera and **I am all set**

Note: Remember each item/piece of equipment needs an article 'a' or to be in the plural. For example….

The only thing I need is **a** bat and **a** ball

I only need **a** bat and ball**s**

I need lots of **utensils** for cooking

I don't need any sophisticated **gadgets** for reading

A Kindle is **a** useful **device** for reading

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Why do you think people have hobbies?

It has a **calming effect**

It's a great **stress buster**

It helps us **relieve our stress**

It helps me **unwind / chill out / lay back / kick back**

It's just a way **to kill time**

It's a way to **socialise**

When you get **in the zone** - you can **disconnect** from work / from your daily routine

It's very **grounding** (brings you down to earth/back to nature)
to work with your hands

Get **back to nature**

It feels **fulfilling** - satisfying

To discover and **showcase** their **hidden talent**

It can **increase our productivity**

To enables us to **grow and develop**

It can be a **channel** to **express our creativity**

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To **preserve** our **mental health**

Some hobbies help us **keep healthy**

It can help me **stay in shape**

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Home and Accommodation

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Riddle
What runs all around your garden but never moves?
Answer
A fence

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Some useful Links

35 different kinds of house (in USA) with **pictures**!
https://www.homestratosphere.com/types-of-houses/

A complete and **alphabetical list** of house types
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_house_types

Virtual tour of a luxury house
https://youtu.be/VOWZoeGyR9M

Click to get a complete **Mock IELTS** Test.
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Part 1 QUESTIONS

What kind of accommodation do you live in?

Houses

A detached house

A town house - a duplex - a semi-detached (*usually two houses together)*

A terraced house *(one house connected to many others in the same row/street)*

A bungalow *(a house with only one level)*

Flats

Flat / apartment *(a living area within a bigger building)*

e.g. a two-bedroom flat

Note: flat and apartment are really the same, you can use either.

A block of flats *(a building that contains many flats)*

An apartment block *(a building that contains many apartments)*

A condominium *(a building that contains many apartments)*

A high-rise building

Often for students

Rented house
Student accommodation
Student digs
A studio / A bedsit *(a self-contained unit; everything in one room)*

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Collocations

Remember to use collocations to add 'colour' to your language.

A **run-of-the-mill** house
= an ordinary house

A **cosy / noisy / cramped flat**

Cosy = small and comfortable

Cramped = too small and uncomfortable

A **three-storey** building

Note: ***'three-storey'*** *is an adjective and so is singular.*
You can spell this 'story' or 'storey'.

I live **on the third floor**

a **spacious** /**comfy** flat

Spacious = plenty / lots of room

Comfy = comfortable

Parts of a house

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Rooms

Kitchen
Living room
Dining room / area
Tea room
Bathroom
Lounge = living room
Entrance hall
Office (n.) / study (n.)
Bedroom
Bathroom

Furniture and **Equipment**

Kitchen island *(table in middle of kitchen for food preparation)*
Oven *(for baking and roasting)*
Fridge
Stove *(hot plates for cooking)*

Cupboards *(for pots, plates, cups…)*
Chest of Drawers *(for socks, underwear…)*
Wardrobe *(for clothes)*

Coffee table
Couch = sofa
Fireplace
Cabinet
Bookcase
Desk
Armchair

Bed

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Bedside table
Carpet *(wall to wall)*
Rug
Tiled floor

Piano
Staircase

Sink
Shower
Bathtub
Mirror

Decoration

Paintings
Photos
Plants
Ornaments *(any kind of decoration)*

Table lamps
Floor lamps

Model plane
Desk calendar

Collocations

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En-suite bathroom *(attached to the bedroom)*

The **master bedroom** *(the biggest one, usually for the parents)*

A **king size** bed *(the biggest size)*

Open plan kitchen

Spacious living room with a **modern look**

Colourful bedroom

An **elegant** bathroom

A bedroom full of **contrasting colours**

Fluffy cushions (on the sofa) and **pillows** (on the bed)

A **hand-woven** carpet *(made by hand)*

Fully-furnished house

A **well-lit** living room

A **flat-screen** television

A **state-of-the-art** TV

Artificial plants

A **wooden** table

Bob's your uncle! (G.B. Slang)

It kind of means, everything is good or it's easy to do. Often used at the end of a list of instructions to someone.

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What's the difference between where you are living now and where you have lived in the past?

What is the examiner looking for?

Use of tenses:

I am living in a coastal city

I have been living her for 2 years

We live on the sixth floor

It's quite a cosy place, but it is a little but cramped

Before we moved here, I was living in Malaysia

We lived in a condominium

It was a 27 storey building

Comparisons:

Much bigger than where we are now

There was far more room

It was just way more spacious

It had a lot more mod cons (modern comforts) than what we have now

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Idioms

IDIOMS to talk about WORK

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Some useful Links

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https://ieltsetc.com/28-day-planner-2/

Idioms dictionary online
https://www.theidioms.com/

English Idioms Online Youtube Channel full of useful idioms
https://www.youtube.com/channel/UC1HH5tChfG8wfFr3tpqzBEQ/playlists

List of 2,000 Useful **Idioms**
https://phrases.org.uk

British National Corpora - great to check idioms and get examples
https://www.english-corpora.org/bnc/

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Introducing Idioms and Idiomatic expressions

Idioms are **fixed** phrases whose meaning is **different** from the individual words

E.G.

Yesterday, I was talking to Jane and I decided **to spill the beans** about my new job.
(=to reveal a secret)

We use them to
get attention (especially news, blogs, articles…),
for **humour**
for **emphasis**
to add**colour**

Often idioms have a connotation = so be careful, try to learn the connotation

Idioms dictionary online
https://www.theidioms.com/

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Idiomatic expressions

Idiomatic expressions make up a much wider group of expressions that include idioms, but also include some phrasal verbs and set phrases.

Some Phrasal verbs

Pack something **in**
= to stop doing something

I am going to **pack in** my job.

Cut down on
= to reduce (usually something you see as bad, eg. smoking)

I need to **cut down on** the time I spend in meetings

Spoken chunks

By the way (used to give extra information)

At a pinch
= if absolutely necessary

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Idioms to talk about work

*These are the idioms and idiomatic expressions found in the **video** in today' live lesson.*

I've been **working like a dog**
= *working hard*

She had **a stinker of a day**
= *a terrible day*

This job is (way) **above her pay grade**
= *a a job that someone more senior should do*

Her boss **went up the wall**
= *he was angry, he saw red, he flew of the handle*

He **came down on her like a ton of bricks**
= *to be strict on s.o. / punish them*

If she **gets over this bump in the road,** she'll be fine.
= *to overcome a problem*

If she **plays her cards right,** (*do the right thing)* she will **be up for** *(eligible, recommend her for)* a promotion

We work 9 to 5, we are **stuck in the rat race**
= *stuck in a boring routine*

We try our best to **climb the corporate ladder**
= *To move up in the company*

You need time to **find your feet** *(=learn how to do new things)* and to **learn the ropes**

You **get a golden handshake** *(= bonus when you retire)*

I am going to **pack it all in** and **throw in the towel** (*=give up, quit)*

He could **sell snow to the Eskimos**
= *he is very good at sales*

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What do you like and dislike about your job?

My job has a number of **fringe benefits** *(=non-financial benefits, e.g. free lunch, gym membership)*

I have got **flexible working hours**

It's **challenging** but **rewarding** as well

There is too much **red tape** *(=bureaucracy/ too many rules)*

I always have to **burn the midnight oil** to meet all my deadlines.
= *work late into the night*

It's a **cushy number**
= *an easy job*

I **have a lot on my plate** these days
= *I am busy / things are hectic / I am snowed under*

I have hit **a glass ceiling**
= *I can go no higher in the company - no chance for promotion*

I was easy to get **a foot in the door**
= *to get an opportunity to enter…*

My boss is **a slave driver**
= *makes me work very hard*

I really **have my work cut out**
= *I have a difficult job to do*

I took **a busman's holiday**
= *I took holiday but I actually worked on holiday*

He is **a mover and shaker**
= *He is an important and well-connected person in the company*

She has a **good track record**
= *She has a good work history*

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Model Answers

Q1. DESCRIBE YOUR REGULAR WORKING DAY.

A1. So, I get up at the same time most days. I have **a bit of** a routine that I like to follow **everyday**.

I like to go walking in the morning and then **I will come back home** and have a **hearty breakfast** to have lots of energy for the day.

I work from home, so it's **quite straight forward** for me.

I don't have to commute and can control my work time quite easily but **I tend to** do the same thing day after day.

Q2. Are you the main bread-winner? If so, how do you feel about it?

A2. Yes, I am the main bread winner in my family, although my wife does work, she works part-time, and I **bring home the bacon**, **by and large**, most months.

I am absolutely comfortable with that. I think, **a relationship is a balance** where both the husband and the wife, or both partners, have to **find a comfortable balance** where they both **contribute to the well-being** of the family.

There are things **beyond finance**. There are other things to take care of, like looking after the house, educating the children, bringing up a **happy family environment.**

So, I think both have to make equal contributions. I **am a big one for making a contribution** at home, whether that's washing the pots, tidying the house little bit, but we like to share responsibilities.

So, I think it's a shared responsibility issue.

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Q3. What you want to change about your job?

A3. Well, as you may know, I am an online teacher so I spend **quite a bit of time** teaching and I also **dedicate quite a bit of time** to making videos and teaching online.

I really enjoy my job you know, its something that makes me happy, I am really engaged in my day to day work.

If there were one thing I could change, I think that one thing **might be,** I **would like to** rent or buy a space, better equipped for video recording.

At the moment, I **work form home** so as you can see, I have to record in our bedrooms and it's not the most professional or best quality and I would really like to **take the opportunity** to rent a place the has **better facilities** and **amenities** for **that aspect of my work**.

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More Idioms from students about work

I like to **put my feet up** after work
= *to relax*

I need to **think on my feet** in my job
= *to think quickly and improvise*

I was going to volunteer to give the speech but then I **got cold feet**, and decided not to do it.
= *got nervous*

Michael annoys me, he is always **dragging his feet** at work
= *working too slowly*

She has been here for a year now, she needs **to stand on her own feet**
= *be independent and look after herself*

I **put my foot in it** yesterday when I told me boss that nobody really listens to him.
= *made a mistake / said an embarrassing thing*

I don't worry too much about small mistakes, I believe **every dog has its day**
= *Everyone will be successful sometime*

I took a day off work yesterday, I was **as sick as a dog**
= *extremely sick / ill*

He **was in the dog house** with his boss after messing up the whole project
= *his boss was angry with him*

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Let’s talk about a company you like

It **does a roaring trade**
= *to sell a lot*

It might **go belly up**
= *to go wrong, go bankrupt (lose all money)*
= *They **went bust***

This company has **gone to the dogs**
= *The quality of its work has dropped*

They wanted to dominate the China market and they have **pulled it off**
= *to be successful*

Their products **sell like hotcakes**
=*sell very well.*

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Live Lesson Notes

Idioms

IDIOMS to describe PEOPLE

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Riddle
When a girl has an accident, why can't her brother help her out?
He can't be a brother and assist her (a sister).

Joke
My doctor asked me if any of my family suffer from insanity…
I said no, we all actually enjoy it!

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Some Recommended Books

Collins Co-build Dictionary of Idioms
Publisher - Harper Collins (1995)

English Idioms in Use (Advanced)
Felicity O'Dell / Michael McCarthy
Publisher CUP 2010

Some useful Links

List of 2,000 Useful Idioms
https://phrases.org.uk

British National Corpora - great to check idioms and get examples
https://www.english-corpora.org/bnc/

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Introducing Idioms

Idioms are **fixed** phrases whose meaning is **different** from the individual words

E.G.

Yesterday, I was talking to Jane and **I <u>let the cat out of the bag</u>** about the surprise party for her.
(=to reveal a secret, accidentally)

We use them to **get attention** (especially news, blogs, articles…), for **humour**, **emphasis** and to add **colour.**

NEWSPAPER HEADLINES!

Here are two examples that show some humour.

Opticians can't <u>see eye to eye</u>!

(to see eye to eye = to agree)

European farmers are sitting on the fence!

(to sit on the fence = can't decide - indecisive)

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MY ADVICE

In IELTS Speaking, you can and should use some idioms, but not too many.

You need to be sure that you can use them well, and you need to use them naturally.

So only use those, that you are confident you know how to use well.

It is key to learn idioms in context or within a topic, not via a list.

That is why this lesson focusses more on the topic of PEOPLE.

You will hear them as you listen to podcasts, videos, films and radio, so do make notes of them and focus on how they are used.

Then start to practice using them.

You can find and check idioms here.

https://phrases.org.uk

https://www.english-corpora.org/bnc/

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Types of Idioms

Idioms may include

Similes / metaphors

Expressions comparing two things

They are **like two peas in a pod**
=*They are very similar*

He's **as thin as a rake**
=*very thin*

He **saw red**
= *he was angry*

I'm still **learning the ropes**
= *learning how to do something*

Binomials

Two words joined by a preposition (usually AND)

This problem is **black and white**
= *it's clear*

I do yoga **now and then**
= *sometimes*

We need to learn idioms **step by step**
= *slowly, one thing at a time*

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Sayings and Proverbs

It's a small world

When in Rome, (*do as the Romans)*

Once bitten, (*twice shy)*

NOTE: We often just use the first part of proverbs, as everyone knows the second part by heart.

Be careful, overall proverbs tend to have a moral message and so many may not be appropriate for IELTS Speaking.

Euphemisms

Used to avoid offending people or saying words you are uncomfortable with

Nature calls
= *I need to go to the toilet*

I am going **to spend a penny**
= *I am going to the toilet*

Did you know Jane **has a bit on the side**?
= *to have a lover/ mistress*

He **passed away**
= *he died*

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Idioms to talk about people

He is **the black sheep** of the family = the naughty one

She is **down to earth** = practical

He is **the apple of my eye** = I really like / love him

He is **cool as a cucumber =** doesn't show emotions

She's **a bosom friend** = a close friend

Birds of feather, (flock together) = similar people hang out together

I know him **like the back of my hand** = know sthing /s.o. **very well**

He is **a know—it-all** = knows too much and shows off

We are **as different as chalk and cheese**
= very different

He is **the spitting image** of his father
=looks exactly the same

It runs in the family = everybody in the family does it

My own flesh and blood = my family

He/she is **set in his/her ways** = doesn't like change

We **go back a long way =** have known each other a long time

She is an **old flame** = an ex-girlfriend / lover

To be **highly strung** = to be nervous and easily upset

She **doesn't suffer fools gladly =** She doesn't tolerate stupid people

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He’s **a loose canon** = says things (often bad) without thinking or realising it

She can **think on her feet** = can think quickly and improvise

Binomials about people

He is **calm and collected** = very calm

He is so helpful **come rain or shine** = at all times

She is so **neat and tidy** = very tidy

She likes to keep her house **spic and span** = in perfect order / tidy

My wife and I are like **chalk and cheese** = very different

We always **see eye to eye** = agree

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Comedy

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The Riddle:
As I was going to St. Ives,
I met a man with seven wives,
Each wife had seven sacks,
Each sack had seven cats,
Each cat had seven kits:
Kits, cats, sacks, and wives,
How many were there going to St. Ives?
Answer: **1**

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Some useful Links

This one is about different types of **British Humour**
http://greatbritishmag.co.uk/uk-culture/10-types-of-british-humour-explained/

Some great **short jokes**
https://www.rd.com/list/short-jokes/

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youtube.com/c/IELTSSpeakingSuccess

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Essential Vocabulary

It's a **<u>co</u>medy** (n.)

I like **<u>co</u>medy** (adj.) shows.

I like **<u>co</u>medies** (genre/type)

He is a *hilarious* **co<u>me</u>dian** (person)

He is a professional **<u>co</u>mic** (person) (also a magazine)

That pay rise is **<u>co</u>mical** (adj.)

Some of Your Favourite Comedians

Mr Bean - character
Rowan Atkinson - comedian
Mr. Gabriel Iglesias
Jim Carrey
Laurel and Hardy
Kemal Sunal
Michael McIntyre
Kevin Hart
Charlie Chaplin
Frankie Boyle
Kapil Sharna
Robin Williams
Trevor Noah
George Carlin and Dave Chapelle
Adam Sandler
Charlie sheen
Vaigaipuyal Vadivelu
Doug Standhope

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Some British Comedians I suggest you explore!

Peter Kay

Tommy Cooper

Michael McIntyre

Miranda Hart

John Bishop

Russel Howard

Jennifer Saunders

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Part 1

The following are the kinds of questions you might be asked in IELTS Speaking.

Do you like watching funny TV shows?

If I am **in the mood for** comedy,

then, yes I do

I am really fond of **stand-up comics**

so I will often watch a show called…

…**if I remember correctly,** I think it's called 'The Comedy Channel'

where I can see some of **my favourite comedians perform**

If I am **feeling blue /down** (=sad),

then I like to watch **my favourite sitcom**

which is 'Friends'.

It's about a group 30-something-year olds

and how their relationships develop and change .

It really helps me **unwind** and **disconnect**

from my daily routine

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Do you like to make people laugh?

I like to **mimic** / **imitate** people (=copy)

I am good at **doing impersonations** of famous people (= imitate / copy the voice of mannerisms of someone)

(a parody - imitate someone to make fun of them)

Yes, it helps **reduce the tension**

It's a great way to r**elieve the stress**

I am into **telling jokes**

I love to **crack** jokes when I am with friends

That **cracks me up** = it makes me laugh

Yes, I **have a knack of** making people laugh (= I have a talent for it)

I **enjoy a good laugh**, but I am not good at **telling jokes**

Well, I try to tell jokes, but whenever I get to the **punchline**, I usually **mess it up**!

The **punchline** of a joke is the last line - where the joke is 'revealed'

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Do you think it is important for friends to laugh together?

Yes, with all the **pressure on our shoulders**

we need to **disconnect** sometimes,

and **having a laugh with friends**

is a great way to do that.

******
For sure, they say **laughter is the best medicine**

And it's so true.

When I am out and about with friends

we always **end up** laughing at some joke **or other**

I think we all need to laugh

to relieve our stress

******

Yes, it can help **strengthen the bond** between us

Yes, so we can build a **deeper connection**

Yes, it can help determine if we **are in the same boat** (= on the same wavelength = have the same things in common)

It **creates a good vibe** for the group

It helps us all **unwind**

We need to **take things with a pinch of salt!** = not too seriously!

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Types of Comedy / Humour

Parody (n.) = when you imitate someone

Satire (n.) = ridicule or mock / make fun of someone

Visual humour = comedy that doesn't rely on words

Slapstick (n.) = visual humour, usually falling, hitting, knocking things.

Stand up comedy = comics telling jokes on stage

Observational comedy = giving a funny twist to everyday life routines

Sitcoms = Situational Comedy *(e.g Friends, Big Bang Theory)*

Musical comedies

Romantic comedies

Check out different types of **British Humour** in this link

http://greatbritishmag.co.uk/uk-culture/10-types-of-british-humour-explained/

Wit (n) = comedy that uses a **play on words** or a '**pun**'

A play on words or a pun is using the second meaning of a word to make the story funny.

e.g. What is black and white and **read** *(red)* all over? A newspaper!

This joke uses the 2 meanings of the sound 'red / read' which can mean the colour or the past of the verb to read.

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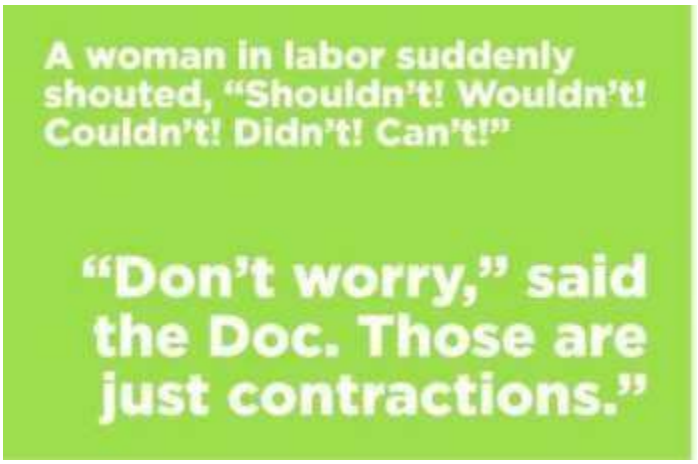
Here are some more examples below



All of these jokes below use 'puns' or a play on these words:

Pause (hesitation) **/ Paws** (animals' hands or feet) (same pronunciation)

Contractions (movement when a woman is giving birth / reducing a word to a short form)

Space (room / area beyond the earth)

Type (kind of person / kind of font for writing)

All of these are taken from this website

https://www.rd.com/list/short-jokes/

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Common English Jokes

A___walks into a bar…

Knock knock!
Who's there?
Lettuce
Lettuce who?
Let us in, it's cold out here!

Knock knock!
Who's there?
Ivor
Ivor who?
I've a lot of money, so let me in!

Did you hear about the Irishman who….?

Did you hear about the Irishman who swam from Ireland to England. He got so tired half way across that he decide to turn around and go back!

Irishman are the butt (target) of many British jokes.

Most countries use someone as the butt of many of their jokes, although nowadays this is often not seen as being Politically Correct (P.C.) and may be seen as offensive. Please be careful when telling such jokes in English to people you do not know very well.

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More vocabulary and Idiomatic expressions

To tell / **crack a joke**

My joke **raised a smile** = made someone laugh

My joke got a few laughs

To have a (good) laugh

All of the following mean to **laugh out loud**

- I was in stitches
- I split me sides laughing
- I burst out laughing
- I was laughing in the aisles

It was **a barrel of laughs** = it was a lot of fun

To **laugh** something **off** = to laugh about it / not worry about it

When I didn't get the score I wanted, I decided to just **laugh it off**

To have a good / twisted / dry / dark **sense of humour**

To laugh (v.)

A laugh (n. - countable). We had a laugh

Laughter (n. - uncountable, more general meaning) - I heard laughter in the classroom

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Jobs

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Essential Vocabulary
Phrasal verbs
Talking about your job
An ideal job
Video and Listening Practice
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Essential Vocabulary

What's the difference between JOB and WORK?

Job (n.) *Countable*

I have two **jobs** and I like both of them.

Work (n.) *Uncountable*

I have a lot of **work** to do

We can make 'work' countable by adding 'a piece of' - the same way we make other words countable like news, advice, information

I have **a piece of** work / advice / news / information for you

We can also use 'work' as a countable noun when talking about art or possibly literature.

This is **a work of art** by Picasso *(Countable)*
His **works** are great. *(Countable)*

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Collocations

Work is also a verb (v.)

To work hard

To work **part time** / **full time**

Work from home = to work remotely = I like working virtually

I have a **well paid** job / **badly paid** job

A **white collar** job = *indoors, office job (banker)*
A **blue collar** job = *outdoors, manual job (mechanic)*

I **work shifts** *(work specific hours of the day)*

As a doctor I sometimes have to work the **night shift**

It's **arduous work** = *difficult / hard*
It's **rewarding work =** *you enjoy it and it is satisf*ying

This is **a sterling piece of work =** *fantastic*
This is **a shoddy piece of work =** *terrible, low quality*

I know this report is **shoddy**, but I was up all night **burning the midnight oil** *(working late into the night)* all to **meet my deadlines**, and I know it's not **up to scratch** (*good enough),* but please **give me some slack** *(give me a break, take some pressure off me!)*

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Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal verbs are vey common in spoken English.
Basically it is where the meaning of a verb is changed by adding a preposition

For example:

To speak = *to talk, say something*
To speak up = *to speak more loudly*

To put = *to place something somewhere*
To put off = *to delay something*

Here are some more examples of phrasal verbs that can be used when talking about jobs.

I **put in** a lot of work *(=to do)*

I have **taken on** too much work *(=start / accept)*

Let's **get down to** work *(=begin)*

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What job do you do?

I work **as a**_____(teacher, builder, banker…)
I work **in**_____(sales/ marketing/education…THE FIELD)
I work **in a**_____(hospital, school, bank..PLACE)
I work **for**_____(Amazon, a multinational company….)

What do you like about your job?

I love **the fact that**___I can ….

Well, it's good because **I get to** _____

What I really like about my job is _____

What would be your ideal job? Why?

My ideal / target / dream job is **to work as a**_____(carpenter, astronaut …)

I wish I worked _____

I would love to be a/an _____

I long to be a / an _____

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Listening Practice

Watch the video and answer the first question.

1. What is my ideal job?

Also try to fill in the gaps below with the correct collocation.

2. **Put on a _____**
3. **To my _____**
4. **The adrenaline _____**
5. **Financial _____**
6. **It's more of a_____than a passion**

Answers at the bottom of the page

Watch a full grammatical analysis of this sample answer here

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Idioms about Jobs

Here are a number of idioms that can be used when talking about jobs and work.

This job **suits me down to the ground** *(=it's 100% match / perfect for me)*

She never **does a stroke of work** *(=she is so lazy, does the least work possible)*

She doesn't **pull her weight** *(=she is too lazy)*

I like to **pull my weight** *(=to work hard, do what I am responsible for)*

He **made light work of it** *(=he did it easily)*

This job is **a cushy number** *(=it's an easy job)*

It's not a great job, but at least I can **get a foot in the door** *(=start working in a company - with a view to getting a higher position there)*

I have hit **a glass ceiling** *(=invisible barrier)***,** I can't go any further in this company

I **have a lot on my plate** *(= I am very busy)*

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Sample Answers

Why do you think people quit their jobs?

I think there's probably **a multitude of different reasons** and obviously it depends on the **circumstances,**

but I would say for a lot of people, nowadays, **one of the main reasons** they **give up their job** is because of the stress.

You know, lot of people are **under stress.** They have to work hard.

They have to **meet deadlines**, **tight deadlines**, so **huge amounts of pressure on** them and so a lot of them will just give up the jobs because **it's not worth sacrificing your health for** the work that you are doing.

Describe an awkward moment at your work

I'd like to tell you about a time when I took my boss for a meeting but the people we met didn't **turn up** *(=to appear)*

Now, this is **going back quite a while.**

It **must have been** or about six years ago.

I was working as a project manager at that time, for an educational institution and I was organising a project where we helped teachers in their schools and I had to go with my boss to meet a local government

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official.

What happened is, I was responsible for **setting up the meeting** and organising the discussion, the content, the agenda, and **all the follow up points.**

So, I **spent a lot of time meticulously working out the agenda**, setting up all the details, and I even agreed on the location, the date, but **absentmindedly**, I forgot to **double check** with the government official the day before, that the **meeting was still on.**

So, the day of the meeting, I got into car with my boss. We drove down to the government office. We arrived **just on time** and then said that we were ready to meet Mr X, but **we were told that** Mr X was not there that he **wasn't aware** *(didn't know)* there was a meeting.

My boss said to me, 'did you telephone this morning to double check we had a meeting?'

And I was so embarrassed because I hadn't and it was **a rookie mistake** *(=a mistake a beginner makes),* like a beginner's mistake.

The first thing I should have done was to check the meeting.

I was so embarrassed because the meeting was cancelled.

It **turned out** to be **a total waste of time** for my boss who was rather angry and we drove back in complete silence to the office.

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Listening Practice Answers

1. I want to be an actor
2. Put on a play
3. To my surprise
4. The adrenaline rush
5. Financial instability
6. It's more of a whim

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Live Lesson Notes

Leaders

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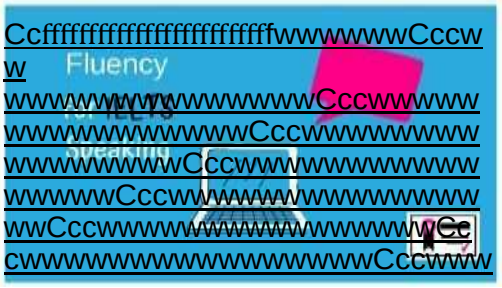

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful links
Warm up questions
Useful vocabulary
What is leadership?
Idioms to talk about leaders
Tips for Part 2
Qualities of a leader
Women leaders
Tips Part 2
Model Answers

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Useful Links

Definition of **leadership** and many more business tools
https://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newLDR_41.htm

Another **definition of leadership** from **Forbes** magazine
https://www.forbes.com/sites/kevinkruse/2013/04/09/what-is-leadership/?sh=75671e715b90

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of LEADERS, you will learn how to talk about qualities of a leader, different types of leaders and the future of leadership.

Watch the complete video about this topic of leaders here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of Leadership that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

What makes a good leader?

Can leaders be trained?

Do you think leaders will be different in the future?

Describe a friend who is a good leader!

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Related topics

Decision-making
- Should a leader discuss decisions with team members?

Family
- Who is the head of the family in your country?

Team-work
Do teams need a leader?

Cooperation vesus Competition
-Which is better?

Skills
- Which skills will young people need in the future?

Education
- Should we and can we teach children to be leaders?

Games
- What can children learn from playing games?

Types of leader

- Religious
- Political
- Business
- Military
- Community
- Student
- Family

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Useful vocabulary

Lead (v.)

Leader (n.)

Leadership (n.)

What is leadership? What is a leader?

Someone who guides others towards a common goal

Someone who **motivates** and **inspires** others

Someone who **builds an inspiring vision**

A leader needs to have a vision and be able to take others with them towards that vision.

A leader does the right thing, a manager does things right.

Leadership **has nothing to do with** titles or seniority, it is about directing people towards a common goal.

What is a good leader?

A good leader **paves the path** for the success of generations

They can **think critically**

An exceptional person who can lead others **without losing their temper**

The one who leads any group efficiently and effectively

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A person who could listen and understand others

A person who can **distinguish right from wrong** and lead others the right way

Any person who works the most and ensures others work honestly

A person who is **goal-oriented**

A person who **sets a good example** for others

A person who **carries out what he preaches**

Anyone who has **strong decision-making power** and the ability to lead others

A person who can help others find their way.

Collocations with 'leader'

Experienced / smart / loyal / inspirational / vocal / open-minded

well-qualified / zealous / easy-going/ versatile/ a visionary

calm and collected / vigilant / magnetic / agile / passionate/ organised

composed / determined / accountable / inventive / goal-oriented

dedicated / pragmatic

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Idioms to talk about leaders

She is a **natural born leader**

Their ability **sets them apart** (=makes them different / better)

They **stand <u>out</u> <u>from</u>** the crowd

They are **a cut <u>above</u> the rest** (=better than others)

She is **in a different league** (=better than others)

She is **second to none** (= the best)

His ideas are **ahead of the curve** (=brand new)

The leader **calls the shots** (=makes the decisions)

He is **as sharp as a knife** (=clever)

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Tips for Part 2

Describe a friend who is a good leader.

Someone who leads….you can talk about,

A family (father, mother)

A small business (restaurant / shop owner…)

A team (project at work/school,

A club (reading, wine-tasting, chess…)

A coach (school football team)

An event (planning a wedding / conference / holiday)

What kinds of qualities does a leader need?

Active
Brave
Charismatic
Decisive
Empathetic
Fair
Gregarious
Honest
Influential
Jubilant
Kind
Loyal
Motivational
Optimistic
Persuasive
Responsible
Supportive
Trustworthy
Unprejudiced
Veracious
Wise
Zealous

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Do you think in the future there will be more women leaders?

- Yes, absolutely, because women **have good judgement** in critical conditions.
- Yes, of course, there is no **gender difference** these days.
- Yup, because they know the art of **going shoulder to shoulder** with men.
- Yeah, as we go forward, women are **making breakthroughs** in all fields.
- Yes, women change the world.
- The Prime Minister of New Zealand is the true example.
- Oh yeah, Queen Elizabeth is in front of us.
- Yes, most probably, as the **gender equality concern** is growing day by day.

Tips for Part 3

Give your **Opinion**
Say **Why**
Use **examples**

Below you have examples of leaders provided by students. Remember you can talk not only about political leaders, but also influencers, business leaders, members of your family, educators and so forth.

M Sheikh Hasina
YS Jagan Mohan Redd
Kamala Harris
Prime Minister Imran Khan
Angela Merkel
Abbad Reda
Rodrigo Duterte
GusDur
President No Muhyeon
Kim Namjoon (RM)
Sudha Murthy
Daw Aung San Su Kyi

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Model Answers

1. What are the qualities of a good leader for you?

For me I think, a leader, **first and foremost,** is somebody who has a vision and not only has the vision of what they want in the future , but has **the ability to lead others** and to take others with them, towards that future.

So, I think they must be **influential** and **persuasive**, but to do it in such a way that people want to go with them and follow them and realise that vision.

So, I think, these are the key factors that a good leader must have.

On top of that, I think, they also need to be **quite decisive** and to be able to make decisions even though there is not enough information, but to **choose a path,** in a quick time. So, I would say those are some of the key qualities of a good leader needs.

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2. Can children be a leader to the elderly?

That's a very interesting question and I haven't thought about that before, but **to be honest** I would say, well it depends on both the child and the elderly. I think, children can **have a great influence on** elderly people. You know, for example, they can teach them new technology. I know lots of younger teenagers are helping their grandparents learn how to get online, to **become silver surfers** and to **browse the internet** and find things that they want, even shopping online.
So I think, if there is either **a skills gap** and there is also **an element of trust** between the child and the grandparent, then, absolutely, I think certain children **have a knack for** leading their grandparents and to lead the elderly so long as there is an existing relationship between them.

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3. Do you have any leadership qualities?

That's a **tough question** and I am not sure I have thought about thatbut let me see! I think there are some **aspects of leadership** that I do possess.

You know, I do **have a knack for** influencing people and getting them to follow me. I think my **down to earth approach** can be **quite appealing** and so people sometimes come with me and will join me to try to **achieve a particular goal** that I want to achieve.

That said, the kind of leadership qualities of being **decisive**, I am not great at. I think **my achilles heel** is my decisiveness.

I tend to **dilly dally** (=waste time) and **dither** (hesitate and not decide) when it comes to making decisions. So, I am not very good at that.

So, I think that's **one aspect that** may be a, I am not very good at leading and er, that's my answer.

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Learning Vocabulary 1

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TODAY'S RIDDLE

What word begins and ends with an E but only has one letter?
Answer: Envelope.

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Some useful Links

Collocation Dictionary
www.ozdic.com

Find a word in a phrase
www.fraze.it

Dictionaries
https://www.collinsdictionary.com/

British Council resources
https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/vocabulary

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How to learn Vocabulary

Different people learn in different ways

There is no **one best** way

The way you learn vocabulary also depends on,

- your personality *(are you systematic, artistic, a rule-lover….?)*

- your level

- your mood

My suggestion is be **eclectic** - meaning, chose a variety of different methods.

Remember -

It takes time to learn or know a word…

…in the same way it takes time to get to know your boyfriend, girlfriend, husband or wife!

Even after years of studying English, you will find out new things about words that you thought you knew well.

For example, you may know the word ‘milk’ as a noun, a kind of drink.

Then later in your studies, you discover it is also a verb ‘to milk a cow’.

Maybe a year later, you then discover it has an idiomatic meaning to - ‘I’m going to milk this opportunity’ - take as much from it as possible.

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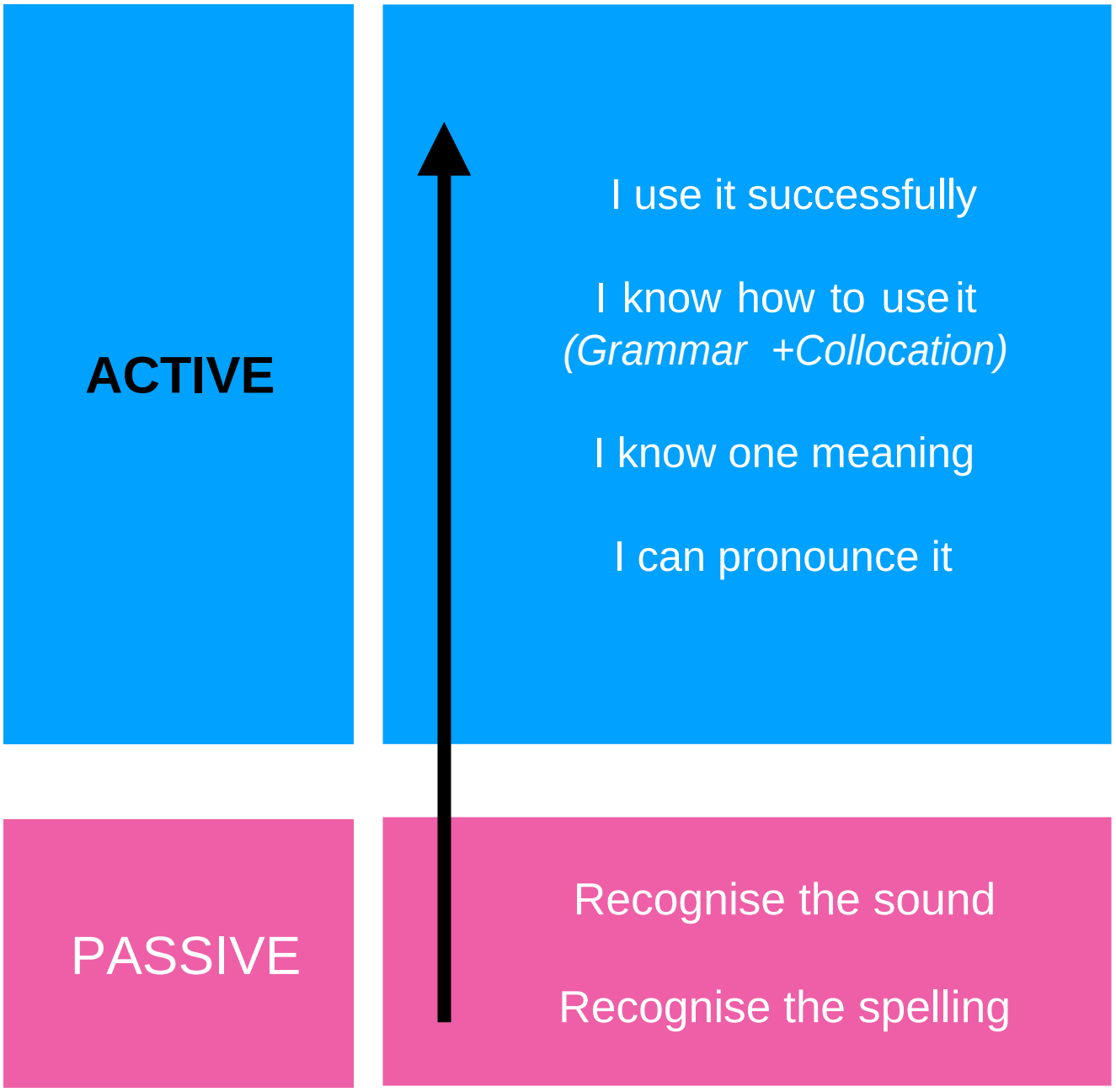
What do we mean by ‘**knowing**’ a word?



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Tips

1. Learn words in context

It is much better to learn words in **context**, rather than just reading a list of words.

This is because the **context shows you how to use the word**.

Find context in a variety of texts (audio, video, written)

As you read or listen, identify new / interesting / important words or phrases.

Some useful sources include (thanks to all contributions from students)

Rock n Roll English
Discover Channel
BBC - 6 minutes
The Economist
Ted Talks
National Geographic
ABC News Australia
Friends (the sitcom)
How I Met Your Mother (the sitcom)
Friday Night Comedy (BBC podcast)
Luke's English Podcast
Easy English (YT channel)
Harry Potter (books)
Sapiens: A brief history of humankind (book)
NPR one (National Public Radio USA)
Guardian (newspaper)
Engvid (YT channel)
Bloomberg
CNN News
Collocations in USE (reference book)
Culips English Podcast
Spotlight English
Voice of America (VOA)
History Channel
The Ellen Show (YT channel)
In Fluency (Podcast)
AllearsEnglish (podcast)

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Research tells us in order to start learning a word, we need to see it in at least **4 different contexts.**

So if you are reading about a topic, (for example technology and A.I.), you also want to look for a video and an audio on exactly the same topic.

For example,

I was reading an article about AI being used for a machine that can debate against humans.

I then went on Youtube and looked for a video on exactly the same topic, searching for ‘Artificial intelligence debater project IBM’.

Next, I looked in my Apple Store for a podcast on this same topic. Searching for ‘Science AI’, I found a related series and episode.

Written article
https://newsela.com/read/ibm-robot-debate/id/44458/

Video YT
https://youtu.be/naQujxmg9gg

Podcast
https://www.theguardian.com/science/audio/2018/jan/10/questioning-ai-what-kind-of-intelligence-will-we-create-science-weekly-podcast

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2. Learn vocabulary by theme or topic

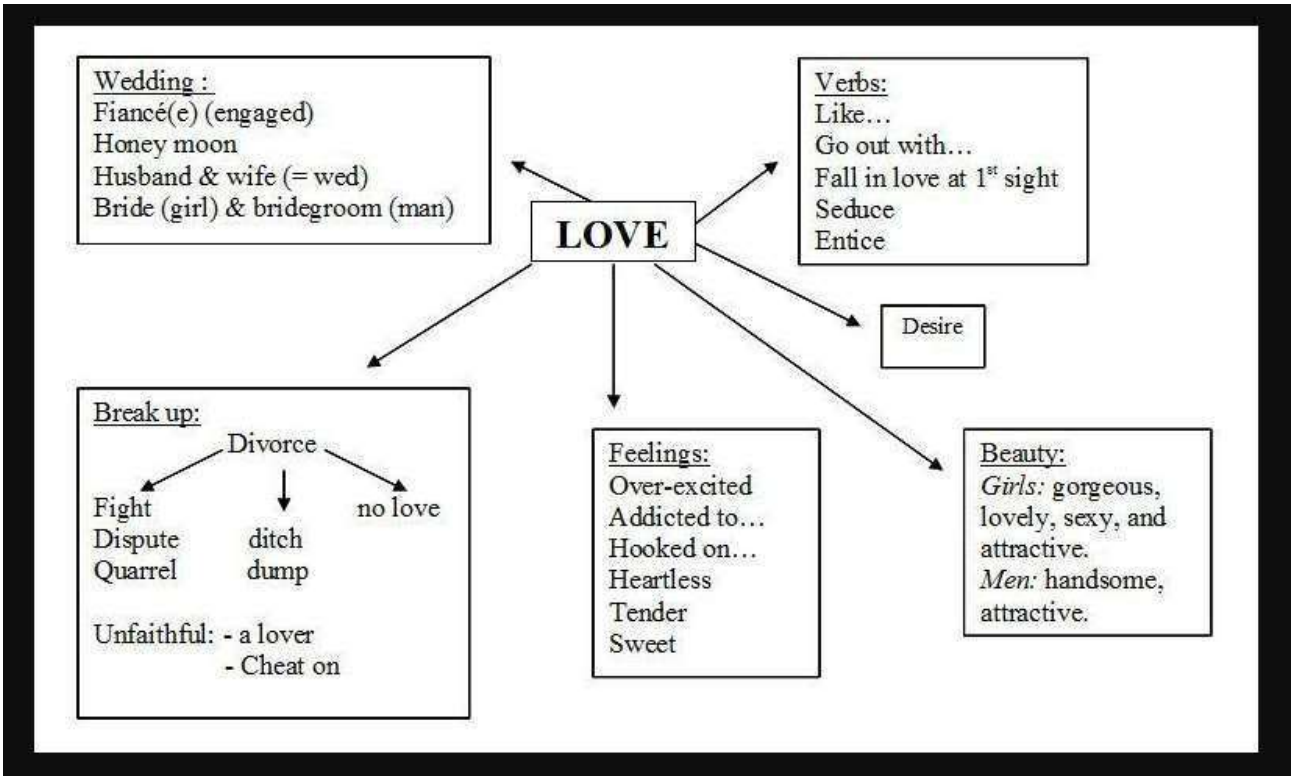
By learning and recording vocabulary by topic or theme, we are able to **make connections** between words and so **better remember** them.

When we 'learn' a new word, **we need to connect it to something we already know**.

Building vocabulary by topic allows us to make these essential connections.

1. We can use **Spidergrams** or **Mind Maps** to help us do this.

Here is one example, on the topic of love



Credit: English Day by Day

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2. Make Short stories

Use the vocabulary in your spider gram to **make short stories**

3. Phrasal verbs - Lists or topics?

You can try both approaches and see which works best for you.

Here are 2 examples below:

Phrasal verbs by **Lists** - TO CUT (phrasal verbs)

Cut off	= interrupt someone
Cut in	= drive in front of someone
Cut down	= take down a tree
Cut down on	= to reduce (often something you use too much)
Cut up	= cut something into smaller pieces

Phrasal verbs by **Topic** (e.g. about love)

Chat up	= to start a conversation and flirt with s.o.
Ask out	= ask someone to go on a date
Fall out with s.o.	= to have an argument and stop speaking to s.o.
make up with s.o.	= to become friends again
Break up	= to split up

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3. Make a note of new words

If you want to learn new words, it is a good idea to make notes.

You should note;

The grammar
(noun, verb, adjective…)
Countable or uncountable
Any preposition to use with it

The meaning
Use a dictionary. Always better to put a definition in English if possible (help you stop translating), or use images.

Useful collocations
The words that are usually used with this word

A phrase using the word
Try and make a phrase that is meaningful for you. This will help you remember it better

For example,

I was listening to a **recording** about London here https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/general-english/audio-zone/living-in-london

I saw a new expression 'l***ove-hate relationship'*** and so I made the following notes…

I checked for collocations in www.ozdic.com

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MY NOTES

A relationship (n.)

A love-hate relationship (adj.)
= I love and hate something /someone

Harmonious / healthy / fragile / stable *(other adjectives that collocate).*

To have a relationship (v.)

Enjoy / build / break off *(other verbs that collocate).*

Example:
I have a good relationship with my students

Look out for Learning Vocabulary 2 …

Coming next week!

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Live Lesson Notes

Learning Vocabulary 2
5 more useful Tips

Study with me to get a Band 7 or above on IELTS Speaking
with my Udemy online course

IELTS Speaking Success - Get a Band 7+

TODAY'S RIDDLE

I am an odd number. Take away a letter and I become even. What number am I?

Answer:Seven

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Some useful Links

Collocation Dictionary
www.ozdic.com

Great website and tool for learning vocabulary
https://quizlet.com/

Get a complete Mock IELTS Test.
Use the CODE: **keith10** to get a 10% **discount**.

https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

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Review of tips from last lesson (Vocabulary 1)

1. Learn words in **context**

2. Learn vocabulary by **theme** or **topic**

- Spidergrams
- Short stories

3. Make a note of new words

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More tips for learning (Vocabulary 2)

1. How to remember words

How do you remember words?

Many students do the following to learn new words: (these are all good!)

Speak it out loud

Speak it out loud practicing with the family

Use it in a sentence

Use it in conversation

Connect it to something you already know

Connect with a picture

Write it down

Write it and visualise it

Use it in an essay or a story

Use flashcards

Revise new words before going to bed

Teach it to others

Put sticky notes around the house

In addition, we can use the following techniques…

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Mnemonics

1. In order to remember useful conjunctions in English, we can use the acronym ***FANBOY***

For, **A**nd, **N**or, **B**ut, **O**r, **Y**et, and **S**o

2. To remember how to spell words we create a sentence.

For example, I often struggle with 'b-e-l-i-e-v-e'

So I use this phrase 'never be***lie***ve a ***lie***'

3. To remember a new word like '***snorkelling***' I make sound associations.

I imagine a man snorkelling, but he fell asleep and died.

He '***snores***' (when asleep) and it is '***killing***' him.

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The Mind Palace

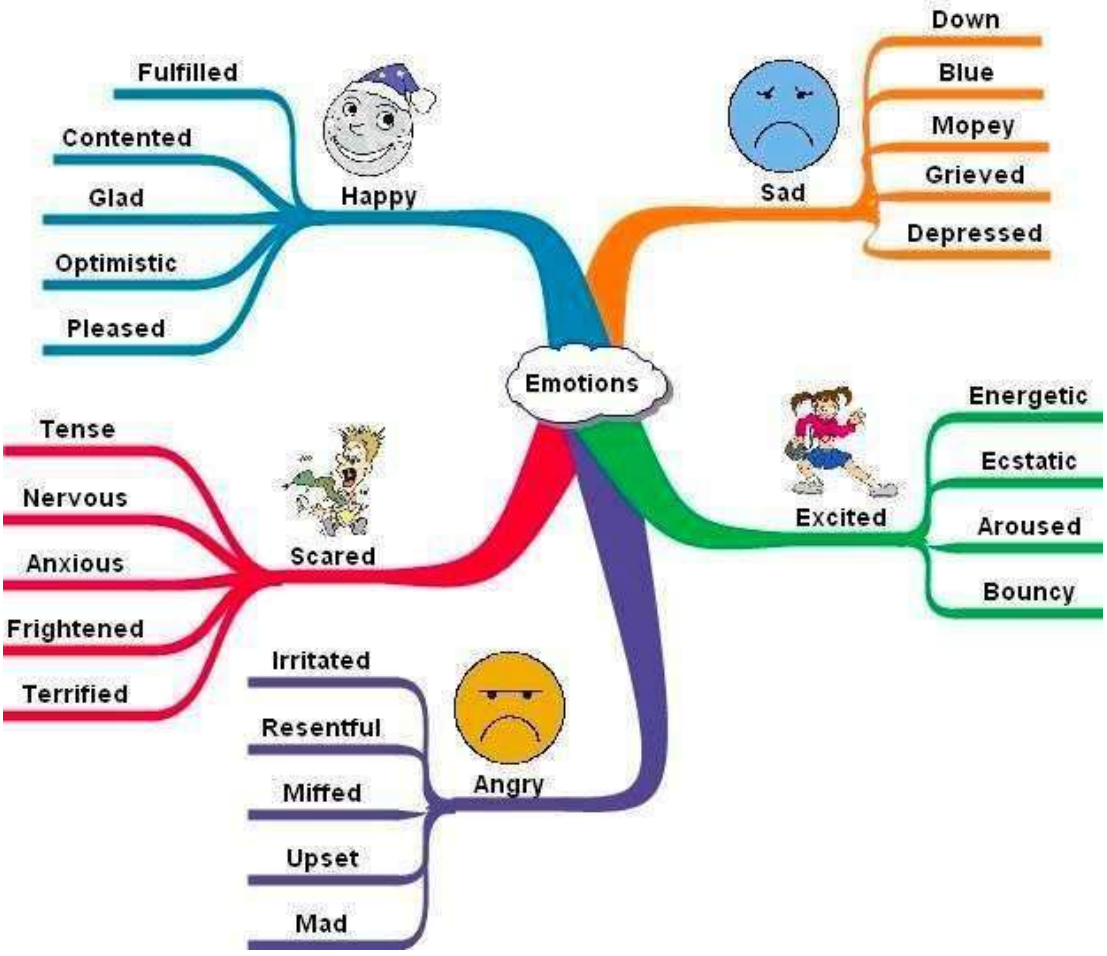
See this being used by **Sherlock Holmes** here
https://youtu.be/0FSKTndbwVo

So, here you imagine a house with many rooms.

You visualise each room and you 'put' a new word (from your word list) into each room.

Then you practice visiting each room and ‘collecting’ (repeating out loud) the word there.

Mind Maps



2. Focus on activating your passive vocabulary

Our vocabulary consists of

1) ***New*** *words (we don't even know yet)*
2) ***Passive*** *words (we recognise, but can't use yet)*
3) ***Active*** *words (we can use well)*

When we learn words, they pass from one stage to another (new to passive to active).

It takes time to become active, and so for you to be confident in using them.

Many students focus on just learning **new** and complicated **vocabulary**.

Usually, because they think this is needed to get a high score in IELTS speaking.

The problem is, when you start learning new, fancy words - they will be passive knowledge for some time.

Until you know how to use then effectively (i.e. they have become part of your active knowledge) - it is better not to use them in the test.

As a student, of course, you want to learn some new words, but

you should focus <u>most</u> of your time of trying to <u>activate</u> your passive words.

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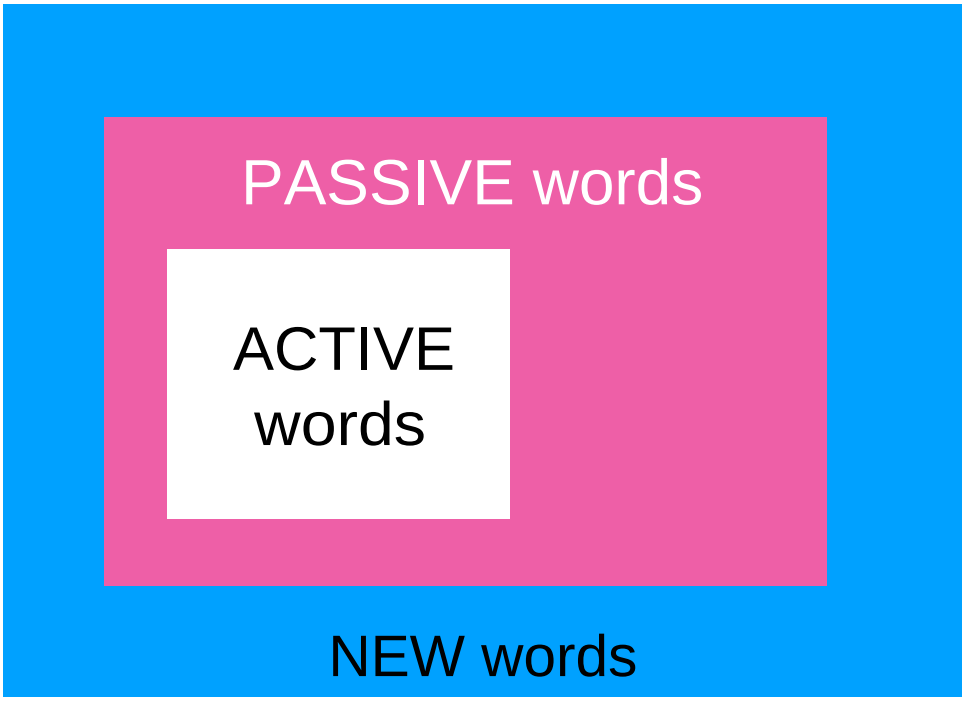
Why?

Because…

1) you are already familiar with the word (like a familiar face at a party)

2) it will become active *more quickly*

3) in the IELTS test you should mainly be using active vocabulary, otherwise you will make lots of mistakes (giving you a low score in Vocabulary)



So, as you can see in the diagram, spend more time, practicing passive vocabulary and making it active.

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3. How to activate vocabulary

Juggle

Imagine a new word is a ball.

You need to practice throwing it around, until you are comfortable with it.

That means, using it in short simple phrases, until you can use it effectively.

Lets take an **imaginary** word (this is not a real word)

To **sackle** = to meet *(for fun)*

*We can see the **meaning** = to meet*

*We can see the **use** = describes meeting someone to do a fun activity*

I sackl**ed** into my friend yesterday

*We can see the **grammar** of the word = it is **regular** in the past, and takes the **preposition 'into'***

Now let's **juggle**

Make a simple phrase with this word in

1) Present tense
2) Past tense
3) Present perfect tense

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For example…

I like to sackle
I often sackle into friends
I usually sackle into friends on the weekend

Yesterday I sackled
Yesterday I sackled into Tom
Last week I sackled into some college mates

I have not sackled much lately
I have never sackled at home
I haven’t sackled into Sarah for ages

Can you see what we are doing?

We are practicing the **pronunciation** and **use** of the word

By making sentences that are true, we are also **engaging** our brain in learning these words.

We are also **practicing** our **basic grammar** skills!

We can make simple phrases or more complex ones.

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3. Put word lists into ‘groups’

Take one of your word lists (for example these words on the topic of food).

White bread (n.)
Fresh Fruit (n.)
Sliced Ham (n.)
Cheese (n.)
Pizza (n.)
Olive Oil (n.)
Fish (n.)

Put them into a **group**.

For example, things *that you like* / *don’t like*

Speak out simple phrases, for example,

I like **fresh fruit**
I really like **sliced ham**
I quite like **cheese**
I love **pizza**

I am not so fond of **white bread**

Other groups might be,

- Sweet / savoury
- Good for you / bad for you
- Fresh / processed

Depending on the topic, you can create different groups.

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4. Learn collocations

When learning new words, we don't just want to learn individual words.

You want to know how to use it, so you should always learn ***collocations***

<u>Collocations</u> are words that are <u>usually used together</u>

For example,

We say,

White wine (NOT yellow wine)

Black tea (NOT red tea)

Heavy rain (NOT big rain)

Do Yoga (NOT make yoga)

So when we are practicing answering IELTS questions like the one below, we can first think of one word answers, but then start to brainstorm collocations.

What is the most important thing for a successful city?

Jobs
Pollution
Safet

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Using collocations….

Job creation
Job market
Job opportunities
Job security

Air pollution
Water pollution
We need to combat pollution

Public safety

If you are not sure which words are collocations, you can use a collocation dictionary like Ozdic.

www.ozdic.com

Don’t try to learn all the collocations at once.

There are too many.

Just choose one or two.

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5. Test yourself

It is so important to test yourself.

Test the new words you have been learning.

This **challenges** you, **engages** your brain, and is a **powerful** way to **review** words, and also learn them **more deeply**.

There is a lot of research on the power of *assessment (tests) for learning.*

This is worth understanding if you are a teacher

https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0191491X11000149

https://www.teachingenglish.org.uk/article/assessment-learning

So how can you test yourself?

Cover and test

- Take a list of words with definitions
- Cover the words
- Read the definition then say the word aloud
- Check your answer

Write a test

- Make a test, maybe Multiple Choice
- Wait one day
- Test yourself

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Use your family

- Get a member of your family to test you

Use flashcard tests

QUIZLET is a great source of flashcards, or you can make your own.

Then you can try, learning, games, tests….and other features.

https://quizlet.com/

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Live Lesson Notes

Listening Skills
10 Useful Tips

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with my Udemy online course

IELTS Speaking Success - Get a Band 7+

TODAY'S RIDDLE

What occurs once in a **m**inute, twice in a **mom**ent and never in one **thousand years?**

Answer: The letter "M."

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Some useful Links

TED talks with transcripts
https://www.ted.com/talks

British Council Listening Materials
https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/skills/listening

British Council Listening Test
https://takeielts.britishcouncil.org/take-ielts/prepare/free-ielts-practice-tests/listening/section-1

The Fluency Gym
https://ieltsspeakingsuccess.com/free-ielts-speaking-practice-online-fluency-gym/

Get a complete Mock IELTS Test.
Use the CODE: **keith10** to get a 10% **discount**.

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Listening Skills

There are two main skills to develop

1. Listening for **detail**

(e.g. phone numbers, a street name, a time…)

2. Listening for **gist**

(e.g. A person is complaining in a hotel, two people are arguing about politics…)

The **gist** = the main idea or general meaning

I get the gist = I understand the main idea

We had technical problems in today's class, but the great thing was it produced a new idiom!!

I am going to ***vote with my feet!***

= I am going to leave!

You might have voted with your feet, when I had technical problems in today's class

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Tips

1. Be comfortable not understanding everything!

You will most likely never understand everything, so relax and don't stress just because you can't understand everything you hear.

Focus on what you can understand, not what you can't.

When you listen for gist, you actually don't need to understand every word.

In addition, if you always look up lots of words when listening, you will build vocabulary, rather than build your listening skills.

When listening to stuff at home, be clear about your goal.

Do you want to increase your vocabulary or improve your listening?
I suggest you just choose one goal each time you 'do listening'.

2. Use context (pictures, text/transcript/questions) and activate schemata (existing knowledge).

That means when you look at the questions in IELTS Listening, think about the ideas and language you know on that topic. Ask yourself,

"What do already know about this topic?"

For example, for this question below…

QUESTIONS: TRANSPORT FROM BAYSWATER

1. Express train leaves at (1) .....
2. Nearest station is (2) .....
3. Number 706 bus goes to (3) .....
4. Number (4) ..... bus goes to station
5. Earlier bus leaves at (5) .....

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…we activated (or brainstormed) the following;

Means of transport include, trains, coaches, buses, ferries, express trains.

Trains leave from ***platforms***

Ferries leave from ***terminals***

Official (train) times are said like this '16:05' (not like this '5 past 4')

We have ***peak times*** *for travelling - and* ***off-peak times****.*

Peak times are ***more expensive*** *than off-peak*

Destination

Departure times, arrival times

3. Develop your **noticing skills**

When practicing listening skills, you should try to **notice** the following things

1. **Word stress**
2. **Chunks**
3. **Weak forms**
4. **Contractions**
5. **Connected Speech**

When you listen, you can stop the audio and try to notice and pick out these features.
If you have the transcript, you can listen again and read at the same time to see where these feature happen.

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Let's take a simple example of a sentence from the IELTS listening above.

That'll get you there in under an hour

You can listen to it here

https://takeielts.britishcouncil.org/take-ielts/prepare/free-ielts-practice-tests/listening/section-1

This phrase is here at 2 mins. 25 secs.

1. Word stress

That'll get you there in under an hour

We can hear the stressed words 'there', 'hour' and possibly also 'under'.

Focusing and noticing **only** the stressed words is a key way to get the general meaning.

2. Chunks

Chunks are pieces of language, made up usually of two of three words.

In our example, there are two chunks.

CHUNK 1 - That'll get you there
CHUNK 2 - in under an hour

When we notice chunks, it helps us focus on the **sounds**, rather than the words. This helps us listen to longer pieces more easily, as we are not '**stuck'** at each word.

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You can practice listening to and speaking out chunks in the **Fluency Gym**

https://ieltsspeakingsuccess.com/free-ielts-speaking-practice-online-fluency-gym/

3. Weak forms

Many of the following have 2 pronunciations.

One is a **strong** form and the other is a **weak** form.

Auxiliaries (be, do, have, can…)

Personal pronouns (you, he, she…)

Prepositions (to, at, of, for…)

Conjunctions (and, but, than…)

We use the **strong** form when we **stress** that word.

E.g. I **do** like pizza.

Do is pronounced /duː/

*But most of the time, these words are **not stressed**, and so use the weak form*

E.g. **Do** you like pizza?

Do is pronounced /də/

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Coming back to our sentence…

*That'll get **you** there in under **an** hour*

You is not stressed and weak, pronounced /jə /

An is not stressed and weak, pronounced /ən/

That'll get **/jə** / there in under **ən/** hour

4. Contractions

When we speaking we nearly always use contractions.

I will = I'll
I would = I'd
I would have = I'd've

We can hear this in our example sentence.

That'll get you there in under an hour

5. Connected speech

The final big thing that makes listening extremely difficult is connected speech.

If you can crack this, your listening skills will rocket.

RULE:

When a word ends with a consonant sound and the next word begins with a vowel sound, we usually connect the two words.

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In the first chunk you can see a link between GET and YOU

That'll **get_you** there

In the second chunk you can see a link between IN and UNDER, UNDER and AN, and finally AN and HOUR.

in_under_an_hour

Whenever you hear connected speech, notice it and try repeating it.

4. Train your memory processing time (to make it longer)

In IELTS listening we have to listen for details, often numbers or the spelling of a name.

Our brain works like this; we hear, understand, store the information, produce it (usually writing).

A simple way to train this skill is record yourself saying a series of numbers (or letters) with increasing difficulty.

Play the recording non-stop, and try to write down the numbers.

For example,

84
7253
901 56 79
534 87 24 03
679 21 54 62 89

Do the same with letters (BUT NOT WORDS YOU KNOW)

R-I-G
T-I-G-G-L-E
F-I-S-T-L-E-T-O-N
H-O-P-P-L-E-S-T-A-N
P-A-S-T-O-R-S-H-I-P-E-D

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VARIETY IS THE KEY TO IMPROVING YOUR LISTENING

5. Listen to all levels

Listen to material **lower than your level,** to build confidence and fluency.

This is really good when noticing weak forms, connected speech….

Listen to material at the **same**, or **higher**, **than your level**

Try the resources here.

https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/skills/listening

6. Listen to all speeds

You can change the speed in Youtube videos in the navigation bar below the video.

Listen to **slow English** for confidence and fluency!

Try the audios from

www.esl.culips.com

Listen to **fast English** to improve your processing skills.

Find examples of native speaker content Check out the 'useful podcasts' recommended here

https://ieltsspeakingsuccess.com/resources-courses-e-books-tips/

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7. Listen Intensively (short clips 3 mins) and Extensively (long clips +30 mins)

Listening to short clips intensively helps you develop your 'listening for details' skills.

Listening to longer clips helps you develop your 'listening for gist' skills, as well as building your stamina, so you can stay focussed throughout the IELTS Listening test.

8. Listen to different genres and topics

Check out LingQ

www.lingq.com

or go through my referral (same for you but I earn points to my account!)

https://www.lingq.com/?referral=keitho123

This is a programme for language learning, but it has thousands of audio clips, with transcripts, that you can access for free. It also covers a wide range of topics and genres.

The first thing they do when you register is ask you what topics you are interested in.

This way, you can access a variety of content.

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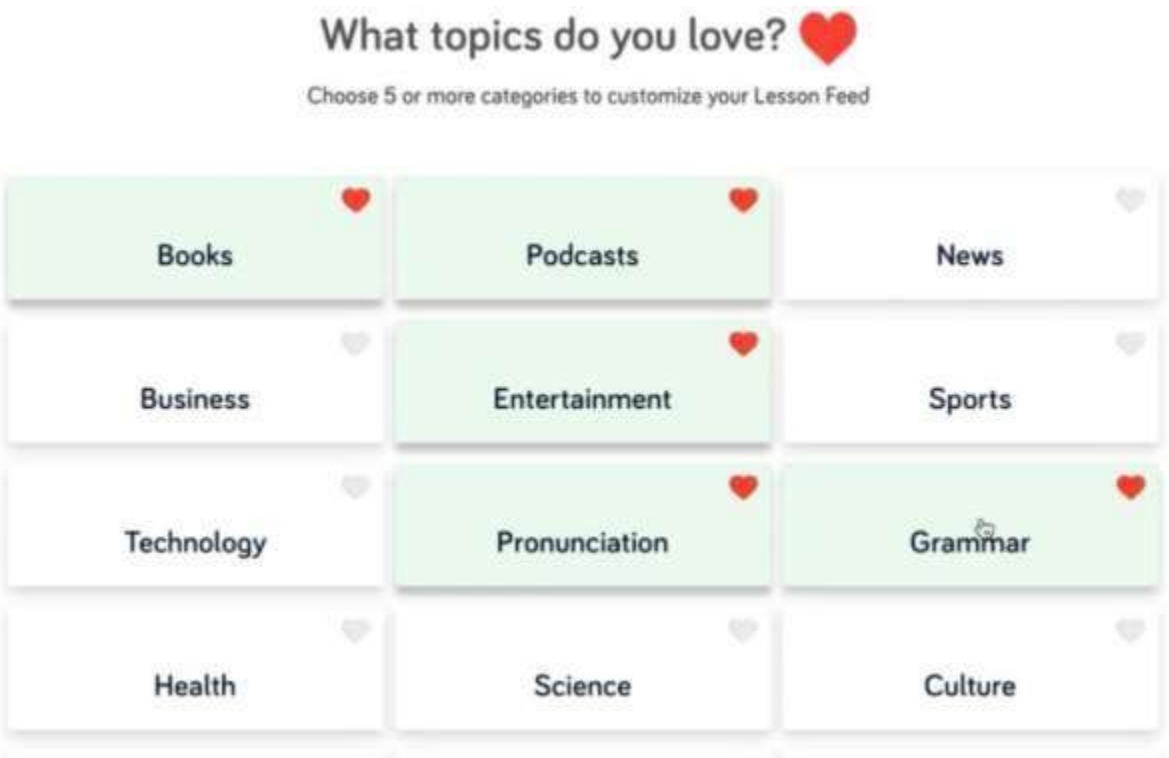

You can pay to join if you want to follow their complete course, but you can access lots of listening content for free!

Lyrics Training https://lyricstraining.com/

English Central https://www.englishcentral.com/

Elllo http://elllo.org

ESOL courses https://www.esolcourses.com

ESLvideo.com

9. Listen to different accents

In IELTS listening, you need to be familiar with at least the main native-speaker accents of English; American, Canadian, British, Irish, Australian, and New Zealand.

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Remember these countries have lots of very different accents within each country, so look for as wide a variety as possible.

So actively search for videos and podcasts that expose you to these accents.

Some interesting podcasts here focusing on accents.

FM player - https://player.fm/podcasts/Accent

Try a free **radio app** with International stations and then tune into programmes from around the world.

I have used these before (available from Apple or Google Play stores)

Simple Radio

FM Player

10. Enjoy yourself

There is a lot of research shows that you learn more when you are relaxed and enjoying what you do.

You can read about Krashen's Affective Filter here - https://www.sk.com.br/sk-krash-english.html

Stress blocks learning.

So, as well as doing IELTS Practice tests, which are a great idea, you should also choose lots of stuff that you will enjoy listening to (and yes, that includes songs too).

Get a balance between what is good for you (variety of topics, levels and accents) and what you enjoy.

It's a bit like a healthy diet, right?

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Eat a variety of stuff, some healthy and some that you just love.

Just get a balance.

Now go to it….

Go and listen to something and improve your listening skills.

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IELTS Speaking Success

Maps and getting lost

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with my Udemy online course

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THE RIDDLE
What is black and white and read all over?

Answer: A newspaper

IELTS QUESTIONS

Please note, in Part 3 the examiner is free to make up a lot of the questions.

So, it is difficult to predict exactly what questions you will get.

Questions listed here are the kind of questions you may be asked.

You may get different questions.

Some useful Links

Click to get a complete **Mock IELTS** Test.
https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

Use the CODE: **keith10** to get a 10% discount.

Free **IELTS Listening** course from the British Council
https://www.futurelearn.com/courses/understanding-ielts-listening

Free **IELTS Writing** course from the British Council
https://www.futurelearn.com/courses/understanding-ielts-writing

Find a teacher so you can start practicing all the language you are learning here. Practice is the key!
https://bit.ly/IELTSSpeakingitalki

Collect my free materials here and make a donation to support more free materials (if you can)
https://ieltsspeakingsuccess.com/ielts-speaking-free-live-lessons/

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https://www.instagram.com/ieltsspeakingsuccess/

youtube.com/c/IELTSSpeakingSuccess

Part 3

Techniques

Develop your answers

For example, give

1) Opinion
2) Reason
3) Example

Speak generally, not just about you and your life.

Avoid giving lists

Go into details

Give very specific examples

The examiner will listen to what you say and often make up the next question based on what you said.

Don’t worry if the examiner cuts you off. It’s normal.

Part 2 CUE CARD

Describe a time you got lost in a place that you don't know

PART 3 QUESTIONS

Are maps important for travelling?

Why do some people never use maps?

How has the way we find directions changed over time?

Do some people have the skills to find directions faster than others?

Part 3

Are maps important for travelling?

Note: this is a common Part 3 question type.

Are_____important for_____?

You can sometimes use a template like this to answer it.

'It depends ..
If…
On the other hand, if….'

A place you **know like the back of your hand** (=know very well)

Help you **find your way** / orientate yourself

Especially for places (where) I have never been before

I have a **terrible sense of direction**, so yes, I need a map

Useful for planning your **itinerary** / your **journey**

Nowadays, we have websites where you can use **digital maps** to plan your route / journey, book hotels, and that,

and then share your itinerary **in real time** (=live, as it happens) with friends on social media

If we are talking about digital maps - like google maps - they are

-useful

-invaluable

-worth their weight in gold (= very useful)

However, if we are talking about paper maps - without a compass, they are

-pretty useless

-a waste oftime

- ineffective

- worthless

Why do some people never use maps?

Note: this is also a common Part 3 question type.

Why do some people_____?

For this kind of question, you can think about WHICH PEOPLE you want to talk bout.
This will help you focus and answer more easily, as well as helping yo show off a wider range of vocabulary.

If we are talking about….

- Holiday-makers

- Tourists

- Millennials

- Retired people / **folk**

Maybe they **have a good sense of direction**

Some people like to **wing it** (not to plan = to improvise)

Some people prefer to **play it by ear** (not to plan = to improvise)

Point me in the direction of.. (= to show me the way to…)

Google maps is useful to **point me in the direction of** local coffee shops.

Retired folk might need **reading glasses**

They find GPS maps on phones **too fiddly** (=detailed and difficult to use)

The user interface is too

complex (=complicated)

clumsy (=too big and difficult to use)

fiddly (=detailed and difficult to use)

Maybe they are **technophobes (= a person who hates technology)**

Actually I reckon most people do use maps nowadays - especially digital ones such as GPS devices

How has the way we find directions changed over time?

In days gone by **(=in the past)…**

We used to..

ask people the way

ask people **for** direction**s**

We even used the sun to know where north was.

Now, it has become **digitalised**

We have become rather **over-dependent** on GPS tools

Nowadays, **not only** can we find directions, **we can also** find restaurants, museums, in fact **you name it**, almost **anything** in the **vicinity** / **in that area**

Not only + inversion_____, we also….

Not only do we use google maps to find our way, **we also use** it to find local restaurants or other facilities.

in fact **you name it** = everything

Do some people have the skills to find directions faster than others?

I guess some people have an **innate** sense of direction

Innate *= something you are born with, natural*

Some people are **quick off their feet** and can find their way instantly.

Others **are prone to** getting lost

*To **be prone to** = to be likely to suffer from (negative)*

E.g. 'I am prone to accidents / headaches'

'He is prone to getting lost'

Others are, you might say, '**directionally challenged'**

We use this form of

Adverb + challenged

in a humorous way to talk about people who find something difficult or are bad at something.

It is euphemistic.

For example ,

I am **directionally challenged** = I am terrible at finding the way

I am **vertically challenged** = I am short

I am **intellectually challenged** = I am stupid

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Money

Click on this picture to study with me!

What you will learn:

Useful Links
Warm Up Questions
Essential Money Vocabulary
Do You Like to Buy Expensive Things?
Expensive Activities
More Idioms About Money
Model Answers

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Useful Links

Great article and videos about **who controls the finances** in the family
http://www.abc.net.au/news/2018-03-02/questions-to-ask-your- partner-about-money/9349162

A video about what the wealthy teach this children

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of MONEY, you will learn how to talk about making, saving and spending money.

Watch the complete video about this topic of money here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of phones that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Are you good at saving money?

Did you save money as a child?

Is money important?

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Essential Money Vocabulary

By careful to use the right collocations when learning and practicing new vocabulary.

See the examples below. We start with the most common mistake…

I gain money X

I earn money (by working / *by adding value*)

I win money (by gambling at a casino)

The following are more collocations and expressions you may use with 'money'.

You can make money, if you invest wisely

You can earn a fortune, if you are lucky

You can donate money (to charity)

The following 4 expressions mean

"He spends a lot"

He is a spendthrift

He spends money like nobody's business

She spends money like there is no tomorrow

He has more money than sense

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The following expressions mean

"*It **was** expensive"*

It cost an arm and a leg

It cost a fortune

I paid over the odds

I paid through the nose

They charged an exorbitant price

These expressions can be used to say something is cheap.

It is going for a song

It is dirt cheap
(=very cheap)

It is dead *(=very)* cheap

It is cheap as chips

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Do You Like to Buy Expensive Things?

The following are all related to spending a lot of money

I like to fork out **on** gifts

I like splash out **on** clothes

I am happy to dig deep (**into** my pockets) and buy expensive things, if they are value for money.

I often splurge out **on** new books

I tend to spend lavishly when it comes to clothes shopping

The following are all related to NOT spending a lot of money

Yes, but I need to keep an eye on my wallet

No, I can't afford it

No, I am a bit strapped for cash at the moment
(= don't have much money)

I am on a tight budget at the moment

I am on a shoestring budget
(= don't have much money)

No, I am quite frugal / thrifty
(=careful with money)

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Expensive Activities

What activities would you say are expensive?

Some **sports** need pricey equipment, like golf, paragliding, scuba-diving.

Travelling can be expensive, especially if you go in first class.

International **travel** can cost a lot too.

Taking a **holiday** can cost an arm and a leg, especially when you stay in 5 star hotels

Collecting things (e.g. classic cars, antiques in general…) can be expensive

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More Idioms About Money

The following are all idiomatic expressions or idioms on the topic of money.

Which of the following are true for you?

I am a bargain hunter
(= like looking for things that are good value for money)

I love to splash out when I go shopping for clothes

I like to save for a rainy day

Right now, I know someone who is living on a shoestring

I don't have enough money to make ends meet
(= to get by or to survive)

We had to live from hand to mouth
(=had little money)

I am strapped for cash these days
(=have little money)

He's rolling in it
(=he is very rich/ he is loaded)

I am going to splash / fork out on a new computer
(=spend a lot of money)

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Model Answers

Q1: Do you think it is ok to lend money to friends or family members?

A:

Well, I think, **by and large**, I think, it's absolutely fine to lend money to friends or family members.

I know some people **have reservations about** doing that, but for me friends and family members, when they are in need or if they need a **helping hand,**

then, you know, I think we should be the first person to help them out.

So, if a…., my brother or my sister asks for money, I would probably **go ahead** and lend it to them.

Provided, I had enough money to do that, I mean, I wouldn't **put myself in debt** and **go into the red** in order to help them by lending them money.

So, it would have to be some money I **had put away** or **put aside** and then I were free to use and help them out.

So, for me, I think it's absolutely fine to do that.

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Q2. Is money everything to you?

A:

OK, not at all, **by no means**, **by no stretches of the imagination**.

Whilst on the one hand, I think money is important, we need enough money to buy clothes and food and to enjoy a comfortable lifestyle and may be it's nice to **splash out** every once in a while and **treat yourself to something specia**l, maybe, some clothes or something similar, but for me, certainly money is not everything.

I think, there are much more important things in life, such as relationships with friends and family, enjoying the little things or the little moments in life.

I know it's a bit of the cliché, **but** smelling the flowers, a beautiful view, watching a funny moment where the kitten is rolling on the floor playing with the wool.

Those are also very important things.

So, **whilst I think** money is important, **it's not** the most important thing for me.

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Q3. Is it good to buy products from famous brands?

A:

OK, **I am not one for** buying famous brands, partly, because they are so expensive, but also because expensive things **are no guarantee of** high quality.

Sometimes, you can **fork out a lot of money on** an expensive brand and **end up** being really disappointed with the **shabby quality** of the product that you get.

Now, if you are very rich and somebody who **spends money like there is no tomorrow**, then it's absolutely fine to buy products with famous brands.

In fact, I think, a lot of those people don't care so much about the quality, but rather they focus on **showing off the brand** to other people.

It's almost like a **status symbol** and so, I guess, in some respects, you are paying for that status symbol, rather than paying for the quality of the item that you are buying.

So, as with many questions, it depends on who is **doing the purchasing.**

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MUSIC

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POSSIBLE IELTS QUESTIONS on this topic

Part 1

Do you like to listen to music?
Do you play a musical instrument?
What kind of music do you listen to?

Part 2

Describe a singer or a band that you like

Part 3

Music and children
Is music useful for children?
Should children be forced to learn music at school?
Are there any disadvantages of music being a subject at school?

Music industry
Is music an art form?
How has the music industry changed in recent years?
How will the way we access music change in the future?

Some useful Links

26 *Genres of Music* in Alphabetical Order
https://youtu.be/A_ZatuoalP0

Lyrics Training is a game-based approach to *learning English with song lyrics.*
https://lyricstraining.com

A great introduction to *instruments of the orchestra* and you can actually listen to the sounds of each one. If you are a parent, great to teach your kids with too.
https://www.mydso.com/dso-kids/learn-and-listen/instruments

The best and most complete list of *Music* vocabulary you will find on the Internet.
https://www.englishclub.com/vocabulary/music-vocabulary.htm

VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS

Music (uncountable noun)

Note:
You **cannot** say, 'I like many musics' **X**
You should say 'I like many **kinds of music**' ✅

Musicians (person) - amateur / professional
Musical (adj.) - instruments / family / expression
Musical (n.) - broadway / popular

Favourite artists / singer / singer songwriter / band / group

Types of music

Pop
Rap - Hip Hop
Alternative - Indie
Blues
Rock
Country
Jazz
Classical - opera - film soundtracks

Ways to say LIKE

I am a big fan of jazz
I am really into jazz
I am one for jazz

I can't get enough of jazz
I really dig jazz
I am passionate about jazz

I hate musicals
I can't stand musicals
I can't be doing with musicals

I **have** unusual **taste in** music

Ways to say GOOD AT

I **have a flair for** playing the guitar

I **have a knack for** playing the violin
My friends say I **am talented** at the violin
I am quite **handy** with the violin

Useful Vocabulary

Lyrics (Pl. n.)

Lyrical (adj.)

Instruments (n.)

Melody (n.) - captivating, bouncy, up-beat, catchy

Melodious (adj.)

Harmony (n.)

Rhythm (the beat). Catchy, up-beat, slow, lazy

Acoustic (adj.) guitar
They played acoustic (play unplugged)

Acoustics (n. Pl)
The acoustics in this concert hall are fantastic / out of this world!

Catchy (adj.) - song, melody, tune

Melodious (adj). Voice

Up-beat - lively, fast-paced

Idiomatic expressions

It's **going for a song** (=cheap)

It's **music to my ears** (=good news)

We have to **face the music** (=face a difficult situation you have created)

Blow your own trumpet (praise yourself, brag, boast)

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Nations and Culture

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Some useful Links

Find **word families** with the **Longman** online dictionary
https://www.ldoceonline.com/dictionary/culture

Link to interesting video on what it means to be British
Watch here

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General Vocabulary

How can you increase your vocabulary 3 or 4 times?

Learn ***Word Families***

When you learn a new word, at the same time, learn the other parts of speech (the 'word family'), such as noun, verb, adjective, adverb…

culture (n.)

cultural (adj.)

cultured (adj.) - well-educated, well-read, intelligent, polite

culturally (adv.)

1. Touching a child's head is culturally unacceptable

2. In my culture it is rude to ask someone their age

3. He is a very well-behaved and cultured person

Great tool to find Word Families is this online dictionary from Longman
https://www.ldoceonline.com/dictionary/culture

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More examples

Noun	Person	Adjective
Nation	Nationalist *(s.o. who supports their country, often to the exclusion of other nations)*	Nationalistic National
Patriotism	Patriot *(s.o. who loves their country)*	Patriotic
Stereotype *(a bias or generalisation, that may not be true)*		Stereotypical

What is culture?

Customs, behaviour, traditions, language, festivals, food, literature,

norms, a set of norms, values, a set of values, rituals, social events

Culture **moulds** peoples' lives

Culture **brings harmony** and uniformity to some extent

Many countries have a **fusion of cultures** or a **blend of cultures**

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*To give **your personal opinion**, you can say:*

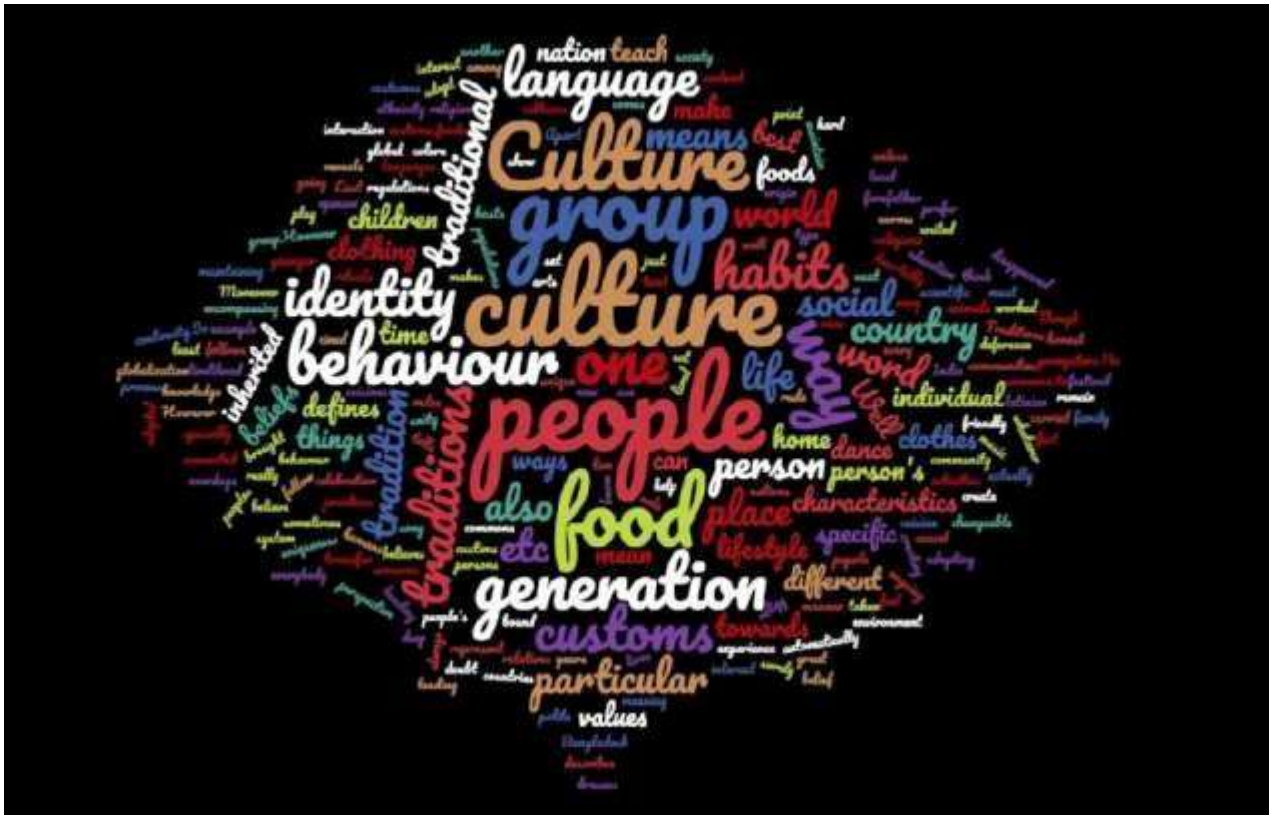
For me,

From my perspective,

From my point of view,

Personally speaking,

Word cloud from your answers in the FB group



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Other useful expressions to talk about culture….

You can substitute the underlined words for any of the words above about culture.

Culture is **all about** behaviour

It's **a way of life** related to food

It's **the way of** behaving

It's **a set o**f behaviours

Culture is **connected to** traditions

It's r**elated to** our customs

Globalisation **cancels** local cultures

Passed from one generation to the next

It's what makes us unique

Cultural diversity
= *a mix of cultures and races in a country or organisation.*

A melting pot
= *a mix of cultures and races in a country or organisation.*

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Nations - what does it mean to be British?

Integral (adj.) = important, necessary

Watching football is an integral part of being Spanish!

Quintessential (adj.) = the perfect example

A quintessential part of being British is our love of dogs!

*This is a very hard question to answer without using **stereotypes** or **generalisations** that may not be true.*
In the video, I show 10 stereotypes and ask 'which do you think are true for me?'

The answers (and answers) were:

1. I queue for the bus T
2. I live in England F
3. I don't talk to people on the train T
4. I drink tea at 11 T
5. I speak like the queen F. (RP)
6. I value diversity T
7. I carry an umbrella everywhere F
8. I drink tea at 5 F
9. I value democracy T
10. I eat fish and chips F

T - True
F = False

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How can we learn about other countries?

We can learn from the Internet and also from reading books.

When we visit another country that is a chance to learn about that nation and its culture.

At times, we may meet nationals living or travelling abroad, and we can learn about their culture directly from watching their behaviour and listening to them.

I learn lots about other countries by listening to radio programmes about those countries.

Probably the most powerful way to learn about another country is to live or work there. You pick up so much more when you are participating in everyday life there.

Model Answers

Notice, my speech is not in perfect sentences. If you write your answers out in perfect sentences, it will not sound natural, it will sound like you are a book!
Avoid *writing your answer out first, before speaking it.*

Q1. Why do we have to preserve cultures?

This is an interesting question, because the question assumes we have to preserve culture. You can disagree with this assumption, if you want! Don't feel you have to agree with the examiner!

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A1.

Well, I think there are **several aspects** of our culture that are **well worth preserving** and some of those are traditional aspects.

I think, you know, customs around birthday celebrations, wedding celebrations, Christmas celebrations,

the way that we bring together family to celebrate certain days in our culture, is a really good thing to do,

and one that we should **make an effort to** preserve because I think it helps bring family unity and **stronger bonding** within the society.

At the same time, there are certain aspects of culture that maybe we don't have to preserve.

Its inevitable for me, I think culture is **fluid** and forever changing, and to try and **stick rigidly to** tradition doesn't really work either.

So, we have to be **a little bit** flexible in our approach to culture and not preserve things just **for the sake of** preserving them.

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Q2. Do you have any national heritage in your country?

A2.

It's a very good question and I think the answer is **yes we do.**

For example, there is a very, very famous monument, **if you like**, or an area called Stonehenge.

It's **a historical site.** It's actually **preserved by UNESCO** as a heritage site.

It's an area that dates back, and **I am by no means an expert,** but I think it dates back thousands of years and it's just a group of_____or stones,

and some people think it was **an area where** the Pagans **would** pray to Gods and other scientists and anthropologists have different ideas.

I think **another aspect of** our heritage in the UK is our music,

and going back to the Beatles, who were hugely popular in the 1960s,

and the more contemporary bands like Oasis or Blur, who were all the rage in the 1990s,

dating up to even today where you've got some famous rappers who are British

and the name of, the name of the one I am thinking about **has just slipped my mind**, but not to worry.

So, I think music also is actually an interesting part of the **national heritage** in my country.

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Q3. How has globalisation affected local culture over the years?

With general questions like this, it can help you to be very specific and to choose one area to focus on.

A3.

Well, I think an interesting part of local cultures that has changed is food, and the **whole food industry.**

Globalisation has created **international food chains**, lots of **franchises** of restaurants such as MacDonald's and KFC,

typically, kind of, not good quality food and these have **penetrated countries and local cultures** all over the world,

causing local people often **to opt for** the globalised, international food rather than their local food,

and so as cooking and recipes used **to get handed down** from generation to generation, now, many local recipes are disappearing.

People are going to the fast food restaurants and it's having a really negative impact on **local cuisine**

and the **whole culinary traditions** around cooking and preparing food in families in local cultures.

So, I think that's an important area where globalisation has impacted local cultures.

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News

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Some useful Links

Great website for teachers and students with new lessons about breaking news every week.
https://breakingnewsenglish.com

Study the news and the language of the news with the BBC
https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/lingohack

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General Vocabulary

Avoid this common mistake!

I heard a news yesterday X

You should say -

I've got some/little news 😁
I haven't got any/much news 😁

So, remember - News is uncountable!

How to make it singular?

A piece of news!

(remember the spelling by thinking of PIEce of PIE!)

An **item** of news

Tons of news, a bit of news, a plethora of news

COLLOCATIONS

Adjectives

Breaking news / latest news / urgent news
Updated news / out-dated news
Good news / great news / tremendous news
Unwelcome news / devastating news / traumatic news
Fake news

Verbs

To get / receive news
To hear some news
To catch up on the news
I want to catch up on all your latest news
=get up to date

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Great **source of collocations** is
http://www.ozdic.com/collocation-dictionary/news

More examples

1. I heard some _gloomy, happy, **breaking *(=brand new)*____**news yesterday

2. Have you _seen, heard, read, caught up on____the latest news?

3. The news is _spreading___like wildfire!

4. This is___breaking, brand new____news, it has just been released!

Kinds of news

International or foreign
National or domestic
Local

Personal news (news about your family, friends, neighbours…)

Think of the typical greeting cards to get ideas of personal news.
(marriage, birthday, pass exams, funeral, new born baby….(

Have you heard, Tom has passed his IELTS test?
I heard that Tom is getting married?
I've just found out Alice is pregnant
They have just had a new baby boy!
They have invited me to the christening

Websites to study the topic of NEWS

https://breakingnewsenglish.com

https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/lingohack

https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/news-report

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Part 2

Tell me about some news you heard about recently

Many IELTS speaking questions are deliberately open!

You can talk about national, domestic, local or even personal news.

So long as you talk about some NEWS, and it is something you HEARD and it was RECENT (so not in your childhood!).

Don't worry too much about right and wronganswers.

1 minute preparation tips

1. Get the first idea (good enough)
2. Get 2 or 3 main points
3. If time think of an Idiom or some Collocations

Watch the video to see my give an example

Will the examiner give bad band score for pauses?

No, but be clear about the difference between pause and hesitation.

Pause 😃
A pause if where you stop talking to think of ideas. This is good!

Hesitation ☹️
A hesitation is where you errr and umm, whilst trying to find the correct word. This will bring down your fluency score.

I have a series of 6 videos explaining approaches to all different categories of PART 2 questions. Check it out on YOUTUBE.

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Do you believe everything you read?

"No I don't of course - some of them can be economical with the truth or lie through their teeth."

To be **economical with the truth**
= *not tell the whole truth*

You can also say (meaning the same)

This story is **stretching the truth**

To lie through one's teeth
- *to clearly lie without trying to hide it*

You can also say (meaning the same)

They are **telling blatant lies**

They are **telling outright lies**

"No, I don't. Due to the reason that some articles available online aren't reliable. Some are fake news."

Reliable (adj.) = trustworthy, credible, dependable

"I tend to check everything from some alternative sources"

Some information is misleading, so we have to be careful

I am always wary of *(=cautious about, careful with)* stories that paint things black and white (=say things are simple)

A rule of thumb *(informal rule)* is to be suspicious **of** *(=wary of)* stories shared on social media like Facebook

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It's hard to know for sure, because everyone has their own agenda *(=have your own objective/goal)*

Generally yes, if the sources are really reliable - credible enough.

It depends on the source of the news and how authentic they are.

If it's convincing enough but I would like to discover some reliable evidence first.

No, I don't. It seems good journalism is vanishing these days.

No, because some news agencies are altering the real stories.

Many media platforms tell lies.

Irrespective of the truth, I just enjoy news.

You can express uncertainty by saying…

I have mixed feelings about it.

I am on the fence.

I am in in two minds about it.

A great source of questions and answers is the **Quora** forum. Good for language. It is an open forum, so the facts may not be always correct.

https://www.quora.com/Do-you-believe-everything-that-you-read

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Model Answers

Tip

When speaking, we often **personalise** our speech.

We may use expressions as below to do this.

“to be honest, I know, you know, the way I see it, I think, my take is…”

SPOKEN

I know some people say that clothes represent your identity and its a way of expressing your personality, **but to be honest, for me**, **I take** a much more pragmatic *(=realistic)* approach**.**

WRITTEN

It is said some people say that clothes represent your identity and its a way of expressing your personality, **however my approach** is much more pragmatic

TIP:

If you write your answers out in perfect sentences, it will not sound natural, it will sound like you are a book!

Don’t write your answer out first,

Speak your answer first, then record it, then write it out.

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Q1. Do you think newspapers will be replaced by computers someday?

A1.

It's an interesting question. **To some extent,** I think, newspapers have already been replaced by computers.

I think we are living in a **digital world** where more and more people are **accessing information online**

and so they would rather **get** the **latest news** through social media, like Facebook, or **through newspapers** websites on the internet.

So, I said to some extent, because **what's also happening at the same time**, is that the newspapers and the **media outlets** are moving from the paper to the digital source.

So, papers still exist and I think they will always exist.

I don't think **it's black and white** *(=very simple)*. I don't think we have to choose from one or the other. I think it will be **a blend of** *(=a mix of)* paper, physical newspapers and online newspapers.

Yes, so, to be honest, I don't think it's a question of replacing one by the other.

I think both will continue to exist but people are **more likely to access the news** through the computer, in the future.

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Q2. Do you think getting updated news is important?

A2.

To be honest, for me, I think, getting updated news is **overrated** *(=not as good as people think)*

I think we have been pushed into this society where the **breaking news** or the **latest gossip** is the most important and the most valuable,

but I think it's **nonsense**.

I think the most valuable information is not necessarily the latest or the most updated, and it just pushes us to **follow fashions** and **trends** all the time.

So, I am actually **an advocate** *(= a person in favour of)* of not following the latest news.

I think you can **pick out** *(=choose)* pieces of news or items of news that are relevant and useful for you,

but I don't think we should be **dragged along with this current** *(here I am just using a metaphor of a river)* of always chasing of the latest news.

It's just **media hype** that is there, to try and get us to buy newspapers or information.

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Some useful Links

Find **word families** with the **Longman** online dictionary
https://www.ldoceonline.com/dictionary/culture

Link to interesting video on what it means to be British
Watch here

Click to get a complete **Mock IELTS** Test.
https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

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General Vocabulary

My morning was full of noise pollution!

Workers **ringing** the door bells
Dogs **barking, yelping**
Construction workers **drilling**
Workers **shouting**

A **ca<u>co</u>phony** of sounds
= *a mix of different noises sounding terrible*

They made such a **racket**
= *a terrible noise*

A noise…is a sound, especially one that is loud and disturbs. Which noise do you really NOT like?

Noises from PEOPLE

Shouting
Screaming
Crying
Bad singing (in the **Karaoke**)
Music **on the loud speaker** of a mobile
People **eating**, chewing, slurping, munching, chomping

Snoring and grinding your teeth when sleeping

Noises from ANIMALS

The **rooster** / cock in the morning
Mosquitoes **buzzing** around my ear at night
Dogs **barking**

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Noises from THINGS

Alarm clocks
Thunder, storms and lightning
Car horns
People honking their horn
Ambulance sirens
Drilling
Low flying airplanes

How to talk about noises

I am **sensitive to** certain sounds

I really dislike _____

I **can't stand** the sound of _____

This sound is…

annoying

irritating

aggravating

maddening

(all four words mean the same, i.e. a sound you don't like)

This sound really **grates**

It hurts my ears

It drives me **up the wall**
=makes me angry, drives me crazy

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It drives me **round the bend**
=*makes me angry, drives me crazy*

It drives me **nuts**
= *it makes me crazy*

It gives me a headache

It gets **on my nerves**

It makes me **cringe**

That noise is…

loud,

piercing,

unbearable,

deafening,

throbbing (for a drill),

grating,

high pitch**ed** (adj.),

screeching,

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Which noise do you hate the most and why?

I actually find the sound of the the train quote smoothing and calming

The shrill of the telephone ringtone is so aggravating and irritating

The high pitched hum of the drill on the construction grates so much.

The piercing noise of the automatic saw is unbearable, it reminds me of the dentist's drill and really scares me.

The shrill crow of the rooster is a terrible way to wake up the in the morning

The crash of breaking glass drives me nuts and gives me a headache.

Is noise pollution a problem? Why?

Yes, it can cause stress

It can affect our **stress levels**

It can lead to sleep loss, or even **insomnia**, (the inability to sleep),

It could lead to **hearing damage**

It can aggravate the health of elderly or sick people.

It disrupts our work

It distracts us and makes it impossible for us to concentrate on our work or studies.

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Is there more noise pollution now compared to the past?

With this kind of question notice the 'clues' in the question about comparisons ("compared") and the past time ("to the past")

You don't have to use this grammar (comparisons and past tenses) but it is a good opportunity to do so, and clearly would be appropriate for this kind of question.

One possible template:

Clear opinion: ***I would say arguably yes.***

Talk about the past: ***In the past, there were fewer building sites, so…***

Talk about the present and make comparisons: ***But nowadays…there is more noise pollution because…***
OR
These days there are higher levels of noise because …

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Model Answers

Notice,

*Speech is **not** in perfect sentences.*
*There is **repetition***
*There are **false starts***

If you write your answers out in perfect sentences, it will not sound natural, it will sound like you are a book!
***Don't** write your answer out first,*
***Speak** your answer first, then record it, then write it out.*

You can compare these features of spoken and written English below.

Q1. Why do we have to preserve cultures?

SPOKEN	WRITTEN
Well, I think there are **several aspects** of our culture that are well worth preserving and some of those are traditional **aspects**.	Well, I think there are **several aspects** of our culture that are well worth preserving and some of those are traditional **features**.
I think, you know, customs around birthday **celebrations**, wedding **celebrations**, Christmas **celebrations**, …	I think, you know, customs around birthday, wedding **and** Christmas **celebrations**, ….
It's inevitable for me… I think culture is fluid and forever changing, and to try and stick rigidly to tradition doesn't really work either.	I think culture is fluid and forever changing, and to try and stick rigidly to tradition doesn't really work either.

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Model Answers

Q1. Can the problem of noise pollution be solved ? if yes, how?

A1.

It's a really good question and I think, **frankly speaking,** we can never completely **get rid of** noise pollution.

I think due to the development of technology and industrialisation, there is **a growing amount** of construction happening around us,

so there is always gonna be a certain level of noise pollution coming from the drilling, the building, the shouting of the workers,

even though we put in measures to reduce the amount of noise pollution,

so for example there may be **rules and regulations** about the time of day you can drill or what **kind of machinery** you use to drill,

inevitably, there always be noise pollution.

So, I think it's a real challenge to solve this problem.

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Q2. Which noise don't you like and why?

A2.

Well, there are so many noises that **I find aggravating** but **one of the most maddening noises** there is for me, is the sound of the dentist's drill.

It's one of those noises that is so **high pitched** and **piercing** that **it really grates**

and **it drives me around the bend**, and not only that, not only does it drive me round the bend, it really scares me.

It's a sound I think, maybe the dentist wants to attack me and kill me.

So, **it's one of those noises** I really hate.

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Q3. What are the primary causes of noise pollution in cities?

A4.

I think, nowadays there's **a number of causes of noise pollution**

but probably **one the most significant ones**, is traffic.

As cities grow and there is **an influx of people** coming from the

countryside to the city, they bring their cars with them.

Private car ownership is growing, everybody wants their own car and so there is more traffic on the streets

and that comes with the noise of the engine, from the exhausts, people **honking their horns** because there's more traffic jams,

people **get exasperated** and so you get this build up of noise pollution from traffic.

I think, that's one of the primary causes,

but also, as cities grow there is more and more construction right.

so you have the noise from the construction site, **be it from** machinery,

be it from workers shouting, **be it from** drills that are being used and making this **aggravating** and **piercing sounds** that you hear throughout the day.

So, yeah I would say those two; traffic and construction, are two of the primary causes of noise pollution in cities.

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Part 1 Topics

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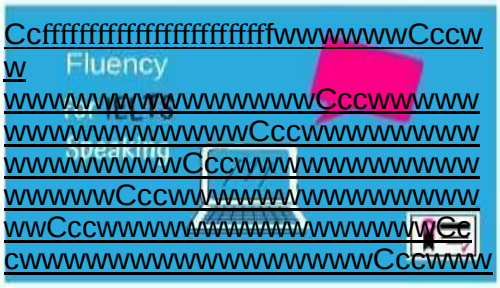

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Part 1 Topics for IELTS Speaking

Concentration and focus
Museums
Handwriting and texting
Weekends

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Useful Links

My **Free Online Course** ***Crack IELTS Speaking Part 1***
https://keithspeakingacademy.com/crack-ielts-speaking-part-1/

Different **kinds of museums**
http://www.historyofmuseums.com/museum-facts/types-of-museum/

10 reasons to visit a museum
https://www.colleendilen.com/2009/07/31/10-reasons-to-visit-a-museum/

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson we will look at some **IELTS Speaking Part 1 topics** that you might be asked about in 2021.

Watch the complete video here

Tips for IELTS Speaking Part 1

1. Mindset:

Before the test, say to yourself, ***"I am going to enjoy this test"***

Sounds strange, right?

However, many people let nerves control them before the test, and this has a negative effect on their speaking and their score.

By focusing on 'enjoying the test', you are more likely to relax and perform better, and so get the score you deserve.

2. Develop your answers just a little

I suggest speaking for around 10 - 20 seconds, if the examiner lets you. Sometimes they will stop you and move on to the next question. This is normal. This is not a conversation, but a test, so expect to be interrupted.

Don't just focus on questions. Focus on the topics and how you can speak with flexibility on those topics.

Many Part 1 questions are quite similar, whatever the topic. If you know these you can better handle all topics.

Find out the most common types of Part 1 questions and how to answer them in my free course here -

Crack IELTS Speaking Part 1

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Concentration and Focus

Here are some phrases you can use to talk about this topic.

Things that distract us….

- Noises (such as traffic, construction workers, children playing)
- Interruptions by co-workers
- Loud music
- Background TV
- People reading my book or newspaper over my shoulder
- Neighbours arguing or making a noise
- Babies crying
- Notifications on social media
- Lack of sleep

We can describe this with the following phrases - practice making sentences with these:

I get distracted by____(something)

My **mind tends to wander** when__I hear loud noises / there are loud noises

I can't **keep focussed** when _____

It's a challenge **to** focus when _____

I lose concentration when _____

I have a **short attention span**

I **am a stickler for**_____(Something) *(= like and insist on some quality or behaviour)*

I **am a stickler for** silence / for working hard / for being on time

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If on the other hand, you find it easy to focus, you might use some of these expressions;

It's easy to focus

It's **dead** *(= very)* easy for me to focus

I **have no trouble** (at all) focusing

I manage to **keep** / **stay focussed on** goals

I am good at **keeping my eye on the ball** *(=focussing on a goal)*

Set my mind to something *(=decide strongly to do something)*

How do you focus?

I focus by taking a deep breathe

I can focus by doing some meditation in the morning

I find prayer helps me focus and concentrate

- by wearing noise-cancelling headphones
- by listening to instrumental music
- by practicing yoga
- by locking myself away in a quiet place
- by just learning my mind
- by taking regular short breaks

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Museums

There are many different kinds of museums, and you don't need to learn them all.

Here are some of the more common ones

- Art museums / art galleries
- History museums
- Science museums
- Maritime museums
- War museums
- Virtual museums

Find out more from this link
http://www.historyofmuseums.com/museum-facts/types-of-museum/

In the test, avoid listing different types of museums; it's much better to choose one or two to talk about.

When it comes to the different kinds of museums, you can talk about the content in the museum or the kind of people who go there (the audience).

They **cater to** different audiences *(=provide services for)*
They **provide for** certain **audiences**
They **aim to attract** different kinds of **public**

(Children, adults, universities)

There is a lot of useful vocabulary you could learn to talk more fluently about Museums. Here are some essentials.

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They are full of **artefacts** *(=objects in a museum)* that can teach us about the past

Museums also have…

Art objects
Works of art
Experiences
Guides (in person guide / audio guide)
Exhibitions
Displays
Curators *(people who choose /assemble the works of art)*

Why should we visit museums?
Here are 10 good ideas on why going to museums is beneficial

https://www.colleendilen.com/2009/07/31/10-reasons-to-visit-a-museum/

In the video you can see lots of reasons and ideas on why museums are good and what people like about them.

These students gave some great answers. They had to finish the sentence,

I like museums because….

Thanks to all who participated.

Below you can see all their comments, and I have corrected any mistakes they made.

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I like museums because **they parade the rich culture** of a place through paintings, sculptures and other works of art.

I like museums because they help us to learn about **things that had become extinct.**

I like museums because they **represent the history of our nation** and people can learn lessons from history and from the past.

Well, I like museums because I love **to explore history** and ancient cultures.

Museums are important as **they preserve the history and heritage of a country** as well as the community. It's like you do time travel and you go back to the past and see all the things that were dead back then.

I like museums because they can be **both enjoyable and educational at the same time**. We can also learn and explore different things in a very interesting way.

I like museums because t**hey provide us an overview of how people lived in the past**, compared to these days.

I like museums because **they collect and preserve our cultural** and **historical values** and I reckon they're really entertaining too.

I like museums because they can serve and preserve the things that have **meaningful value** in a place or community.

I like museums because they're **educational** and usually really interesting.

I like museums because there's a lot of **statues** and **busts**. I love to learn about them.

I like museums because I do like history and **heritage**. Without history, honestly, we don't know where we came from and we can't see where we are going without understanding where we've been, I believe.

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Well, to be honest, **I'm a big fan of the arts** and you know a museum is a place where **a plethora of art works** including **artefacts** and sculptures are displayed.

I like museums because they provide me **an effective way of learning.**

I like museums because I am a great fan of culture and **I'm curious about old and ancient civilisations.**

I like museums because they are not only interesting and **informative** but also allow me to **learn various unknown facts** about my country.

Museums have me **spellbound**, I would love to learn history in these **heritage sites** and also explore new points of view on history at the same time.

I was always **intrigued by museums** because I feel they really are an interesting way of learning about cultures and history. It's just like visiting the past.

I like museums because museums help me **expand my horizons**. On top of that, I feel like **I am standing on the shoulders of giants.**

I like museums because of their **uniqueness** and history, from the past to the future.

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Handwriting and Texting

In the video you can see different kinds of writing

The following are useful ways to describe different kinds of writing.

- Calligraphy
- Writing **with** a pen
- Writing **by hand**
- Taking notes / Making notes / **Jotting down** notes
- Typing **with / on** a keyboard
- **Typing on** a computer
- Texting
- **Cursive** writing (letters are joined - not print writing)

Print is more **legible** (you can read it)
Handwriting might be **illegible**

Notice these unusual words that we use to describe somethings we can do.

You can drink it.	Potable
You can eat it.	Edible
You can read it.	Legible
You can hear it.	Audible
You can see it.	Visible

Graphology *(the study of handwriting and it's connection with personality)*

Handwriting can **reveal** / **show** a lot about a person

Handwriting **speaks volumes about** a person

The way you write **says** a lot about you

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Did you know, handwriting analysis is used

to screen and recruit
to capture criminals
to make a health analysis,

Apparently / Supposedly / According to graphologists…

If you write____, itmeans _____

…or so it seems

Handwriting and personality- are they connected?

Possibly, but I think you need to be an expert to understand it.

Yes, I think so, the handwriting strokes can affect the mood of the writer and you can see this in the writing.

I am not an expert in that field, but I have heard that it is true.

The police think so, they use graphology to help identify fake suicide notes

Maybe, I have heard that if you write with small sized-letters, then it means you are an introvert

I have read somewhere that people who have almost illegible handwriting are smarter than most people.

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Sample Answers

Q1. Do you think computers might one day replace handwriting?

A.

It's a very interesting question. I think that **it's unlikely** computers will completely replace handwriting, although **it's the norm nowadays** for people to communicate by **typing on a computer** or texting.

I still think a lot of people like to **write by hand** because it's **more expressive.**

It has a personal touch and many people are able to kind of **reveal their personality through their handwriting**, whereas typing can be quite cold and **aloof**.

Q2. How do you usually spend your weekends?

A.

Well, to be honest, nowadays my weekends are a bit **monotonous**.

On Saturday mornings, I **tend to work**, but then in the afternoons I like to **go for a stroll around the park** with my family, but only for a short time because of the **confinement**, we are not allowed to spend a lot of time out-doors.

So, unfortunately, yeah my weekends can be rather boring, **not as exciting as they used to be.**

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Q3. How can we make museums interesting for children?

A.

Well, I think, **there is a myriad of ways** we can make museums more attractive for children.

I would say **one of the principle ways** is to give children **an interactive experience**, so that they are doing things when they are in the museum,

because if they're just reading something and looking at different **artefacts**,

they are not really **engaging with the whole experience,**

whereas the kind of interactive experience, maybe also **integrating technology**, **will be much more appealing** for children.

Q4. What makes you happy?

A.

To be honest, **happiness for me is**, finishing work early, going into the kitchen, where **I like to dabble** and **cook up** one of my favourite dishes.

For me, cooking is really **therapeutic** and it really relaxes me and makes me very happy.

But **what makes me the happiest of all,** is sharing the meal with my family or friends after I've cooked it.

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Part 2 Cue Cards

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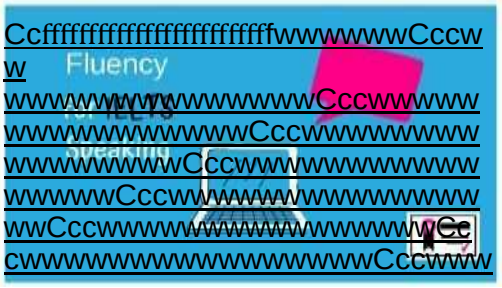

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Part 2 Topics / CUE CARDS for IELTS Speaking

Part 2 Myths
New Cue Cards
Topics and Categories (People and Things)
Sample Answers

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Useful Links

Discover what the **Part 2 categories** are here
https://keithspeakingacademy.com/ielts-speaking-part-2-topics/

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson we will look at some **IELTS Speaking Part 2 topics** and **CUE CARDS** that you might be asked about in 2021.

Watch the complete video here

Myth-busting!!

A myth is something many people believe is true, but actually it it not. Here, we are going to break (or bust) some myths about IELTS Speaking

Are these True or False?

1. You have 2 minutes to prepare
2. You have to give the Cue Card back before you speak
3. You should speak for 1 to 2 minutes
4. I will be allowed to speak for 2 minutes
5. You always get a follow up question
6. Part 2 is worth more than part 1

(ANSWERS AT BOTTOM OF PDF)

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List of Cue Cards (from Students in 2021)

*Notice the **main topic** being asked, as it is important you prepare this topic well for part 3. Notice also the tense, whether they are asking about the past or future.*

Describe a **famous** person you are interested in
Describe a person who you think wears unusual **clothes**
Describe a person who often **helps** others

Describe a special **hotel** you have stayed in
Describe a **city** you have been to and would like to **visit** again

Describe a **toy** you liked in your **childhood**
Describe something you **ate** for the first time
Describe a **wild animal** you have seen

Describe a time when you told your **friend** an important **truth**
Describe the **first time** you **spoke a foreign language**
Describe a time you visited an **art exhibition**

Find out more about the categories of People, things, place, events and activities here

https://keithspeakingacademy.com/ielts-speaking-part-2-topics/

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People

You may be asked about people who are

famous,
intelligent,
energetic,
helpful
…

FAMOUS PEOPLE - Check out a video here - Celebrities video

ENERGETIC Person

Here are some useful phrases you can use to describe an energetic person

To be full of beans
To have a lot of drive
Full of vigour (=energy)
Hyperactive = too much energy (negative)
He is very enthusiastic / zealous / dynamic

INTELLIGENT Person

Here are some useful phrases you can use to describe an intelligent person

To **be on the ball** *(clever / smart)*
He knows_____**like the back of his hand**
She knows_____**back to front**
She knows_____**inside out**
To be **quick-witted** *(smart and funny)*
To **be the brains behind** something
She is **as sharp as a knife**
He is **as bright as a button**
He is a genius / gifted / resourceful when it comes to _____ *(learning languages, selling things)*

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Generally talking about people:

Here are some useful phrases you can use to describe people in general.

The person I want to talk about is **none other than**_____*(my mother, my wife, my neighbour…)*

This is used to mention a person that may surprise the listener)

I've known them (him/her) since_____*(2010, January, lastweek)*

SINCE is used with a point in time

I've known them (him/her) for_____*(2 years, 6 months, 1week)*

FOR is used with a period in time

It must've been_____years ago when we first met

This is often used when trying to remember some exact information.

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Things

You may be asked about things such as

Objects,
Food,
Things you buy,
A book,
A film,
Photos,
Something you have lost
…

Lesson about FOOD - https://keithspeakingacademy.com/how-to-talk-about-food-in-ielts-speaking

Lesson about FILMS / TV - video

Lesson about PHOTOS- https://keithspeakingacademy.com/how-to-talk-about-photography-in-ielts-speaking

Describe a useful book you have read

USEFUL BOOK - Ideas!

Self-help book / personal development books
School books
Novel *(help you relax)*
Dictionary *(to look up words)*
Bible / Koran - Quran *(helps me build my faith)*

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Useful Vocabulary

It's **a** good **read** (n.)
It's a real **page-turner**
I couldn't put it down = *(it was addictive)*
That book had me **on the edge of my seat** *(=it was exciting)*

I read it **from cover to cover** *(= I read the whole book..it was good)*
It's **well worth** reading
It was worth its weight in gold *(=very valuable)*

Each of the following phrase means it was useful.

It **came in** useful
It came in **handy**
It **proved** very **useful**
It **turned out to be** very useful *(=in the end it was useful)*

Each of the following phrase meansI love reading

I'm **a bit of a** bookworm
I'm an **avid** / **voracious** reader
I'm **keen on** reading

Generally talking about things:

Here are some useful phrases you can use to describe things in general.

It's **one of the best____**I've ever **_____**

It's **by far the best___**I have ever **_____**

It's not expensive, but it has **sentimental value**

It's **the best thing since sliced bread**

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Sample Answers

Describe an interesting house you have visited

The other day, I went to a friend's house because they were having a dinner party and they **invited a few of us round** to visit them.

There was only a small number of us, four of us, because during COVID we are not allowed to have a large group of people together.

So, I went to visit their house and it was a really interesting house. It's **out in the sticks** *(= an isolated place)***,** a long way away from the city.

So, it's a bit of a countryside house, a little bit **isolated**, and as you approach, actually, it looks very **palatial** *(=looks like a palace)*

It's really quite a big house. It's made of stone and it has, on the outside a kind of **pebble-dashed finish**, and then it has these kind of, **black tiles on the roof.**

And when we went into the house, I was really impressed, actually, by the **interior decoration**.

She had some lovely **décor** in the living room, I mean where we actually went to eat the dinner, was a **gorgeous room.**

They had this **open fireplace** that was on because it was cold and it's in the winter, and then they have these lovely sofas and a really nice, **mahogany wooden table**, dining table, where we ate the dinner.

Then, the kitchen was my favourite room. **It was by far the best kitchen I have ever seen** because it was huge and it had **all the mod cons** *(= all the modern conveniences),* the modern kind of oven, **working top**, **preparation top**, it was a **gorgeous kitchen**, one that **I would die for.**

And we had a really enjoyable meal and I was very impressed with the house so I thanked them for the meal and **paid my compliments to them** about the beautiful house they also had.

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Describe a funny movie you have seen

I'd like to talk about a movie I saw several months ago and it's called 'The Yes Man' starring Jim Carrey.

Now this was **a film that my brother recommended me to watch.**

He said, it was one of these **laugh out loud** films. He thought it was **hilarious** and that it would **suit my sense of humour.**

So, I watched it on, I think…., I watched it on Apple, actually on the iTunes and so, I rented the film and it was great.

It was all about a man who decided to say yes to life. Basically, he was a very **pessimistic** person and he said 'no' to everybody and then he went to a conference where he was convinced that he should try saying 'yes' to everybody.

So, **he sets himself a challenge** to say yes to every question he is asked and he **gets into all sorts of funny situations.**

It was, you know, one of these films where you're literally **laughing in the aisles**, I **split my sides laughing**. Just all the unusual and comical difficulties he gets into and the creative ways that he uses **to get out of those problems.**

So, I love the actor. Jim Carrey is a kind of famous well-known celebrity.

He has done a lot of different films, from **slapstick comedy** to **irony**, **satirical films** he's been in. He has also played some serious roles as well.

I think the reason I really like this film was **I could identify with the main character** *(= I empathised with him),* right.

I just thought those are the kind of difficult situations I would get myself into and I thought it was really funny, relaxing.

It was a lovey way for me **to chill out.** So yes, I really enjoyed that.

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Myth-busting!! - ANSWERS

1. You have 2 minutes to prepare FALSE

You have 1 minute to prepare

2. You have to give the Cue Card back before you speak FALSE

You should keep the card as you speak, and give it back after you finish speaking

3. You should speak for 1 to 2 minutes TRUE

4. I will be allowed to speak for 2 minutes TRUE

This is true, unless you give a memorised answer, in which case the examiner may stop you after one minute

5. You always get a follow up question FALSE

If you speak for a fun 2 minutes, you may not get a follow up question

6. Part 2 is worth more than part 1 FALSE

Your score is assessed over all three parts of the speaking test, soall three are equally important.

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Live Lesson Notes

Phones

Study with me to get a Band 7 or above on IELTS Speaking
with my Udemy online course

IELTS Speaking Success - Get a Band 7+

What you will learn:

Useful links
Warm up questions
Essential vocabulary
What do you use your phone for?
Kinds of Apps
Student Question
Vague Language
Benefits of texting
Idiomatic expressions
Model Answers

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Some useful Links

Useful vocabulary about phones
https://dictionaryblog.cambridge.org/2014/06/18/the-language-of-mobile-phones/

Article about the **benefits of texting**
(This website is a great resource and you can sign up for free)
https://newsela.com/read/texting-can-be-positive/id/44960/#

Interesting video about the 'Look Up' movement

Click to get a complete **Mock IELTS** Test.
https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

Use the CODE: **keith10** to get a 10% discount.

Find a teacher on **italki** so you can start practicing all the language you are learning here. Practice is the key!
https://bit.ly/IELTSSpeakingitalki

Collect my free materials here (and donate, if you like)
https://keithspeakingacademy.com/ielts-speaking-free-live-lessons/

Follow me on **social media**

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https://www.instagram.com/keith_speaking_academy/

https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCiVm8XcbwS8-pcDEa5lFXIA=

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of PHONES, you will learn how to talk about phones, mobile phone apps and texting.

Watch the complete video about this topic of books here.

Warm up

These are the kind of questions on this topic of phones that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

What do you use your phone for?
What's your favourite app on your phone? Why?
Do you often send text messages?
What are the benefits of texting?

Essential Vocabulary

It is essential to build your vocabulary and also to start ***activating*** *it.*

That means you should try ***making some phrases*** *with the vocabulary below.*

Remember to always learn the ***collocations*** *of new words.*

Smart phone / mobile phone / cell phone

I don't have **a landline** (fixed phone at home in the office)

The **battery** is low
My phone is **low on battery**
I have **run out of** battery
My phone / the battery **is dead**
I need to **charge (up) my phone**

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What do you use your mobile phone for?

There are 2 ways of expressing use

1. I use it FOR + gerund

I use it for accessing the Internet

2. I use it to + verb

I use it to access the Internet

Both mean the same and either can be used

For **passing on** information
For **sharing** stuff **on** social
media For calling friends
For photography
For reading newspapers
For **listening to** songs
For **taking selfies**

I am selfie-mad (I love it)

To chat
To **navigate my way around**
To watch videos
To **apply for** jobs
To **listen to** podcasts
To **get the weather forecast**
To **do online shopping**

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I use it to download **trending** apps

I use it for texting

I use it to **send my emails** at work or at home

I tend to use it just to get online and **surf the web**

It's really **handy for** video-conferences
=convenient, easy to use

It **comes in handy for** accessing Facebook and other social networks

It's **the best way to** play games

I **use it as** an alarm clock

I also use it **to kill time**

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Kinds of apps

Games
Language learning
Productivity
Stocks and trading
News
Health and fitness
Music streaming
Audio books
Dictionaries
Weather
Photo editing
Personal finance

Student Question

What are some places where you cannot use a cell phone?

If we are talking about not making a noise or **being a nuisance**…
(A pain, a bother, something bad)

Temples, mosques, churches or **similar places of worship**
Some hospital **waiting areas**
Quiet zones of trains
Libraries
Cinemas
Theaters

If it's more about **not being allowed to** take photos….

Some museums
Some art galleries
Temples

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Airport security check
Passing through customs control (airport)
Some government buildings (e.g. Embassies) **forbid / prohibit** phones =*not allowed*

Generally speaking,…

When taking an exam
In many schools
At the petrol station / gas station
In meetings - at least we have **to turn the phone to silent**

To turn <u>your phone</u> off

To turn off <u>your phone</u>

To turn <u>it</u> off
To turn off it XXX

Vague language

When you don't know the name of something, you can say…

It's a **thingy**, you know a kind of **thingamajig**
I use a **whatchamacallit**
I like to use the **whatsisname**

What are the benefits of texting?

Texting is **less intrusive**
It'seasier and quicker, especially in emergency situations
It's convenient / **handy**
It comes in handy for expressing emotions
It **eases** the communication between people
It saves time
It's not **time-consuming** / time-draining
It's great for sharing important information
We can say things we may be **too shy** to say **in person**

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Idioms

Just **drop me a line** on What's app when you know = *get in touch*

You can **keep me posted** by sending me a message on Facebook =*keep me up to date*

I use Facebook **to keep in touch** with family

The great thing about texting is that it allows you **to get straight to the point,** *(=be direct)* you don't need **to beat about/around the bush** *(to ramble, be indirect)*

Texting is good for **cutting straight to the chase** =*getting to the point*

At last we can speak, we've been **playing phone tag** all day!

To hit the bullseye = to get it right = to **hit the nail on the head**

Model Answers

Q1: Will books be replaced my mobile phones in the future?

A1.
To be honest, I think **that's highly unlikely,** and the reason is I think a lot of people like **to access both** kinds of things.

So, for example, I enjoy reading paper books, but at the same time, I also like to **read digital books on** the Kindle App on my mobile phone.

So, **I don't think it's a question of either or,** I think actually, it's gonna be both, but maybe we will use one more than the other,

and it's most likely that we are gonna use mobile phones much more than we'll use the old fashioned, **fuddy-duddy**, paperback books.

I think they'll **go out of fashion**, but I don't think they will disappear.

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Q2: Which app you use most in your mobile phone?

A2.

That's a great question.

I have got so many Apps**, it's hard to choose**, but if I had to choose one I would **opt for** Google maps, to be honest,

because when I need to **navigate my way around** a new city or even my own city here, I always use Google maps.

I think I **have lost the habit of** asking people the way.

I **just much prefer** to use Google maps.

It's quicker, it's faster, and it's more accurate.

So, that's probably **the App I use most** on my mobile phone.

Q3: When was the last time you got a piece of good news through your mobile phone?

A3. It was about a week ago, and one of my students **sent me a text message through** WhatsApp to let me know the result of their exam.

So, they **had been preparing** for this English Exam, you may be heard of it, called IELTS…

and you know she had been preparing for maybe 3 months.

She **had worked** very hard for this test and then I got the message, I was actually, I remember, I was at work **at the time**,

I was in front of my computer when my phone **pinged** and I looked at the message and it said that she got the result that she needed.

She was **over the moon** and I was **elated** that she managed to get result she needed and yeah,

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it was a great piece of news for her and I **felt very happy for** her.

So, what I did, is I immediately **texted back** to say congratulations and

to, you know, ask her to **stay in touch with** me and just, if there is anything more she needed, then I would be happy to help her.

So, I think that was the last time I got a piece of good news through my mobile phone.

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Live Lesson Notes

Photography

Study with me to get a Band 7 or above on IELTS Speaking
with my Udemy online course

IELTS Speaking Success - Get a Band 7+

What you will learn:

Useful links
Warm up questions
Essential vocabulary for photography
What kind of photos do you like to take?
Video activity
IELTS Speaking Part 3 Tips
Model Answers

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Useful Links

If you want to **hone your photography skills**
https://expertphotography.com/a-beginners-guide-to-photography/

Tips to **take better photos**
https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/good-pictures-phone-tips

Click to get a complete **Mock IELTS** Test.
https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

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https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCiVm8XcbwS8-pcDEa5lFXIA=

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of PHOTOGRAPHY, you will learn how to talk about different kinds of photos, how to take better photos and how the industry has changed.

Watch the complete video about this topic of PHOTOGRAPHY here.

Warm up

These are the kind of questions on this topic of photos that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Do you like to take photos?
What kind of photos do you like to take?
How often do you take photos?

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Essential vocabulary for photography

Try to fill in the gaps in these sentences, using words related to photos.

1. I snap shots all the time, I am an amateur _pho**to**grapher_____
2. I have a knack for taking good _**pho**tographs_____
3. I am following a _pho**to**graphy_____course online at the moment.
4. I look terrible in photos, I am not at all _photo**ge**nic_____
5. How do you remember all that information? You must have a _photo**gra**phic_____memory.

Answers:

phoTOgrapher
PHOtographs
phoTOgraphy
photoGEnic (adj.)
photoGRAphic (adj.)

An important part of vocabulary building is word families

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Common Collocations

Take a photo **of** someone

To **shoot** a photo

To take some **shots (n.)**

To **snap** a picture / photo (casual)

To take **a snap (n.)**

To **pose for** a photo

I hate posing for photos, 'cos I am just so not photogenic

A **digital** photo

Colour photos / black and white photos

A high resolution photo

A **photo opportunity**

Having all the family together for my birthday was a great photo opportunity

To **capture** the moment **(to catch)**

Photo editing (n.)

To **crop a photo**

a photo frame / album

A photo session

to be **in focus**
to be **out of focus**

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What kind of photos do you like to take?

I tend to take_____

Landscape photos
Portrait photos
Cityscape photos
Seascape photos
Panoramic views
Picturesque views
Selfies
Group photos
Daily life photos

I like taking pictures of_____

I like to capture / shoot _____

I like to photograph (v.)_____

Cities / nature / people / animals / spontaneous (=not planned) moments / everyday situations / food / different scenery / different scenic views

I love to take photos and **post them on social media.**

Everything and anything, it is all **just one click away.**

I am camera shy (= I don't like to be in photos)

Photos that **give me** good memories / **bring back** good memories

I adore **looking back** at my **wedding pics**

Screen shots of brand new jewellery

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Video activity

Watch Stan the Man's **Photography MasterClass**

Fill in the words below!

1. Change_____(use a different angle)
2. Shoot_____above or_____below
3. Give your photos a **sense of**_____(proportion or balance)
4. Use_____out of nature or man-made ones
5. Put your photos_____of focus (the blurry effect)
6. Use Depth of _____

Answers at end of worksheet

This **Masterclass** was based on **tips** from

https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/good-pictures-phone-tips

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IELTS Speaking Part 3 Tips

Develop your answers.

Choose **one focus** and develop that.

Don't plan too much - talk as naturally as possible.

Common Question Types

How has the way we take photos changed in recent years?

You can break your answers into three simple parts.

1. The past
2. The change
3. Now
4. Reason
5. Example

1. Well, in the past, _____

2. But recently **there has been** a huge change

3. Now, we **can see** _____

4. This change is due to _____

5. For instance _____

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Model Answers

Q1. What kind of photos do you prefer taking?

A.

Well, I am a bit of **an amateur photographer** and I really do like taking different kinds of photos, but if I had to pick one kind, I think it would be **different scenic views.** Right?

Landscapes, **I particularly like landscapes** because I live near the countryside.

I am **surrounded by nature.**

So, I love to **get out into the countryside** and to **snap some mountains** or rivers, something natural.

That's the kind of photo I prefer taking.

Q2. How have photos changed our lives nowadays?

A.

Right! I think, well, there are two things, right?

The ways we take photos has changed, and the impact has had on our lives has also changed.

I think the fact that we can take photos with our mobile phones and we can **snap any moment** very, very quickly and high quality,

has meant that nowadays we like to **share high resolution photos** with all of our friend and families, and even people we know, in a very easy way.

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So for example, I think nowadays people love **taking shots of food**. Typically you go into a restaurant and instead of just eating the food, you see people shooting the plate, before they eat it,

and they will even **go to great lengths** *(=try very hard)* to set up the photos, using **symmetries** or **frames** and even special **filters**

to get the perfect photo and then send that to their friends.

So the way we eat has been impacted actually by the photos we take, and the fact that, you know, we can take photos at the press of a button, and high resolution photos **at that** *(=as well).*

Q3. How often do you take photos?

A.

To be honest, I think I take photos **most days.**

It's so easy nowadays just to take out, **to whip-out** your phone and to **snap anything** you see around you,

whether it's food in a restaurant or **a spontaneous moment** when you walking down the street, and, I love **to capture those moments.**

I always have my phone with me so, to be honest, yes, I am taking photos most days.

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Answers to video task

1. Change perspective (use a different angle)
2. Shoot from above or from below
3. Give your photos a **sense of** symmetry (proportion or balance)
4. Use lines out of nature or man-made ones
5. Put your photos out of focus (the blurry effect)
6. Use Depth of Field

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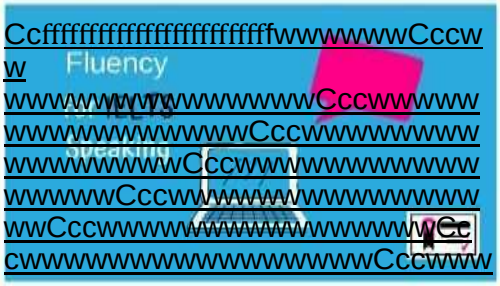
Live Lesson Notes

Preparing for IELTS Speaking

Click on a picture to take my online courses:
*Still **discounted** for the New Year!*



What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful **links**
10 questions you have about IELTS Speaking
Websites to help you prepare for IELTS
Do you have a **New Year's resolution**?
15 favorite **podcasts**

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Useful Links

My **Free Online Course**
Crack IELTS Speaking Part 1
https://keithspeakingacademy.com/crack-ielts-speaking-part-1/

Free ebook: **Reading and Listening Materials for IELTS**
https://keithspeakingacademy.com/free-ielts-study-material-book-listening-reading

Click to get a complete **Mock IELTS** Test.
https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson we look at the Top 10 questions you have about IELTS Speaking.
We also look at great websites and podcasts you can use to prepare for the test.

Watch the complete video about the Top 10 in IELTS Speaking here.

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Your Top 10 Questions about IELTS Speaking

You sent me hundreds of questions about IELTS Speaking and here are the most common ones with my answers.

I have grouped them into categories.

PRACTICING AT HOME

1. Can you tell me the common questions for speaking?

Yes the most common questions for ***Part 1***, can be found in my free online course - **Crack IELTS Speaking Part 1**

For ***Part 2***, there is huge list of questions, so it might be easier to prepare by looking at some of the common topics. You can find some of these **on my website here**

For ***Part 3***, you can find some of the most common questions at the bottom of this **page about IELTS Speaking Part 3**

2. How can we identify our speaking level at home?

Well, you can start to identify your level by **using the IELTS Speaking Band Descriptors.** These are publicly available **here**.

You can also find a simplified version with a **simple explanation here**.

Whilst many students are good at identifying their own weaknesses, they are not so good at assessing their own level.

I would recommend **getting a qualified teacher** to do this.
Platforms like **Cambly** and **iTalki** are good for this.

Alternatively, you could do an **online mock test**.
There are **free ones here,** but I am not sure of the quality

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I recommend **Take IELTS** as I have taken a mock test and like the accuracy and quality of the feedback. I think it is good value for money. You can get a **10% discount** on all their test using **the code**: **keith10**

FLUENCY

3. I've all the sentences in my brain. How can I make the way from my brain to my tongue easier? How can we keep the fluency when we are talking?

Do not try to memorise your answers, or even memorise whole sentences. If you do, you will not focus on fluency when speaking.

Try doing speaking practice (even for 10 minutes a day) where you choose a topic / question and talk about it **only using simple vocabulary** that you know. Forget the fancy words or words you have only just learnt, **just use words you know.** This will help you focus on and build fluency.

GETTING IDEAS

4. How can I develop ideas and organise them well in speaking Part 2?

- **Practice** speaking for 2 minutes. Time yourself, like you are in exam conditions.

You can use some of my **mock tests like this one**, to practice.

- **Research** - read and listen to a wide range of topics

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- Also, **try the following 2 approaches**. I use both, and find they both work well.

1) Go with the flow
2) Use a 3 point structure

- Use Spoken **Cohesive devices** (connectors). Here are some useful ones.

First of all…
For starters….
On top of that….
Mind you / but……
So, anyway…. (Changing topic)
So, finally….
In a nutshell…/ In a word….

GRAMMAR

5. Is Tense important? Sometimes I make silly mistakes regarding tense. Will it cost me a lot in IELTS SPEAKING?

Yes and no!

Yes, because **grammar makes up 25% of your mark**

However, grammar is not only about tense, it includes a lot more.

So a few mistakes in tense won't matter too much.

Also the score is across the whole test; including Parts 1, 2 and 3. So again, one mistake in one question, may not be a big problem.

The problem is when you make the same mistakes again and again, or even different mistakes but regularly.

Error-free sentences must be frequent to get a **Band 7**.

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VOCABULARY

6. Is it ok to use both contractions and their full forms like first "gonna" or "wanna" and then later using "going to" or "want to" Am I penalised for that?

You **should try to use contractions** most of the time, as we use these in conversational spoken English.

So "gonna" and "wanna" and similar ones are fine to use.

You can also use the full forms sometimes, that's fine and you won't be penalised for that.

7. How can we differentiate between spoken English and written English?

This is hard, but I really do recommend to **practice your listening and speaking skills together.**

This way, as you learn new words from a podcast or video (someone talking) you know it is the kind of language you can use in speaking.

Generally speaking, the majority of idioms and idiomatic language tends to be spoken, rather than written.

Likewise, study reading and writing together, for the same reason.

TEST FORMAT

8. What should I say when asked about my hometown or other similar questions, when the actual answer would be too boring or too short?

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Don’t worry, **short is good!** (Especially for the introduction questions)

In the introduction questions, I recommend keeping your answers short and simple. This will take the pressure off you, help you relax, and make it less likely for you to make mistakes.

9. Is it possible to achieve band 8 when it's my first time having IELTS ? And do the questions change depending on my answers?

- Yes, it is certainly possible, but **it depends on your level and how well prepared you are.**

So, if your real level is Band 8 and you have prepared exam technique well, in particular being familiar with the test format and evaluation criteria, then it is possible.

- Regarding the questions changing, **in part 1 of the test, no they do not change**; they are fixed.

In Part 2, the examiner can choose which question to ask each candidate, but that question is then fixed and the topic will be fixed for Part 3.

Part 3 is where the questions can change depending on your answer. The examiner may make up questions to push you further and test different aspects of your language.

PRONUNCIATION

10. Is it ok to use both American English and British English when I speak? I already know that accent is not a problem but what about vocabulary?

It doesn’t matter what kind of vocabulary you use when speaking, **it can be either American or British, or a mixture of both.**

Due to globalisation, you now find many native speakers mixing both and this is seen as acceptable.

Choosing one style is only important in the writing test, not in speaking.

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Websites to help prepare for IELTS

These are websites that many of you are using and that I would recommend for different aspects of IELTS. For more details watch the full video of this live lesson.

IELTS Advantage

IELTS Speaking for Success Podcast

BBC Learning English

E2 Language

MyIELTS Classroom

IELTSLiz

British Council

IELTS Simon

Academic English Help

Read Theory

Ted Talks

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Do you have a New Year's resolution?

On New Year's Day, many people around the world decide to make a change, to stop a bad habit or start a good one. They may even set themselves a goal for the coming year. We call this a ***"New Year's Resolution"***

Here is some language we can use to talk about New Year's Resolutions

A resolution = goal

Yes,

I'm going to _____
I'm aiming to _____
I'm determined to _____
I really want to _____
My goal is to _____

I'm going to stop smoking!

Here are some useful idiomatic expressions you can also use for this topic.

I'm going to do it, come rain or shine *(=whatever happens)*

I'll do whatever it takes!

I am going to turn over a new leaf *(=start fresh / anew)*

I want to kick this habit *(=stop)*

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15 Favourite Podcasts

Here are 15 podcasts that you like and that I also recommend to listen to help you prepare for IELTS.

For ESL/EFL students

Shelly Cornick's podcasts

All ears english, IELTS energy 7+,

IELTS speaking for success by Rory and Maria

Luke’s english podcast

British councilpodcast

6 minutes English from BBC

For everybody (not aimed at students)

- BBC Outlook
- BBC Food chain
- BBC People fixing the world
- BBC Friday comedy night
- BBC Global News podcast
- Future tense from ABC Radio
- Michelle Obama’s podcast
- Radiotopia australia
- The TED interview

Find **more podcasts that I recommend here**

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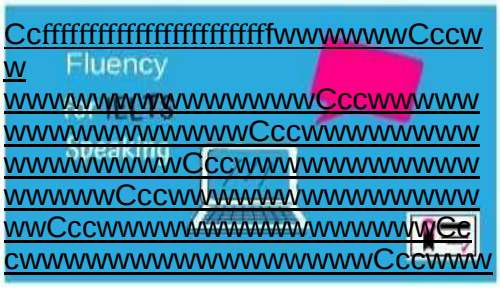
Live Lesson Notes

Prizes

Click on a picture to take my online courses!



What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful Links
Warm up questions
Different kinds of prizes
Part 3 Tip
Essential vocabulary
Prizes - good or bad?
Idioms
Prizes in the workplace

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Useful Links

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of Prizes, you will learn how to talk about different kinds of prizes and the advantages and disadvantages of awarding people prizes.

Watch the complete video about this topic of Prizes here

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of Prizes that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Part 2

Describe a prize you won.

You should say:
what it was
when you wonit
how you won it
and explain how you felt about it.

Part 3

Is it good to award prizes to students in school and university?
Should we use rewards or punishment to motivate young children?
What are the advantages and disadvantages of giving people prizes?
Should companies give their employees prizes?

Practice this mock test with me as your examiner here.

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Different Kinds of Prizes (school / work)

These are the most common kind of prizes that you might want to talk about, at school and in the workplace.

At school
Money
Certificate
A high quality pen
Scholarships
Books
Gift voucher

For sport
Trophies
Cups
Badges
Medals

At work
Perks at work (gym membership, branded bag, half day holiday)
Promotion (a reward)
Money

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Tips for IELTS Speaking Part 3 Questions

A common question in IELTS Speaking Part 3 is

Do you think……?

OR
_____, what's your opinion?

Many people are on automatic pilot and just reply 'I think…"

This is ok, but you can gain some positive points by ***training*** *to use different forms, such as*

The way I see it…
As far as I am concerned….
As far as I can see…
It seems to me….
I reckon…

Do you think it's good to award children prizes for good school work?

The way I see it, yes, it's a great idea because it can motivate them to study more, for example, at my school there was a small cash prize every month for the best reader, and so lots of children would borrow books from the library and read more.

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Essential vocabulary

Here is some essential language to talk about the IELTS Speaking topic of Prizes

Prize (n.) (v.)
Award (n.) (v.)
These are won in a contest or competition

Reward (n.) (v.)
This is given for doing something good /well

To **give** s.o. a prize / an award / a reward
To **present** s.o. a prize / an award / a reward
To **award** s.o. a prize
To **get/win** a prize
To **deserve** a prize

I got it **as** a gift **off** my wife

Word Family

A prize (n.)
To prize something (v.) = to value it
A prized gift (adj.) = valued, cherished

Collocations

I got the **prize for** best student
A **prestigious prize** (well-known, highly valued)
A **consolation prize** (prize for last last)

An **academic prize**
A **cash prize**
A **non-monetary prize**
A **runner-up prize** *(for 2nd or 3rd place)*

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I **came in** first / second / third **place**
I **came in** first / second / third
I **came** first / second / third

Prizes - a good or a bad thing?

Here are some ideas why they are good:

It seems to me, they are a good thing because they **boost morale**

They can **motivate** people to do well

They can **incentivise** people to train and do well

It's a great way to **push people forward** and help them **excel** at whatever they are doing

Here are some ideas why they might be bad:

I'm in two minds about that, they can be bad because they **make** some people **jealous**

Awards can **demotivate** people, if they never win.

They are **a waste of time** at school, because it's always the same students who win. This can be very **disheartening** for others.

They can be a **double-edged sword**, they can **encourage** people, but also **discourage** some people.

Sometimes, they can make the winner **proud** and possible **arrogant,**

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Idioms to talk about Prizes

No prizes for guessing who won the football match = *the result is obvious*

I **hit the jackpot** with this job = *I got a good result, it's going well*

He won, and he was **head and shoulders above the rest** = *he was much better*

I won the first time I tried, it **was beginner's luck** = *luck you get when you try something for the first time*

I won first prize and it **was** completely **out of the blue** = *unexpected*

As luck would have it, I got first prize = *Luckily for me*

I won that competition three years in a row, I had **a lucky streak** = *series of lucky wins*

Break a leg = *good luck!*

He was a **dark horse** in that competition, then out of the blue he won! = *the one you don't expect to do well (we also call this person '**the underdog**')*

*All the following mean **very happy:***

*I was on **top of the world / over the moon / chuffed to bits / like a dog with two tails / on cloud nice** / when I won first prize*

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Should companies give their employees prizes?

Yes, because it can improve **employee retention**

Employee recognition is really important, so giving prizes is a good way to recognise and reward a job well done

Absolutely, prizes can help **keep staff motivated**

If they get a prize, this can not only motivate them, but also help them **achieve their goals** at work

Hard work should be **valued** and giving a prize is a good way of doing that.

Employers should **prize hard work**

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Sample Answers

Q1. Describe a prize you won recently?

A.

I am gonna tell you about a prize I won a couple of months ago.

I was reading the newspaper and, you know, I like to do the **crosswords** (= *a kind of puzzle)*, it's **one of my favourite pastimes**, and there was a competition.

It was a special competition for people who could finish the crossword and they **go into a lucky draw** and they would win a special book all about intelligence and IQ and EQ, emotional intelligence.

So, I decided **to try my luck** *(= to have try)*. By and large, I don't consider myself a very lucky person. I don't **have a great track record** of winning prizes, other than one prize when I was at school.

I thought I would have a go, it's worth a try, and so I finished the crossword, because I am quite good at crosswords, and I **put in my entry** and, would you believe it, **low and behold** *(=surprise, surprise),* **as luck would have it** *(= luckily for me)*, I won first prize.

It was totally **out of the blue** *(= suddenly)*, because I thought thousands of people must have entered, but **to my great surprise**, I won first prize.

They **notified** me and they sent me the book by post and it's something I have **prized** and **cherished** ever since. Not only 'cuz it's quite unique for me to win a prize but also, because the book was really useful and I **a really good read**. And, that is a prize I won recently.

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Q2. Tell me about a person who recently won an award and if he/ she deserved it?

A.

I'd like to tell you, actually, about my niece. My niece is, I think, **if I remember rightly**, she's five or six years old, and her mother was **ever so proud** *(= very proud)* the other day to tell me that she had won a competition.

It was a painting competition. Now my niece **is a big fan of** painting. She spends a lot of time with water paints, colour paints, easels and canvases, **making a huge mess** on the canvas but often producing some beautiful paintings.

And so her mother decided **to enter her for this competition**. It was a district competition in our city, and I think there were literally hundreds of children her age, in her age group, who had entered this competition.

As luck would have it *(= luckily for her)*, she got into the final, the final ten and then, in the end, **out of the blue**, she was chosen as the winner and **she was awarded** a lovely canvas with a brand new painting set with brushes and paintings.

She **was tickled pink** *(= very happy)*. You know, her mother was **chuffed to bits** *(= very happy)* because she was so proud her daughter had won.

And I think yes she absolutely deserved it because, not only is she a great painter you know, I think she's also really creative and she was a bit shy and unsure whether she wanted people to look at her work and criticise it, but she **took the plunge** *(= to decide to try something difficult)* and she decided to enter the competition.

So, she was quite brave so, I was delighted and I think she absolutely deserved to win.

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PUBLIC PLACES

RIDDLE

Riddle: How many letters are in the alphabet?
Answer: 11 (t-h-e a-l-p-h-a-b-e-t).

Some useful Links

Great website to learn new expressions *(use search function in top right side)*
https://www.phrases.org.uk/

Forms of public transport
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Outline_of_public_transport

The Fluency Gym
https://ieltsspeakingsuccess.com/free-ielts-speaking-practice-online-fluency-gym/

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PUBLIC PLACES

Describe a new public building in your city

We can talk about…

Theatres / temples / churches / libraries / post offices / public schools / shopping malls / subway buildings / hospitals / business centres / transport hubs /courthouses

Let me tell you about a new bus station in my city…

Knock down the old one (=destroy)

Brand new = very new

Spanking new = very new

More words related to 'new'
https://www.phrases.org.uk/cgi-bin/phrase-thesaurus/pf.cgi?w=new

A huge **complex** = building (group of buildings)

A handful of (some / several) bus stops

State of the art (=very modern) transport hub (=transport centre)

On-boarding and off-boarding of passengers (getting on and off)

Automatic **vending machines** (=machine selling something, often food and drink) to buy tickets

User-friendly, digital interfaces

To emphasise a comparison we can use 'much'. For example,

'It is easier to walk than to run'

'It is MUCH easier to walk than to run'

Another example,

'In the new transport hub, it's much easier to find the bus than it was before.'

Instead of 'much' we can also use 'far' and 'way'

Far easier
Way easier
Way more convenient
Far more accessible

Describe a trip you made by public transport

What is public transport?

'travel systems available for use by the general public, typically managed on a schedule, operated on established routes, and that charge a posted fee for each trip'

So we may talk about

Trains / Buses / Coaches / Ferries / Ships /
Planes / Taxis / Rickshaws

You probably want to talk about something interesting that happened, as this will allow you to use a wider range of vocabulary.

For example, you might talk about

Scenery
A delay
Unexpected event (e.g. someone fell sick)
An interesting conversation (with someone on the trip)
People we met on the trip

To **travel** (v.)

A **trip** (n.) *(usually from A to B and back to A)*

A **journey** (n.) *(Going from A to B and usually longer than a trip)*

To take a trip

To go on a trip

To go on a journey

To travel **by** plane/train/boat/ferry

To take **a** plane/train/boat/ferry

Wonderful **scenery** (=views)

Breath-taking / **mesmerising** / **eye-catching** scenery (= amazing)

Impressive landscapes

Urban / **rural** landscapes

Fields **dotted with** yellows and greens - from the grass and the trees

I could smell the **fragrance** of the **pines and oaks** (=kinds of trees)

I was **amazed** / **gobsmacked** / **flabbergasted** by/at the wonderful views

To take snapshots (=photos) to capture the moment

Snow-capped mountains

Wide open **plains** (fields and valleys)

We got / were delayed by…

To kill two birds with one stone = to do two things with one action.

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Live Lesson Notes

Recycling

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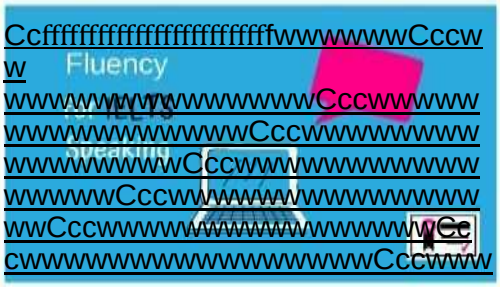

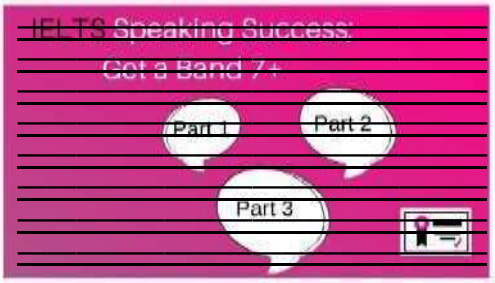

What you will learn in this worksheet:

Useful links
Warm up questions
Useful vocabulary
Do you recycle? Why?
Tips for Part 1
What should we recycle?
Model Answers

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Useful Links

What happens when you **throw plastic away**?
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_6xlNyWPpB8

An interesting article about the reasons we recycle and are they really justifiable?
http://theconversation.com/is-there-any-point-in-recycling-109550

A great tool for learning vocabulary
https://quizlet.com/6398679/recycling-vocabulary-flash-cards/

Some interesting "go green" quotes
https://quotes.yourdictionary.com/articles/go-green-catch-phrases.html

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson on the topic of RECYCLING, you will learn how to talk about your recycling, why we should do it and the kind of things we can recycle.

Watch the complete video about this topic of recycling here.

Warm Up Questions

These are the kind of questions on this topic of business that you might find in IELTS Speaking.

Speak out your answer to the following questions!

Do you recycle?

What do you recycle? Why?

Did you recycle as a child?

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Useful vocabulary

Recycle (v) plastic

Reduce (v) our use of plastic

Reuse (v) items

We can recycle plastic **into** other products

Recycling (n.)

Recycling is important to protect mother earth.

*One of the main things we recycle is waste. There are many words we can use to talk about **waste**.*

waste
rubbish (GB)
rash (US)
garbage (US)
debris

rubbish bin (UK)
garbage can (US)
trash can (US)

landfill
dumping ground
rubbish tip

Biodegradable (adj.) - can decompose naturally

I recycle **biodegradable** items, such as food, or any other **organic** material, in order to make **compost**.

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Compost (helps the soil)
Fertiliser (helps the plants)

I **separate** food **from** household waste

I **segregate** food **from** household waste

I **keep** degradable items **separate from** non-degradable things

Key phrases to talk about throwing away rubbish are,

Thro**w a**way
Thro**w o**ut
Get ri**d o**f
Tos**s a**way / out (inf.)
Dispo**se o**f (frml.)
Donate (=give away)

Common Collocations

Recycling Programme
Recycling centre / factory / plant
Recycling bins / Recycling containers
Recyclable items

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Do you recycle? Why?

I recycle to save/protect/conserve THE environment

I do, **for the sake of** nature

Yes, because it's **environmentally friendly / eco-friendly**

Yes I do, the reason behind this is, it **prevents pollution** and the remaining waste **acts as compost**

I do it in order to **save trees**

It's important to **protect the environment**

Yes, it's our duty to **conserve natural resources**

I recycle to **protect wildlife**, especially **endangered species**

Yes, so that we can **reduce greenhouse gases**

Tips for part 1

Practice speaking for 20 seconds - put your timer on!
Remember, talk about **you**!

Try it now with these questions.

*Do **you** recycle?*

*What do **you** recycle?*

*Did **you** recycle as a child?*

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What should we recycle?

When it comes to **recycling**, we can **recycle**…

Common **recyclables** are…

Plastic
Glass
Paper / cardboard / boxes
Food / leftovers (uneaten food)
Batteries
Used oil

By putting it into separate containers / bins

When it comes to re-using, we **can make good use of** old clothes

Selling **second-hand clothes** online **is all the rage** (=very fashionable) now

We can pass old clothes down to younger siblings

When it comes to re-using, we can make good use of notebooks and magazines

These can be used for **craftwork projects** or activities with kids.

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Model Answers

Will you recycle in the future?

To be honest, I think, I am gonna recycle more and more in the future.

On the one hand, the systems that the government has **are being refined** and **polished** and **getting better and better**, which makes it easier for me to recycle.

But also, I think there is **a dire need** (= an important need) for people generally to recycle more to save the environment.

So I want to **do my bit** (=make my contribution) to help **conserve the environment** and I think recycling is gonna play a key role in doing that.

So I will undoubtedly recycle more in the future.

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How will you raise awareness about recycling in your town?

Well, I think it's really important for **young people and old people alike**, to learn more about recycling and how important it can be.

So I think one of the key things I would do, is I would **first of all** do a **social media campaign**, maybe with some memes and some videos, showing people how to recycle.

That's probably the most important thing, but then also, showing them the impact, the **positive impact of recycling**, and I think that's a really good way to do it because lots of people nowadays g**et their main information through social media,** so it's a channel where we can reach them and have a bigger impact.

Yes, I think that would be **my key focus**, if I had an **awareness campaign** on the topic of recycling.

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How can a nation be developed by recycling?

I think, this is an interesting question, and **on the one hand**, I am not sure that a nation can be developed by recycling, but there are **clear benefits** to recycling.

So, I think on the one hand, you can **raise the awareness** and the kind of the educational level of the **general public** through **government campaigns** to understand how to recycle and the importance of recycling.

So, that's one **clear benefit**. I guess on the other hand, if we are recycling plastics and glass and other items, **non-biodegradable items,** then although yes we are **protecting the environment**, we probably gonna have a **positive impact** on industry as well.

Initially, it may have a **negative impact** on the economy and industry because it might be more expensive, but **in the long term** it's surely gonna make the economy stronger, because we will have **sustainable resource**s that we can use to develop the economy.

So, I guess in the long term, yes, it will help a country to develop their own economy, as well as the general education of the general public.

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Live Lesson Notes

Shopping

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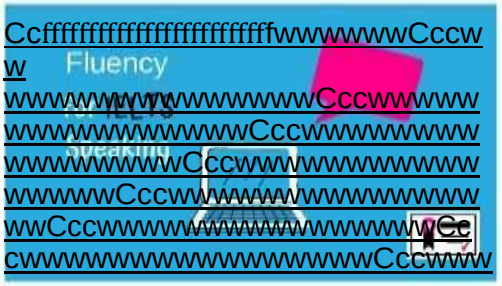

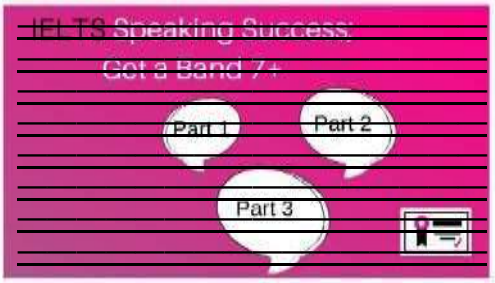

What you will learn:

Essential Vocabulary
Guest Conversation with Eli Howes
IELTS QUESTIONS:
Do you enjoy shopping?
Online versus offline shopping
Idioms
Sample Answers
Vocabulary Review (Kahoot)

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Some useful Links

Click to watch the whole Live Lesson here

Link to our guest **Eli's website** and **Facebook Page**

https://englishprotips.com/

https://www.facebook.com/EnglishProTips/

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Essential Vocabulary

To buy
to purchase (*formal*)
to pick up (*informal*)

Cheap (adj.)
in**expensive**
low-priced goods / food
affordable goods /
clothes

Expensive (adj.)
dear
costly

A shop (n.) = A store (n.) (US)

To shop (v.)

To shop **for** clothes / food

To shop **around** = *to look for the best price*

To **do the weekly shop / shopping =** buy food for the whole week

To **go shopping for** clothes / food

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Collocations

A shopping **mall / centre**

To go **window shopping =** *look in shops without buying*

A High-street shop *(baker's, butcher's newsagents…)*
A Corner shop

Retail shops **=** *shops that sells to customers*
Wholesale shops **=** *sells to businesses/shops*

A One-stop shop = *one shop that sells everything you need*

To shop till you drop = *to shop for hours*

Phrasal Verbs

To pay for = *to buy*

Can I pay for this with cash?

To sell out = *to have no more stock*

They have sold out of those lovely cup cakes

To set s.o. back = *to cost (someone an amount of money)*

It set me back about 20 USD

To splash out = *to spend a lot of money*

I like to splash out on new clothes in the Spring sales

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Do you enjoy shopping?

It **tends to depend on**…..

That depends….

I love **browsing shops** = *going from shop to shop*

I'm an **impulsive shopper** = *I buy things whenever I feel like it, without planning*

I'm a **shopaholic** = *I am (almost) addicted to shopping*

I like to **window shop**, as I don't have much money to spend on clothes.

I like to see all the different things **on display**

Aisle (n.) - passageway, corridor (in a shop, church, airplane…)

I like to **walk along the aisles** in my local supermarket.

The **snack aisle** is my favourite.

I do, my local supermarket gives us **coupons** or **vouchers** that offer discounts to **incentivise** *(=motivate)* us shop more

Adverts are **ever-more** *(=increasingly)* **cunning** *(=clever)* and attractive.

The adverts **grab my attention** / **capture my attention**

A **brick and mortar shop** = *a physical shop*

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Is the move from offline shopping to online shopping a good thing?

Bad Things

It's an **inevitable thing**

It's a shame that so many physical shops are disappearing

So many companies are **going out of business** due to COVID.

*All of the following mean **"to go out of business"***

To close down
To go into liquidation
To go bankrupt
To go belly up

Unfortunately we **lose the personal touch** of chatting and socialising with other shoppers and shop assistants when we shop online

It's not a good thing as we don't know which sites to **trust**.

I am always **wary** (=*careful with)* **of** online payments, I mean you hear of so many **scams** *(=dishonest attempts to get your money)*, so is it really safe and secure?

Good Things

The **rise of online shopping** means we can busy things from anywhere in the world, **at the click of a button** *(=immediately)*

Online shopping makes the purchase of most things **much easier and more convenient.**

Online shopping has been **a lifesaver** during COVID. It's easy to get anything, even **everyday essentials** like food.

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Do you prefer online or offline shopping?

I prefer ____

I lean towards_____*(=I like/prefer)*

Online shopping saves time. **It saves a ton of time.**

It depends **on** what I am buying

I like physical shopping because I can **try** stuff **on.** *(Clothes)*

I like physical shopping because I can **try** stuff **out.** *(Electronic things)*

I can actually touch the products if I am in a real shop

Online shopping is **much more practical** and **the delivery** is usually pretty quick.

With the rise of companies like Amazon, then **online delivery** is very fast nowadays.

Online shopping is fun, if you like opening boxes.

I shop online for clothes a lot, but you never know if **the size is going to fit**, so there **is always a bit of a risk.**

Despite the convenience that comes with online shopping I still prefer offline shopping as it enables me to inspect my goods before paying.

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Describe something you bought and felt happy with

All of the following are things you may want to talk about:

Phones
Perfume
Books
Clothes *(jumper, sweater, dress, shirt)*
A new laptop
A car
A house

I was happy although it **cost me an arm and a leg =** *it was expensive*

I w**as over the moon** with my purchase = *very happy*

I was **delighted** with the quality of the product = *very happy*

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Idioms about SHOPPING

My new bike **cost an arm ’n' a leg** = *to be expensive*

I **paid <u>over</u> the odds** for it = *I paid too much*

I **paid <u>through the nose</u>** = *I paid too much*

It was **going for a song** = *it’s cheap*

I like **retail therapy**, it cheers me up! = *shopping that makes you happy*

To **talk shop** = *talk about your work (usually negative)*

He is so boring, he is always <u>talking shop</u> at parties.

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Sample Answers

What are the differences between men's and women's shopping habits?

Well, I don't want to **stereotype** or **overgeneralise**, you know, because, I think, **it depends more on** the personality, **rather than** whether it's a man or a woman.

However, a lot of people do generally say that women enjoy shopping for clothes more than men.

Maybe because they are more **fashion conscious** and they like to go into a lot more detail like **touching the material**, **checking the price**, **checking the quality**, whereas maybe men are much more practical and you know, if the item of clothing **fits** and it's **comfy**, they may buy it, **irrespective of the price** *(=whatever the price)*

They may **be reluctant to** go to **shop around** to find the best item.

But as I said, that may be a bit stereotypical.

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What is the product, which is consumed most in your country? Why?

To be honest, **I don't know statistically speaking** which is the most consumed product in Britain, but I do know that British people buy and sell a lot of cheese.
We love cheese. So, there are **many varieties of** cheese that are **sold across the country**: mature cheese, blue cheese, crumbly cheese, cheese spreads.
It's something that's may be connected with our **eating culture** and our **culinary heritage**.

We like to have cheese on sandwiches. We often eat sandwiches at lunch time.
So, cheese with different sauces or different kinds of vegetables is a very, very common thing for us t**o consume** either at lunch time or at another time of the day, in the afternoon.

So, I'd say, yeah, cheese **is one of the most popular**, **most widely consumed products** in my country.

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Sport

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Riddle
What 4-letter word can be written forward, backward or upside down, and can still be read from left to right?
Answer: NOON

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Some useful Links

A great tool to find **collocations**
http://www.ozdic.com/collocation-dictionary/sport

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https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

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Essential Vocabulary

He is running

He likes to go running

He is going for a run

He is not jogging (light-paced running), he is running quickly

Go
(often used for individual sports emphasising that you 'go' somewhere to practice it).

Go running, jogging, climbing, cycling, skating, skiing, swimming

Go for a run, jog, climb, cycle, skate, swim

She is doing yoga

She is practicing yoga / pilates

She likes to do yoga

Do
(usually used for individual sports without a ball)

Do yoga, karate, judo, pilates, aerobics, tai chi, athletics, weights, weight-lifting, boxing, arm-wrestling

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They are playing football

They like to pay football

Play
(usually used for sports with a ball or similar and have some element of competition)

Play football, cricket, golf, tennis, baseball, basketball,

When you learn a new word, like a sport…

1) Practice **collocations**

Do pilates

2) Practice **chunks** (=short phrases)

I like to do pilates

3) Practice **juggling** (=saying the chunk in different tenses)

- *I do pilates most days*
- *Tomorrow I will do some pilates*
- *This morning I just did some pilates*

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What sports do you do?

To be honest, I don't do too **much sport** these days.

Notice 'sport' can be ***countable***
e.g. I play lots of different sports

But 'sport' can be ***uncountable*** *if it is more abstract and referring to sport in general.*
e.g. I don't do too much sport these days.

I enjoy **strolling** (*going for a stroll)* on the beach,

and occasionally I even **break into a jog.**

To break into a jog = to start jogging
To break into a sweat - to start sweating

Oh yeah, I also do yoga **now and again.**

Now and again ***= sometimes, now and then, from time to time***

When I was younger **though** I used to go swimming **on a regular basis,**

Though *= but, however (very natural to use it here). Instead of saying 'however, when I was younger…' try saying, 'when I was younger though…)*

I usually **squeezed it in** at lunchtime.

Squeeze in an activity *= find time to do it*

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Collocations with ‘sport’

http://www.ozdic.com/collocation-dictionary/sport

It’s a **spectator** sport (=I watch it)

It’s a **competitive sport**

It’s a **contact sport** (=close contact and possible injury)

Other collocations….

It’s a_____sport

water, field, indoor, outdoor, extreme…

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Is there a new sport you would like to try? Why?

I'd like to **have a go at _____**

I'd like to **try my hand at _____**

I'd love to **give____a go**

I'd like to **take up _____**

Some unusual sports you might like to try

Riding a penny farthing

Surfing

Paragliding

Quidditch

Underwater hockey

360 ball

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Success with Part 2 Cue Cards

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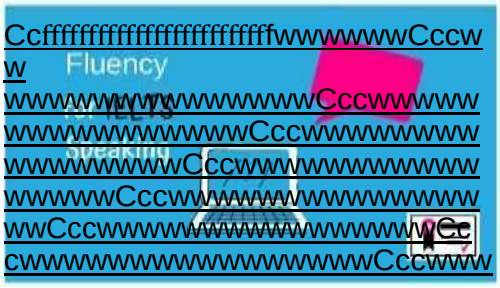

What you will learn in this worksheet:

IELTS Speaking Part 2

Review of Cue Cards about PEOPLE and THINGS
New Cue Cards about EVENTS and PLACES
Ideas / Idioms for many Cue Cards
Sample Answers

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Useful Links

Templates and sample **Part 2 Cue Cards**
https://keithspeakingacademy.com/ielts-speaking-part-2-topics/

Art Museum Virtual Tours
https://artsandculture.google.com/?hl=en

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Introduction

In this free IELTS Speaking lesson we will look at some **MORE IELTS Speaking Part 2 topics** and **CUE CARDS** that you might be asked about in 2021.

Watch the complete video here

Cue Cards

These are Cue Cards that have been shared by students doing the test recently.

PEOPLE:

Describe a famous person you are interested in
Describe an energetic person you know
Describe an intelligent person you know

Describe a person who you think is very open.

Ideas:

You may talk about a person who is..

- **honest** (=don't *tell* lies, don't *tell* fibs)
- **likes to listen to new ideas**
- **accepts feedback and criticism**

Idioms/ Vocabulary:
He never **pulls the wool over your eyes** *(=to lie or deceive)*
She is **open to** suggestions
He is **open-minded**

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THINGS:

Describe a book you found useful

Describe a skill you think you can teach others.

Ideas:

You could talk about …

- A hobby - sport, games, language
- Work - coding, typing,
- Soft skills - communication, team work

Idioms/ Vocabulary:

I **have a knack for** doing this *(= I'm skilled at___)*
I can **show you the ropes** *(= show you the skills you need)*
I can **show you the ins and outs** of this

I know how to **do this with my eyes closed** *(= this is easy for me)*

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EVENTS

*In part 2 you may be asked to describe a **time** you…..*

gave advice
had a dinner
worked in a group
made a decision
got a piece of news/advice

*Sometimes, you are asked about the **first time** you did one of these things.*

Here are some videos to help with 2 of these topics

Describe a time you had to make a decision
Decision-making - video

Describe a time you worked in a team with others
Team work - video

Generally talking about events:

Here are some expressions you can use to talk about any events:

This was__5__years ago
This is going back___5___years

I remember it vividly *(=clearly)*
It seems like yesterday
If my memory serves me right….
If I'm not mistake, it was….

It was a **brand new** experience
It was **my first encounter with**….
I had never done this before then

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Cue Cards

Describe a time when you told your friend an important truth

Describe the first time you spoke a foreign language

Ideas:

You could talk about a time…

- at school
- at work
- on holiday
- in a job interview

Idioms/ Vocabulary:

All of these 3 mean very scared:

I was **scared stiff**
I was **scared to death**
I was **scared out of my wits**

These 3 mean I was nervous and panicking:

I was **panic-stricken**
I was **like a deer (caught) in the headlights**
I felt like a **nervous wreck**

If my memory serves me right (= *if I remember correctly)*

I was afraid people might **mock** me (= *make fun of me)*

I **was** a little bit **tongue tied** *(= I was too nervous too speak)*

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I was waiting with **bated breath** *(= couldn't breathe due to nerves or excitement)*

Words were just **on the tip of my tongue** *(= I couldn't remember or speak out the words)*

Describe a time you visited an art exhibition

Idioms/ Vocabulary:

These mean 'I couldn't understand it'

I **couldn't make head or tail** of (the paintings)
I **couldn't get / wrap my head around it**

There was so much **to take in** *(=to see and absorb)*

I was blown away by the paintings *(= I really liked them - they were vey impressive)*

I was **captivated**

The picture was **jaw-dropping** / **breath-takin**g

If you have never been to an art exhibition, you can take a virtual tour in any of the greatest museums in the world - thanks to google!

Art Museum Virtual Tours
https://artsandculture.google.com/?hl=en

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PLACES:

In IELTS Speaking Part 2 you may be asked to describe different kinds of places, such as a…

- hotel
- home
- public building
- country
- city

Here are some videos to help with 2 of these topics

Describe a home you have visited but would not like to live in
Homes - https://keithspeakingacademy.com/ielts-speaking-lesson-topic-home-accommodation

Describe a city you have visited
Cities - https://keithspeakingacademy.com/ielts-speaking-lesson-topic-cities/

Generally talking about places:

Here are some expressions you can use to talk about any events:

Location:

It's located **in the north** of England
It's located **to the north** of London

It can be found
…in the city centre
…in the suburbs / outskirts
…near the coast

It's **a stone's throw** from my house *(=it's very close)*

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Opinion:

It's a place you wouldn't want to miss
It's a great place to…
It's a must-see place
It's well known for….

Cue Cards

Describe a place in a foreign country where you want to work for a short time.

Ideas:

You could talk about a…

- city
- company
- shop

Idioms/ Vocabulary:

I **fancy** working in Paris *(I'd like to)*
I **wound't mind** working in Paris *(I'd like to)*
I **have got my mind set on** working in Paris *(I have a plan to do it)*
It interests me to work in….

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Sample Answers

Q. 1: Describe a place you never want to visit again?

A place that I would like to describe is a shop that I once visited many years ago.

It must have been about 15 years ago and **this is going back** when I was about nine years old

and **I was on holiday at that time** with my family in France

and none of us **had been to** France before, but I decided, well, we decided to visit this village.

This shop **was located in the centre** of the village and I had to go in and speak French and I didn't do it very well, and I **was scared stiff** and I got so embarrassed because nobody could understand me.

That feeling of embarrassment was so strong that I decided I never wanted to go back to that shop again.

Even though, the next day my dad said, please Keith, go back to the shop and get the bread,

it will help you practice your French, but I **was really reluctant** to go back because I felt a bit like a dope *(= an idiot)*

and I just knew that the words would be **on the tip of my tongue**, but I would **get tongue tied** and I just didn't want to go back.

So that was a place that I would rather not go and visit again; not because the people were unfriendly, but because my experience then there wasn't a very good one.

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Q2. Describe a movie that you saw recently?

I'd love to tell you about a movie that I saw a couple of weeks ago.

I watched it at home, because I enjoy watching movies at home and it was a real kind of **Hollywood blockbuster.**

Now, **I can't remember the name exactly**, but it was one of those **action movies** and it was to do with a kind of an attack on London

and it was Part 2, **it was the sequel to another film** which was about an attack on America, on Washington DC.

And this one was about some kind of terrorist attack on London and on the Government in England.

It was an interesting film. I mean, **as far as action movies go**, it was quite entertaining. The **special effects** were really **spectacular**.

They obviously used **computer graphics** and also some **fancy, elaborate techniques to captivate the audience.**

The music was good. It was very **fast-paced** and exciting music and it really **drew you into the action**. So, you were always **on the edge of your seat,** excited to see what would happen next in the movie.

The main actor was an actor who always plays the same role, he's always playing either the head of the police or the head of the government.

I think **he's typecast** *(= always given the same kind of role in a film)* quite a lot, so he's always in the same role and to be honest **the acting was not believable at all**.

It was just **over the top, ridiculous acting**, but which matches the kind of this film.

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Of course, **the plot was totally unbelievable,** but again with this kind of action packed film, it is what you expect nowadays.

So, overall, I enjoyed it. **It was a bit of escapism for me** so it was .., it's a film that I enjoyed watching.

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Tourism

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The Riddle:
I am a word. If you pronounce me rightly, it will be wrong. If you pronounce me wrong it is right. What word am I?
Answer: **Wrong.**

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Collocation Dictionary
http://www.ozdic.com/collocation-dictionary/holiday

Quora - Forum of questions and answers on any topic!

https://www.quora.com/How-will-travel-tourism-change-in-the-future

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Part 3

Techniques

Develop your answers

For example, give

1) Opinion
2) Reason
3) Example

Speak generally, not just about you and your life.

Avoid giving lists

Go into details

Give very specific examples

The examiner will listen to what you say and often make up the next question based on what you said.

Don’t worry if the examiner cuts you off. It’s normal.

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PART 3 QUESTIONS

Please note, in Part 3 the examiner is free to **make up** a lot of the questions.

So, it is **impossible to predict** exactly what questions you will get.

You should therefore NOT try to predict and plan certain answers, BUT to practice answering a wide range of questions for part 3.

These are the **kind** of questions you might be asked.

What souvenirs do people often buy from tourist attractions?

Why do people buy souvenirs?

Is it good that local people sell things to tourists?

Why do people like to take photos when travelling?

What are the pros and cons of taking professional cameras when travelling?

What are the impacts of tourism on a local economy?

How will tourism change in the future?

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Essential Vocabulary

Holiday-maker / tourist / traveller

Take _a **Holiday**

Book_a **Holiday**

Go_on **Holiday**

http://www.ozdic.com/collocation-dictionary/holiday

To **go sightseeing** = to visit tourist attractions

To **see the sights** = to visit tourist attractions

To **get off the beaten track** = to go to less visited places (where few tourists go)

To **get away from the crowd** = to escape the tourists

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Part 3

What souvenirs do people often buy from tourist attractions? Why?

Don't give a list, just two items is enough and then go deeper…

What do they look like?
Why?
Examples?

Fridge magnets
Key rings
Local food
Caps
T-shirts
Tattoos
Tea Towels
Ornaments
Trinkets

…**and what not**
=and things like that

…and stuff like that

Why?

To **remember** their holiday

It's a **reminder** of their travels

It **brings back** fond memories

So they can **look back on** their holiday

Look back and reminisce

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If we are talking about parents -

They tend to buy _____

They are fond of buying _____

They typically pick up _____

They go for _____

However, if we are talking about young couples -

They might go for _____

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What are the pros and cons of taking professional cameras when travelling?

Pros / benefits / advantages / upsides / a plus factor

Cons / drawbacks / disadvantages / downsides / a negative side

On the one hand _____

On the other hand _____

Compare!!

You can take higher quality photos

Top-notch photos = high quality photos

You can **swap lenses**

You can use a **zoom lens**

You can **shoot** objects from far away

Cumbersome = Bulky = big and heavy, awkward to carry

Not as compact as a mobile phone

Compact = small and easy to carry

It's heavier than a mobile phone

There is risk of losing it / of breaking it

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What are the impacts of tourism on a local economy?

There is a direct impact on hotels, restaurants, and shops / retail outlets

Tourism…

Provides / creates / increases jobs

Boosts / increases sales

Boosts / enlarges profits

Is a **source of revenue**

Brings cashflow to the tourism sector

Strengthens the local economy

Boosts local trade

Destroys local culture

Brings **noise pollution**

Leads to excessive **littering**

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How will tourism change in the future?

https://www.quora.com/How-will-travel-tourism-change-in-the-future

It's hard to say but _____

Increased popularity in **ecotourism**

I think the Corona virus will significantly *change* the *face* of *tourism*

Experiential tourism - people are looking for experiences (stay with a family, go on stage, shop at local markets)

This **draws in** (attracts) a lot of tourists

Notice we can take things that are true now, and just say they will continue in the future, putting our sentence into the future tense.

NOW (RECENT PAST):
AirBnB has changed the face of accommodation for tourists

FUTURE:
AirBnB is going to change the face of accommodation for tourists

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NOW:
We now book hotels online

FUTURE:
The way we book holidays will change dramatically - the trend of booking online will probably continue

Couch surfing will significantly change the face of tourism in the future

I suspect due to the Corona virus, we will travel by air less, and **domestic holidays** will become the **norm** (=the normal situation)

Space exploration and **space travel** will become more popular, once it has become cheaper and more accessible for the **mainstream** (=most people)

More and more young people will travel and volunteer to help in other countries - I think this trend is known as '***voluntourism***'

Note: it doesn't matter if you don't know the exact word for something - you can just say, "I think this iscalled…".

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Helping Others And Volunteering

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THE RIDDLE
What is greater than God,
more evil than the devil,
the poor have it,
the rich need it,
and if you eat it, you'll die?
Answer: **Nothing**

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Essential Vocabulary

To help someone out

I like to **help** people **out**

To lend_a hand

To give_a hand

To lend a *helping* hand

To give a *helping* hand

To pitch in and help = join in and help

To **volunteer** is to offer your time for free, to help others.

Part 2 - Strategy

The 1 minute preparation

Get an idea quickly. Choose the first one that comes to mind that is good enough.

Don't brainstorm lots of ideas, you don't have time!

Choose one that is related to the main question, it doesn't have to be perfect.

Remember *you don't have to cover all the bullet points*

In fact you can talk about different bullet points, so long as you answer the main question.

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I suggest in the 1 minute preparation, *you choose 3 blocks / topics / areas* to talk about ;

For example, with this question

Describe an experience when you volunteered to do something

3 blocks/topics/areas to talk about ***could*** be

1. What I did
2. Why
3. How I felt

Remember, before the 1 minute preparation finishes, *get your first sentence ready!*

For example,

"So, I'd like to tell you about the time I volunteered for a new project in my workplace…"

This will,

- Make a good first impression
- Build your confidence

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Part 2 Question

Describe an experience when you volunteered to do something

IDEAS

Formal

Teaching abroad
Looking after the elderly
Childcare
Wildlife conservation
Community development
COVID - food for people at risk - below the poverty line - helping with the food banks
Festival volunteers (a fad / fashion in UK now)
Fun fairs

Informal

Helping out your parents at home
- Help do the washing at home

Helping a teacher in school
- Clean the classroom
- Carry books
- Wipe the blackboard

Helping a boss at work
- Lead a project (at school or work)
- Take minutes in a meeting

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Sample Answer

Describe an experience when you volunteered to do something

My boss asked for a volunteer to participate in a new project.

BACKGROUND

I was living in… I was working as.. at the time

I had moved there some years earlier

My boss was looking for someone to…

I put my hand up

I agreed to lend a helping hand

WHY

I felt it would help me build professional skills

It was a good opportunity to…

I thought I could….

WHAT HAPPENED

I joined the team

I pitched in

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I enjoyed it…

Why do some people volunteer?

Gain experience

Get a **sense of satisfaction**

They find **solace** in it (=comfort or peace)

Give something **back** to the community

Make a difference in people's lives

Develop new **skills**

Develop a new **skillset**

Develop professional skills

Build self-confidence, self-esteem and well-being

It provides **a sense of purpose**

It's a good way to spend a **gap year**

*(some UK students **take a year off** to travel the world and maybe volunteer abroad before they start university, or after graduation and before they star work)*

It **looks good** on your resume / C.V.

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What role do charities play in your country?

Charity (n.) = an organisation

Charities are non-government organisations (N.G.O.s) set up to help people in need.

Charity (n.) = the act of voluntarily helping others often by giving money.

Some well known charities.

Click on one of these are read about their work.

It will give you a great amount of useful vocabulary, as well as a god idea or example to talk about.

Red Cross

Oxfam

World Wildlife Fund (WWF)

UNICEF

Amnesty

Save the Children

Doctors without borders

They **raise funds** (money / donations)

They put money in the right place to reach the right people

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To donate (v.)

Donations (n.)

They **gather donations** to fund their work.

A donor (person)

Charities collect contributions and distribute the money to help others out.

Philanthropy (n.) - the act of helping people / giving money

This charity was **set up** to help _____

The homeless / homeless people / people without shelter

To help them **get back on their feet**

It helps people who have **fallen through the cracks** in the government system

It aims to build their self-esteem - self confidence

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Work-life Balance

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Riddle
How much soil is there in a hole 3 meters deep, 6 meters long and 4 meters wide?
Answer
None, or else it wouldn't be a hole.

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Some useful Links

The One Thing by Gary Keller
https://www.the1thing.com/

In Defence of Food by Michale Pollan
https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/315425.In_Defense_of_Food

Advice and video on how to achieve a work-life balance
https://time.com/43808/how-to-achieve-work-life-balance-in-5-steps/

Click to get a complete **Mock IELTS** Test.
https://takeielts.net/the-path-to-success-in-the-ielts-test/

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What is work-life balance?

Work-life balance is the amount of time you spend doing your job compared with the amount of time you spend with your family and doing things you enjoy.

(from Cambridge Dictionary, online)

Whose responsibility is it?

It's our responsibility, we need to **manage our own time** and **take our own decisions**

Some people find it hard because of **time limits** and **tight deadlines** placed on them by their company or boss.

It's hard to **turn** your boss **down** (=saying 'no') when they ask you to **work overtime**, especially when you are new in a company.

How do you achieve a work-life balance?

I like to draw a line between work and home

I need to have good time-management skills

Mind management is really important

= *Look after your mental health*

It's good to have outlets for your stress

Outlet = a release or a way to relieve something, like stress

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Delegate = give a piece of work to someone else in your team.
= to **allocate/assign** a piece of work to someone in your team.

To **outsource** = to employ, hire someone else to do it (outside of your team/company)

Leave matters of work at the office

Refuse to take your work home

Use **flexitime**

An example of flexitime is…
You can start between 8 and 10 am
You can finish between 4 and 6pm

More ideas

Prioritise

Do the **important** not the urgent

Don't spend time **putting out fires** *(handling urgent problems)*

Be clear on your **values**

Do things that **align with your values**

Manage your boss

Use the Pareto Principle (the **80/20 rule)**

Do what **only you** can do

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Why do some people have a poor work-life balance?

They are not good at **getting the monkey off their back**

To **have a monkey on your back** = to have a burden or problem

When we **delegate**, often the person we delegate to, will give us more problems to solve, so in effect, we have more problems than in the first place. We have more monkeys on our backs.

They can't delegate effectively

They tend to procrastinate (v.)

They have a habit of procrastinating (v.)

They're guilty of procrastination (n.)

It's hard to **strike** (=reach/achieve) a balance

Deadlines have to be **met**

There is **excessive stress** at the workplace

They are bad at managing their time / work

They **clock up** lots of overtime (=work lots of overtime)

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